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Inventor(s)

Abouhmad; Adel Elsayed Attia et al.

### ANTIBACTERIAL POLYPEPTIDES

#### Abstract

The present invention relates to antimicrobial peptides comprised of a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity. The invention also relates to the use of such peptides in medicine, for example for treating mycobacterial infection.

**Inventors:** Abouhmad; Adel Elsayed Attia (Lund, SE), Kaul; Rajni Hatti (Lund, SE), Briers; Yves (Nederokkerzeel, BE), Grimon; Dennis (Gent, BE), Clarsund; Mats (Gent, SE), Dishisha; Tarek (Lund, SE)

**Applicant:** Novalysin AB (Lund, SE); Universiteit Gent (Gent, BE)

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#### Background/Summary

##### FIELD

[0001] The present invention is in the field of antimicrobial peptides, in particular those for use against mycobacteria.

##### BACKGROUND

[0002] *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* (Mtb), an acid-fast microorganism, is the causative agent of tuberculosis (TB), which is considered a health threat due to the highly emerged resistance rates (Muller et al., 2013). TB is considered one of the leading causes of death worldwide with 10 million patients in 2017 (WHO 2018) with half million new multidrug resistant TB cases. Despite the existence of curative chemotherapy, the emergence of the alarming context of multidrug-

resistant (MDR), extremely drug-resistant (XDR), and totally drug-resistant (TDR) TB and the lack of effective therapies has increased the demand for developing new and innovative antimycobacterials (Marrakchi et al., 2014; Mitnick et al., 2009).

[0003] The major characteristic feature of mycobacteria is their unique cell wall structure with up to 60% lipid content compared to 5-10% for Gram-positive and Gram-negative bacteria (Neyrolles & Guilhot, 2011). The cell wall of *Mtb* consists of an inner peptidoglycan layer that is covalently linked to arabinogalactan, which is esterified with mycolic acids (MA). MA are long chain (C.sub.60-C.sub.90),  $\alpha$ -branched,  $\beta$ -hydroxy fatty acids containing cyclopropane rings, double bonds, and oxygenated groups, according to the species and genera (Watanabe et al., 2001). The specific composition of the MA is dependent on the *Mycobacterium* species including short saturated a, C.sub.20-25, and a longer meromycolate chain, the  $\beta$ -hydroxy branch C.sub.60, comprising double bonds, cyclopropane rings and oxygenated groups (Payne et al., 2009).

[0004] MA are found in two forms: unbound and bounded. The first is: unbound which are glycolipid esters of trehalose forming trehalose monomycolate (TMM) and trehalose dimycolate (TDM; also called the cord factor) which has a key role in mycobacterial pathogenesis (Bhamidi et al., 2008; Brennan, 2003). The second form of MA is bounded via ester linkage with the terminal pentaarabinofuranosyl units of arabinogalactan (AG), the polysaccharide that together with peptidoglycan, forms the insoluble cell wall skeleton (Brennan & Nikaido, 1995; Daffe, 2008; Daffe, 1996; Hoffmann et al., 2008; Mcneil et al., 1990; Niederweis, 2008). Both forms of MA impart impermeability to the cell envelope and participate in the two leaflets of the mycobacterial outer membrane, the mycomembrane (Sani et al., 2010; Zuber et al., 2008).

[0005] The mycomembrane imparts hydrophobicity that results in decreased permeability to nutrients and antimycobacterials making TB difficult to treat (Jarlier & Nikaido, 1990). It is also essential for cell viability, hence the target of antituberculosis (anti-TB) drugs (Vilcheze & Jacobs, 2007). Due to the unique structure of the mycomembrane envelope it is considered a key target for novel antimycobacterials. Tuberculosis drugs target various aspects of *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* biology, including inhibition of cell wall synthesis, protein synthesis, or nucleic acid synthesis. For some drugs, the mechanisms of action have not been fully identified. The major action of anti-TB drugs is via affecting lipids, glycolysis, nucleic acid synthesis and inhibition of mycolic acid biosynthesis. Anti-TB drugs target the energy system of cells and/or inhibit synthesis of cell wall components. They act intracellularly, and so need to be internalised/trafficked into the target cells. Accordingly, anti-TB drugs are typically ineffective on dormant/latent cells.

[0006] The use of endolysins as antibacterial enzymes is increasingly considered for the treatment of bacterial infections. Endolysins are peptidoglycan degrading enzymes produced by phages at the end of the lytic replication cycle. They degrade the cell wall of the infected cells, which eventually results in lysis and dispersion of the viral progeny. The natural function of these endolysins can be exploited to use them as powerful enzyme-based antibiotics, also coined 'enzybiotics'. Exogenous application of recombinant endolysins to Gram-positive bacteria rapidly induces osmotic lysis and consequent cell death.

[0007] In the last two decades, endolysins have proven their efficacy in different models of infection in animals (Nelson et al., 2012) and bacterial contamination in food (Schmelcher et al., 2012). A key feature of endolysins is their modularity and the opportunities that emerge thereof to customize properties of endolysins such as specificity, activity, stability and solubility (Gerstmans et al., 2018). Initially, endolysins were only explored for Gram-positive pathogens as their thick peptidoglycan layer is immediately accessible from the outside. However, protein engineering is being applied to expand the antibacterial spectrum of endolysins to Gram-negative bacteria. Fusion proteins of a single, specific endolysin (KZ144 from *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* bacteriophage varphiKZ) acting against the peptidoglycan layer of Gram-negatives and a selected outer membrane permeabilizing peptide kill Gram-negative bacteria through local destabilization of the outer membrane, followed by passage of the fusion protein across the outer membrane and degradation of the peptidoglycan layer. This results in immediate cell death through osmotic lysis (Briers et al., 2014). These fusion proteins are called 'Artilyns'. In addition, a similar protein engineering strategy has been applied to endolysins against Gram-positive pathogens, resulting in engineered endolysins that kill faster, with higher activity (+2 log) and potency.

[0008] The complex nature of the mycobacterial cell wall, comprising peptidoglycan, arabinogalactan and mycolic acid layers (FIG. 1), poses a major obstacle for antibiotics in general and has hindered the expansion of enzybiotics toward *Mtb* until today.

[0009] Mycobacteria can be infected by several viruses known as mycobacteriophages that face the same challenge of the unusual structure of the cell wall and are therefore equipped with two different and separate types of enzymes to lyse the mycobacterial cell wall: (1) LysA hydrolyses the peptidoglycan layer (peptidoglycan hydrolase enzymes, also termed endolysins), and (2) LysB cleaves the ester linkage of mycolic acids to the arabinogalactan layer (mycolyl arabinogalactan esterase enzymes that are not typically considered as conventional endolysins, but can instead be categorized as enzymes with lipolytic activity). Although these enzymes are encoded in a lysis cassette in mycobacteriophages, arranged as protein coding gene segments in tandem, they are released as separate proteins and do not exist in nature as fusion proteins.

[0010] LysB-D29 enzyme (without any antimicrobial peptide present) showed synergistic effect with anti-TB drugs; Rifampicin (also known as rifampin), Ethambutol and Isoniazid in subminimal concentrations (concentrations which inhibited the growth, but did not show any bactericidal effect) against *M. smegmatis* and *Mycobacterium bovis bacillus* Calmette-Guerin (BCG) (Sharma, 2017). Similarly, in comparison with Sharma, WO 2017/023680 A1 used peptides

comprised of LysB only, in the context of treating acne.

[0011] However, recent evidence has highlighted that LysB peptides alone are insufficient to have antimycobacterial activity (Abouhmad et al, 2020), even when used in combination with anti-TB drugs. Instead, combination with outer membrane permeabilisers, such as colistin and protamine, were required to observe antimycobacterial properties, potentially due to the mycobacterial membrane being highly hydrophobic and thick.

[0012] In other studies, two types of peptides are exemplified (Miller, 2015), each of which consist of: (i) an antimicrobial peptide (AMP), LysA and a protein transduction domain (PTD); or (ii) an AMP, LysB and a PTD. However, these fusions of antimicrobial peptide with either LysA or LysB individually did not exert antimycobacterial activity (Miller, 2015). When these peptides were combined as a mixture post expression and purification, antimycobacterial activity was detected. In this study, Miller was limited to the use of a TrxA tag to enhance the solubility of their peptides.

[0013] There remains a need for improved peptides which are capable of disrupting cell envelopes, such as those of mycobacteria, in order to exert an antimicrobial effect.

#### BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0014] As discussed, the peptides known in the art do not comprise all the necessary activities within a single peptide due to various complications, such as steric hindrance of multiple units comprised in a fusion peptide. The polypeptides provided herein are comprised of all necessary activities within a single polypeptide while retaining the necessary function of antimicrobial (e.g. antimycobacterial) activity.

[0015] The present invention, for the first time, provides peptides comprising at least three domains, as follows: (i) a domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; (ii) a domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and (iii) a domain with membrane permeabilising, destabilizing and/or disrupting activity. Such peptides are capable of targeting complex cell envelopes comprised of multiple components, as shown in FIG. 1.

[0016] A benefit of peptides of the present invention over antimicrobials (such as anti-TB drugs) is that the peptides are able to act against dormant/latent cells. A further benefit of the peptides is their increased specificity and selectivity to bacteria comprised of the aforementioned complex cell walls, for example mycobacteria. Another benefit is that the fusion peptides (comprising AMP, LysA and LysB) have surprisingly a faster expression rate compared with AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB; and improved inhibitory activity compared with a mixture of corresponding AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB mixtures.

[0017] The inventors surprisingly found that all three domains/functions could be provided in a single peptide.

[0018] The peptides of the present invention comprise activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, which enables them to effectively target bacteria with cell walls further comprising a peptidoglycan layer. The peptides also comprise a membrane permeabilising, destabilizing and/or disrupting domain (such as an antimicrobial peptide (AMP)) to further enhance their antibacterial activity. Additionally, in one embodiment, singular peptides of the present invention are capable of killing their target bacteria, which contrasts to peptides of the prior art which require the combination of multiple different peptides to kill target bacteria.

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0019] The present invention relates to a peptide comprising three domains: [0020] (i) a domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; [0021] (ii) a domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and [0022] (iii) a domain with membrane permeabilising activity.

[0023] A “component thereof” may also be referred to as a “portion thereof” herein. These domains may be referred to as a first, second or third domain, respectively. However, a first domain is not to be construed as limited to activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof. For example, the first domain may have activity specific to an ester linkage and/or membrane permeabilising activity. However, the peptides of the invention are at least capable of all three activities as listed above. Additionally, the first, second and third domains can be present in any order in the peptide.

[0024] Accordingly, a first aspect of the invention is a peptide comprising a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity.

[0025] By “activity specific” we include the meaning that the domain is capable of specifically binding or associating with a second entity (i.e. a target), and/or that the domain enacts a change (for example, the breakdown of the target entity) on a second entity. For example, a domain with activity specific to peptidoglycan would include a domain that induces peptidoglycan hydrolase activity.

[0026] Accordingly, in one embodiment a first aspect of the invention is a peptide comprising: [0027] a first domain that is: [0028] a) capable of specifically binding to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; and/or [0029] b) capable of specifically associating with a peptidoglycan or component thereof; and/or [0030] c) capable of enacting a change in a peptidoglycan or component thereof; [0031] and a second domain that is: [0032] a) capable of specifically binding to an ester linkage; and/or [0033] b) capable of specifically associating with an ester linkage; and/or [0034] c) capable of enacting a change in an ester linkage; [0035] and a third domain with membrane permeabilising, destabilizing and/or disrupting activity.

[0036] A “peptide” or “polypeptide” is used herein interchangeably in its broadest sense to refer to a compound of two or more subunit amino acids, amino acid analogs, or other peptidomimetics. The term “peptide” thus includes short peptide sequences and also longer polypeptides and proteins, including variants and fusions thereof. As used herein, the term “amino acid” refers to either natural and/or unnatural or synthetic amino acids, including both D or L optical isomers, and

amino acid analogs and peptidomimetics.

[0037] It will be appreciated by persons skilled in the art that the term “amino acid”, as used herein, includes the standard twenty genetically-encoded amino acids and their corresponding stereoisomers in the ‘d’ form (as compared to the natural ‘l’ form), omega-amino acids other naturally-occurring amino acids, unconventional amino acids (e.g.,  $\alpha,\alpha$ -disubstituted amino acids, N-alkyl amino acids, etc.) and chemically derivatised amino acids (see below).

[0038] When an amino acid is being specifically enumerated, such as ‘alanine’ or ‘Ala’ or ‘A’, the term refers to both l-alanine and d-alanine unless explicitly stated otherwise. Other unconventional amino acids may also be suitable components for polypeptides of the present invention, as long as the desired functional property is retained by the polypeptide. For the peptides shown, each encoded amino acid residue, where appropriate, is represented by a single letter designation, corresponding to the trivial name of the conventional amino acid.

[0039] A domain may be a “binding domain”, which includes the meaning of any peptide sequence that is capable of binding or associating with a second entity. In the case of the first domain, the domain is able to bind specifically to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; in the case of the second domain, the domain is able to bind specifically to an ester linkage and/or to a peptidoglycan or component thereof; and in the case of the third domain, the domain is able to bind specifically to a cell membrane or component thereof (for example, glycolipids (such as Lipoarabinomannan, TDM, TMM), mycolic acids, phospholipids, etc), such as an outer and/or inner leaflet component of a cell membrane. For example, the third domain may be able to bind to glycolipids and/or phospholipids and/or mycolic acids exposed on a cell membrane.

[0040] By “bind specifically” we include the meaning that the domain (or the peptide comprising at least one domain) binds to its target in a manner that can be distinguished from binding to non-target domains (i.e. off-targets). For example, a domain that binds specifically may refer to a domain that binds with higher specificity for the intended target compared with that of a non-intended target. Specificity can be determined based on dissociation constant through routine experiments. A domain being “specific for” a target is intended to be synonymous with a domain “directed against” said target. By “binding specifically” we also include the meaning that the domain has binding affinity specific to its target. Binding affinity or specificity in the context of a domain may be to a particular component part of a cell wall, for example, whereas binding affinity or specificity in the context of a peptide comprising at least one domain may be to a particular cell wall.

[0041] Binding affinity may be quantified by determining the dissociation constant (Kd) for a peptide or domain thereof and its target. Similarly, the specificity of binding of a peptide or domain thereof to its target may be defined in terms of the comparative dissociation constants (Kd) of the peptide or domain thereof for its target as compared to the dissociation constant with respect to the peptide or domain thereof and another, non-target molecule.

[0042] Typically, the Kd for the peptide or domain thereof with respect to the target will be at least 2-fold, preferably 5-fold, more preferably 10-fold less than Kd with respect to the other, non-target molecule such as unrelated material or accompanying material in the environment. More preferably, the Kd will be 50-fold less, even more preferably 100-fold less, and yet more preferably 200-fold less.

[0043] The value of this dissociation constant can be determined directly by well-known methods, and can be computed even for complex mixtures by methods such as those, for example, set forth in Caceci et al. (Byte 9:340-362, 1984). For example, the Kd may be established using a double-filter nitrocellulose filter binding assay such as that disclosed by Wong & Lohman (Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. USA 90, 5428-5432, 1993).

[0044] A method for the evaluation of binding affinity for a peptide or domain thereof may be by ELISA. Other standard assays to evaluate the binding ability of peptides or domains thereof towards targets are known in the art, including for example, Western blots, RIAs, and flow cytometry analysis. The binding kinetics (e.g., binding affinity) of the peptide or domain thereof also can be assessed by standard assays known in the art, such as by surface plasmon resonance (e.g. Biacore™ system) analysis.

[0045] A competitive binding assay can be conducted in which the binding of the peptide or domain thereof to the target is compared to the binding of the target by another, known ligand of that target, such as an antibody. The concentration at which 50% inhibition occurs is known as the Ki. Under ideal conditions, the Ki is equivalent to Kd. The Ki value will never be less than the Kd, so measurement of Ki can conveniently be substituted to provide an upper limit for Kd.

[0046] A peptide of the invention or domain thereof is preferably capable of binding to its target with an affinity that is at least two-fold, 10-fold, 50-fold, 100-fold or greater than its affinity for binding to another non-target molecule.

[0047] Preferably the binding domain will bind only to its respective target, as specified above, and will not bind to any other molecule in the environment, for example in the human body. However, it will be appreciated that some degree of off-target binding may be tolerated, and the skilled person will understand how to determine whether a particular binding activity is of the required specificity or not.

[0048] A peptide of the invention is preferably capable of being expressed at a faster rate than AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides made up of the corresponding domains. Despite the presence of additional active domains, the peptides of the invention are surprisingly not toxic to hosts such as *E. coli*, and so it is possible to express them in such systems without arresting host growth due to toxicity. The skilled person will realise then that the ability to express the peptides of the invention without any apparent toxicity means that the cells are able to grow faster and to a higher cell density and so overall increased peptide yield than cells expressing a toxic protein that affects the growth rate of the cell. On the other hand, AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides are toxic to *E. coli*, which results in arresting cell growth and so a reduced

overall peptide yield. Therefore, in some embodiments, a peptide of the invention is non-toxic to non-mycobacterial hosts, such as *E. coli*. The skilled person will appreciate that the toxicity of an agent can be determined by monitoring the effects of the agent on the growth of the expression host cell, and that the growth rate of a cell or culture of cells can be determined by monitoring the optical density of a culture of cells at the appropriate wavelength. For example in some embodiments, the peptide of the invention does not affect the growth rate of the expression host cell. In some embodiments the peptide of the invention reduces the growth rate of the expression host cell by less than 40%, for example by less than 35%, 30%, 25%, 20%, 15%, 10%, 5% or less than 2%. The skilled person will appreciate that the growth rate of a cell culture is typically determined during the logarithmic growth phase.

[0049] In some embodiments the peptide of the invention is less toxic to an expression host cell than the corresponding AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides made up of the corresponding domains. The skilled person will appreciate that when comparing the toxicity of different peptides, the same amount of each peptide ought to be used. As described above, the toxicity of a peptide can be determined by monitoring the growth rate of a culture of host expression cells grown in the presence and in the absence of said peptide. In some embodiments the fusion peptide of the invention may be at least 50% less toxic, or greater, such as 60%, 70%, 80% or 90% less toxic than the corresponding AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides made up of the corresponding domains—i.e. the fusion peptide reduces the growth rate of the expression host cell less than the corresponding AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides. By having lower toxicity to the host in which the peptides are being expressed, the expression rate or overall yield can be increased for the peptide. As discussed above, the expression rate can be determined based on optical density (OD<sub>sub.625 nm</sub>) of the bacteria in which the peptide is being expressed, i.e. the culture density positively correlates with protein expression level. For example, a peptide of the invention, in comparison with AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides made up of the corresponding domains, may be expressed at least 10 times (10×) faster, 9× faster, 8× faster, 7× faster, 6× faster, 5× faster, 4× faster, 3× faster or 2× faster. The rate of expression may be portrayed relative to time. For example, the rates described above may be after 1 hour, 2 hours, 3 hours, 4 hours, 5 hours, 6 hours, 7 hours, 8 hours or more of incubation in LB medium.

[0050] A peptide of the present invention preferably has a higher level of inhibitory activity against mycobacteria compared with AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides made up of the corresponding domains. In some embodiments, a peptide of the present invention has an inhibitory activity against mycobacteria that is, compared with AMP-LysA and/or AMP-LysB peptides made up of the corresponding domains, ≥2 times (2×) higher, ≥3× higher, ≥4× higher, ≥5× higher, or more. Inhibitory activity may be assessed using known techniques, such as those used in Example 4 of the present specification.

[0051] A domain (e.g. a first domain) with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof may be an enzyme or a domain derived from an enzyme which retains the functional activity of the enzyme, e.g. an enzyme active domain (EAD), also referred to as an enzymatically active domain. Thus, in one embodiment, the first domain exerts enzyme activity on a peptidoglycan or component thereof. In one embodiment the domain is a lysin, for example an endolysin (which may be categorised as a structural endolysin, modular endolysin, and/or globular endolysin). The term “structural endolysin” may also be referred to as structural lysin, virion-associated lysin (VAL), or virion-associated peptidoglycan hydrolases (VAPGH). By “activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof” we include the meaning that the domain is capable of binding or associating with a peptidoglycan or component thereof, and/or that the domain enacts a change (for example, the breakdown of the target entity) on a peptidoglycan or component thereof. For example, the domain may be capable of cleaving peptidoglycan bonds in the cell wall. The endolysin may be a peptidoglycan hydrolase enzyme, for example a LysA and/or at least one enzyme active domain (EAD) thereof. Additionally, or alternatively, the domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof may be a tail fibre protein with peptidoglycan hydrolysing activity, such as a structural endolysin. Additionally, or alternatively, the domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof may not be considered an endolysin, for example the domain may be at least one lysozyme and/or autolysin.

[0052] The targeting of the peptidoglycan layer may be achieved by at least one lysin, for example at least one endolysin, such as at least one LysA. LysA are made up of EAD that may have mechanisms of actions corresponding to amidase, endoamidases, transglycosylase (such as lytic transglycosylases), chitinase, muramidase (such as N-acetylmuramidase), glycoside hydrolase, glycosidase (glucosaminidases, e.g. N-acetyl-β-D-glucosaminidase), DD and DL carboxypeptidase, transpeptidases, epimerase, lysozyme, L-alanoyl-D-glutamate (LD), m-DAP-m-DAP (LD) D-alanyl-D-alanine carboxypeptidase and peptidase (such as N-acetylmuramoyl-L-alanine amidase, D-Alanine-meso-Diaminopimelic (DD) endopeptidase, c-D-glutamyl-meso-diaminopimelic acid (DL) peptidase, L-Alanine-D-Glutamate peptidase, cysteine protease), and γ-D-glutamyl-meso-diaminopimelic acid (DL) peptidase activity. The EAD present in a LysA may vary. For example, a LysA may comprise EAD with at least amidase, transglycosylase, chitinase, muramidase or peptidase activity, such as a LysA comprising only EAD with amidase and chitinase activity. Accordingly, in one embodiment, the targeting of the peptidoglycan layer is with LysA.

[0053] Alternatively, or additionally, the targeting of the peptidoglycan layer may be achieved using at least one EAD derived from a LysA. EAD derived from LysA may be fused with any other domain component contemplated herein. EAD derived from LysA may be fused to further LysA and/or EAD derived from LysA. For example, a first EAD derived from LysA with amidase activity may be fused to a second EAD derived from LysA with muramidase activity. Fusions may comprise 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 or more EAD derived from LysA. “Derived from LysA” is to be construed as encompassing EAD derived from the same LysA or from different LysA. For example, a first EAD (with any of the above

listed activities) derived from a first LysA may be fused with a second EAD (with any of the above listed activities, whether the same or different compared with the first EAD) derived from the first and/or a second LysA. Exemplary EAD include amino acid sequences corresponding to SEQ ID NOs: 326-338, as encoded by the nucleic acid sequences corresponding to SEQ ID NOs: 313-325, respectively.

[0054] The domain targeting the peptidoglycan layer may further comprise at least one cell wall binding domain (CBD). The CBD may be specific for the target cells of interest. For example, the CBD may confer specificity of a peptide to at least one mycobacteria. Alternatively, or additionally, the CBD may be classified as one that does not have specificity for Gram-negative bacteria and/or Gram-positive bacteria. For example, the CBD of a peptide described herein may be specific for mycobacteria only and not specific for Gram-negative bacteria. Multiple CBD may be present, for example as tandem repeats, and/or as multiple copies at different positions within a peptide. The presence of multiple CBD may refer to multiple copies of the same CBD and/or different CBD. For example, a peptide may comprise multiple copies of a first CBD and only one copy of a second (or further) CBD; or comprise multiple copies of a first CBD and multiple copies of a second (and/or further) CBD.

[0055] The CBD selected for use in a peptide of the present invention will depend on the intended target (or targets) of the peptide. For example, the most suitable CBD for treating *M. abscessus* may be a CBD derived from a mycobacteriophage that is capable of infecting *M. abscessus*. In some embodiments, the CBD may be capable of targeting multiple species (e.g. species of mycobacteria) based on those species sharing the targeting domain of said CBD. In some embodiments, the CBD will be determined based on the domain targeting the peptidoglycan layer. For example, if the domain targeting the peptidoglycan layer is a LysA, this may imply that the CBD is the CBD known to be associated with that specific LysA. In other cases, the CBD of a particular LysA could be swapped for (or supplemented with) a CBD from a different LysA to allow the activity of the LysA to be targeted to a different mycobacteria.

[0056] Therefore in one embodiment, the domain targeting the peptidoglycan layer is a LysA comprising a CBD. For example, in one embodiment the LysA CBD may be PGBD (Putative peptidoglycan binding domain) (pfam01471). In another embodiment, the LysA CBD may be a LGFP motif (pfam08310; superfamily cl07065).

[0057] In one embodiment, the amino acid sequence of the domain targeting the peptidoglycan layer may be selected from any one or more of SEQ ID NOs: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14 or 326-338; or may be encoded by any one or more of the nucleotide sequences of SEQ ID NO: 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13 or 313-325, as follows:

TABLE-US-00001 Length: 1566 Type: DNA Other information: LysA-BTCU-1 Sequence ID No: 1

ATGACAGAGCGTGTCTGCGTATGATCGTAATATTGTACCACAAGAAACGGGTTGGTGGTGCGGTCCGGCAGCG  
ACGCAAGTTGTTCTGAATAGTCGTGGAATTATTGTACCGGAAGCGACCTGGCAAATGAAATTGAACAAATTGAA  
AATCCAGGTCGCGGTGACGATCGTGGAACGGATTATGTGGGGCTTATTGAACAAGTGCTTGATCGCCGTGTG  
CCCGAAGCGAAATATACGAGCGTGTATATGCCTAATGATCCGCCCCACCGCAGCCCAACGCGAAGCTTTATGGCAA  
AATATTGTGCGCTCCATTAATGCGGGCTGGGGTGTCAATTATGAATTGGGTGGCGCCGCCATCCAATAAACCACGC  
GGAGTCAAAGGTAGCCCCAATCCTAAATATTCAGGTGGTACAACCTTATCATTATGTGGCCTGTATGGGTTATGAT  
GATACTCCGGGGCGCCCGCGCCTTGTGGATTGCGGATTCTGGGTTTCAACCTTTAATTATTGGATTTCGTTTGAT  
CAAGCAGCAACGCTCATTCCACCTAAAGGGTATGCGTATGCCGCGACGACGGCTACAGCTCCTGCGCCGGCTCCA  
GCCCCTGTTGATGCGGCACCCATTTTAGCACGCGCAGCTGGGATTAGCGAAGCTAAAGCACGTGAAATCTTACCC  
ACCTTTCGTGATGGTTTGCCTTAGCTGAATGTAATAATGTTCCGCGCATTGCAATGTTTATTGCACAAACAGGC  
CACGAAAGCGATAATTTAATGCCACTCAAGAATATGATCATGGCCGTAATTATGGCGATCCAAATGAAGCAACC  
GATCGTTGGAAATATAAAGGGCGTACGTGGATCCAAATTACATGGCGTGGTAATTATGAGCGTTTCTCACGTTGG  
TGTTTTGATCGTAAATTGGTGCCTACCCCAACATATTTTGTAGATAATCCACGCGCACTCGCGGATGTTCTGTTGG  
GCAGGAATTGGCGCGGCGTGGTATTGGACGGTAGAACGTCCTTCCATTAATCGCCTGTGTGATGAGCGTAATTTA  
ACGGAAGTTACTCGTCTGATTAATGGTGGCACATCGTGGGAAGCCCCAACCTGGATGAAACATCGTAAAGAACGT  
TATGATCGTGCGTTAGCTGTGGGTAATGATCTTTTAAAGCTGTTAGATGGCGAAGAAGAAGGGTTTCTGTGCGCG  
CTTACGCCGAAAGAGCAACGTGAACTTTATGATGAAATTATGAAACGTGGGCCTAGCCGTAGCTTTCTTGCGGAT  
GATGGTCGTCAAATCGAAACGCTGCTCGGTTTTATTTATAATATTGATGGAAATGCGTGGAAATATTGTGAATATT  
CTTGGTTGTTTGATTGGTGTACCAGAGTGTGTGCGATGATATTCGTGACGTTGCCGAAAATGGAGTACGTAAAGGT  
TCATATGCAGAAAGTAATCCCTGGCTCGCGCAATTTGGTCAAGAATTTTGTAACGTTTGCTTCCCCTTGCTGGT  
AAACTGTCTGAACTCTTGAATGCACAAGAATTTAAGGTTACACATAATCGCATTATTGAACAATGA Length:

521 Molecular weight: 58.59 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following domains: Peptidase  
C39 like domain; 16.fwdarw.152 Lysozyme like domain; 209.fwdarw.385 Other information: LysA-  
BTCU-1 Sequence ID No: 2

MTERVLPYDRNIVPQETGWWC GPAATQVVLNSRGIIVPEATLANEIEQIENPGRGDDRDGTDYVGLIEQVLDRR  
VPEAKYTSVYMPNDPPTAAQREALWQNIVRSINAGWGVIMNWWAPPSNKPRGVKGSPPKYSGGTTYHYVACMG  
YDDTPGARALWIADSGFQPFNYWISFDQAATLIPPKGYAYAATTATAPAPAPAPVDAAPILARAAGISEAKARE  
ILPTFRDGLRLAECNNVPRIAMFIAQTGHESDNFNATQEYDHGRNYGDPNEATDRWKYKGRTWIQITWRGNYER  
FSRWC FDRKLVPTPTYFVDNPRALADVRWAGIGAAWYWTVERPSINRLCDERNLTEVTRLINGGTSWEAPTWMK  
HRKERYDRALAVGNDLLKLLDGEEEGFLSALTPKEQRELYDEIMKRGPSRSFLADDGRQIETLLGFIYNIDGNA  
WNIVNILGCLIGVPECVDDIRDVAENGVRKGSYAESNPWLAQFGQEFCKRLLPLAGKLSSELLNAQEFKVTHNRI  
IEQ Length: 1434 Type: DNA Other information: LysA-Bxb1 Sequence ID No: 3

ATGCCTCGCGTGGTCTATGGTCTTACACATTCTAGCAATGGCTGGCCTATGCTGAACTCGGACGAATGTGAATGG

ACCAAATTCGCGGACGTCAGTAACCTTACAAATTGCGAAAGGACAAACCGCTGGCAATTTTGGCTGCTTTTGGC  
GCAGATTTTCATGCTTATGTTGAACCTCTCCGTGATGCTGATAGTGCCTGTTGGACACCAACAAATAGTGTTC  
AGCTCGAATCATTTGTCTGGAAGTGAATGGATCTTAATTGGAATACACATCCTTTTCAAGTTCCCGATGCGGGT  
TTTGATGCTGCCAAGAAGGCTCGTGTAAGGAACTGTTGGATTTCTATGAAGGAATGGTCTTTTGGGGTAATGAT  
TGGAGCTCACCGAAAGACGCAATGCATTTTCAACTGGCTTCCTTACGTAATGGTGGCACGTTTGACACGTATGGT  
AATCCCAAAACGGCTGATTTTATTGCCCCGTAAAATTCGTGCCGATGGATATTCTACGTTTCGTCTGGATCAGCG  
CCTGCCTCAGCCGCGCCAATTTTGGCAGCAGCGACGGGTCTTTCGGAAGCGCGTGCCGCAGAAATTTTACCAGCA  
GTGCGTAGCGGTCTGCGTGAGAGTGAATGTACTAATGTGAATCGTATTGCCATGTGGTTGGCGCAAATTGGCCAC  
GAGAGCGGAAGTTTCAATATACAGAAGAAATTGCGAAGAATGGTCGCTATGCACCATATATTGGTCGCACCTGG  
ATCCAAATTACTTGGGATTATAATTATCGTTCTTTTAGCCAATGGGCCTATGCCTTTGGTATGGTCCCTACACCA  
GATTATTTTGTGTAAATTATCGTGAACCTGGCGGACTTAAATGGGCCGGAATTGGTCCGGCGTGGTATTGGACT  
GTTGCGCGTCCCGATATTAATGAATTAAGTGATCGTCGTGATTGTAATACCGTAACTCGTCGCATTAATGGTGGT  
ACGAATGGTCTGGCTGACCGCCAGGCGCGTTATAATCGTGCATTGGCTCAAGGTGACGCCCTCTTGCAGCTGTTG  
CATGAGGAAGATGATTTTCTGTCAGCGTTAACGGATGCCGAGCAACGCGAACTGCTCGATTTAGCCCGTCAACAA  
GCGAAATATAAACGTAAAAGCCGTAGCCCCCTTACATTGGCCTCATGAAGGTGAAGTTGATACAATTGCGGGATTG  
AGCTGGTCTACCGATGCAAATGTTTACATTCAATTAGTTGAAAAGCTGGCAGTTATTTATGGGGATCCCGTTAGC  
ATTGCACTTTTATATGCCGTTTCCAATTCGGATGACCCTACCAATAATCCGGAATTAGCCAAACGTATTTTAAAA  
CGTGTGAAACCGGAAGATATTACGGCAGCCCAAGTGCAAATTCAAAAGTGGCTCGCGGCGGAACAGAAATTTTAC  
GCGGCGTGA Length: 477 Molecular weight: 53.32 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following  
domains: Peptidase\_M15; D-alanyl-D-alanine carboxypeptidase, L-Ala-D-Glu peptidase; 12.fwdarw.137  
Glycoside hydrolase family 19 (GH19), Lysozyme like domain superfamily; 190.fwdarw.347 Cell wall  
binding domain; 382.fwdarw.464 Other information: LysA-Bxb1 Sequence ID No: 4  
MPRVVYGLTHSSNGWPMNLNDECEWTKIPGTSVTLQIAKGQPLAILRAFAADFHAYVEPLRDADSACWTPTNSVP  
SSNHLSGTAMDNLNWNTHPFQVPDAGFDAKKARVKELDFYEGMVFWGNDWSSPKDAMHFQLASLRNNGGTFDITYG  
NPKTADFIARKIRADGYSTFRRGSAPASAAPIAAATGLSEARAAEILPAVRSGLRESECTNVNRIAMWLAQIGH  
ESGSFYQYTEEIAKNGRYAPYIGRTWIQITWDYNYRSFSQWAYAFGMVPTPDYFVVNYRELADLKWAGIGPAWYWT  
VARPDINELSDRRDLNTVTRRINGGTNGLADRQARYNRALAQGDALLQLLHEEDDELSALTDAEQRELLDLARQQ  
AKYKRKRSRPLHWPHEGEVDTIAGLSWSTDANVHIQLVEKLAVIYGDPVSIALLYAVSNSDDPTNNPELAKRILK  
RVKPEDITAAQVQIQKWLAAEQKFHAA Length: 1482 Type: DNA Other information: LysA-D29 Sequence  
ID No: 5

ATGACCTTGATTGTAACGCGGACCATGCGCAATGGGTACACGACATGTGTCTGCGCCGTGCGGGTAATCGTTAT  
GGGTATGGTGGTGCCTTTACCCTGAATCCGCGTGATACGACGGATTGTTTACGATTAGTGTTACAAACCGCCGCG  
TGGTATGGTGGCCGTAAAGATTGGATTGGCAATCGCTATGGATCAACCGAATCCTTTCGCTTAGATCATAAAATT  
GTTTATGATTTAGGATTTTCGCCGTCTGCCACCCGGCGGTGTCGCAGCGCTCGGCTTTACGCCTGTGATGCTGGTG  
GGATTACAACATGGTGGTGGTGGTTCGCTATAGCCATACTGCGTGTACCCTCATGACCATGGATATTCCGGGCGGT  
CCAGTAAAAGTATCACAGCGTGGTGTGATTGGGAAAGCCGTGGTGAGGTGAATGGGGTTGGCGTATTCTTATAT  
GATGGTGGCCGTGCGTGGAATGATCCTCTGTTTCATGATTTCTGGTATTTGGATGCCAAATTGGAAGATGGTCTT  
ACCCAATCCGTGGATGCAGCAGAGATTCTGGCGCGTGCCACCGGACTGGCATATAATCGCGCTGTGCGCTTACTT  
CCTGCGGTCCGCGACGGGTAAATTCAAGCAGATTGTACGAATCCTAACCGTATTGCCATGTGGCTGGCTCAAATT  
GGACACGAATCTGATGACTTTAAAGCAACAGCAGAATATGCGAGTGCGGACGCATATGATACTCGTACAGATTG  
GGGAATACTCCCGAAGTTGATGGTGATGGACGCCTGTATAAAGGACGCAGTTGGATTATGATTACTGGGAAGAT  
AATTATCGCGATTTTAGTCGCTGGGCGCATGGGCGCGGGCTTGTAACCGACACCTGATTATTTTGTCTGTCATCCT  
TTGGAACCTTAGCGAATTACGTTGGGCGGGAATTGGCGCAGCTTGGTATTGGACTGTGGAACGTCCGGATATTAAT  
GCGTTATCGGATCGTCGTGATCTGGAGACTGTGACTCGTCGTATTAATGGCGGTCTGACGAATCTGGACGATCGT  
CGCCGTGCTATAATTTAGCGCTGGCAGTTGGGGATCAGCTGTAAACCCTCATTGGTGACGATGATGAGCTGGCG  
GACCCGACCATCCAACGTTTTATTTCGTGAAATTCATGGTGCCCTCTTTAATACAGTGGTTACACAAAGCCCTTAT  
GGTGATCCCCAAATCCCGATGGTTCAGAACCGCGCTCCAATCTTTGGCAACTGCACGAATTGATTAAGAATGGT  
GATGGAATGGGCCATGCGCGTTATGTGGAAGAGAGTGCACGCGCTGGCGATCTGCGTGAATTAGAACGTGTGGTG  
CGTGCGGCGAAAGGTTTAGGCCGCGACCGTTTCGCCGGAATTTATTGCCCGTGCGCGTAATGTACTTGCACAAATT  
GAAGCCGCGAATCCGGAATATCTGCAAGCCTATATTGCGCGCAACGGCGCGTTATGA Length: 493  
Molecular weight: 54.82 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following domains: Cystine protease;  
20.fwdarw.156 Glycoside hydrolase family 19 (GH19); 398.fwdarw.483 Cell wall binding domain;  
200.fwdarw.365 Other information: LysA-D29 Sequence ID No: 6  
MTLIVTRDHAQWVHDMCRARAGNRYGYGGAFTLNPRDTTDCSGLVLQTAAWYGGRKDWIGNRYGSTESFRLDHKI  
VYDLGFRRLPPGGVAALGFTPVMLVGLQHGGGGRYSHACTLMTMDIPGGPVKVSQRGVDWESRGEVNGVGVFLY  
DGARAWNDFLHDFWYLDKLEDGPTQSVDAAEILARATGLAYNRAVALLPAVRDGLIQADCTNPNRIAMWLAQI  
GHESDDFKATAEYASGDAYDTRTDLGNTPEVDGDGRLYKGRSWIMITGKDNRYRDFSRWAHGRGLVPTPDYFVVHP  
LELSELRWAGIGAAYWTVERPDINALSDRRDLETVTRRINGGLTNLDDRRRRRYNLALAVGDQLLLTIGDDDELA  
DPTIQRFIRESIHGALFNTVVTQSPYGDQPNDGSEPRSNLWQLHELIKNGDGMGHARYVEESARAGDLRELERVV  
RAAKGLGRDRSPEFIARARNVLAQIEAANPEYLQAYIARNAL Length: 1461 Type: DNA Other  
information: LysA-DS6A Sequence ID No: 7

ATGATGCTGTCAGTACGAGTCTTTTCGCCGCTGCTGCTAATTACCTGTCTGTAGACCCGTTATCGCCAGCTTTTC  
CCAGCAGCTGTTGAGTCTATGGTTGCCTGCGGTTGTACTACCGTTAATCGCGCGGCAATGTGGCTTGCACAGGTA  
GGGCACGAGTCCGGGGGCTCTGCGTTGGATGGAGGAGCTGGCCAGCGGAGCCGCTTACGAGTGGCGCTCTGATTTA  
GGCAACACTCAGGCAGGAGATGGGGTCCGCTTTAAAGGTCGTGGGCCTATTCAAATTACGGGACGTTACAACCTAC  
CGTAAGGTGAGCGAATGGGCGCATGCACAAGGCATCGTCCCTACGCCAACCTACTTTGTGGATAATCCTACTCAA  
CTGGCAAGTGATCAATATGGTTTTATCGGGGTCTCGTGGTATTGGCAACATGGGGGGCCACGTCCAGGCCAAATC  
AATGGCTTCGCCGACGCAGGAGATATTTTATCCGGTTCGCGCTGTGTAAATGGGTGGGTAACGACCCCAAATGGC  
ATGCCGGACCGCACCGAGCGTTGGAACCGTTGTCGTGCAATGGGCGACCAAATCCTTCCAGCAGGCGCAGGTACT  
GATAATGGAGGGGATGGTATGGCTTGGACTGGAGATCCGGTGTGGTTAGAAGACGTGTTGCGCCCCGTATTAGGG  
GACCGTCTTCGCGTCCTTCCTTCGTGGCAAATGTACGGTCACGGTGATTTCAAAGATATCCGTGGAGTTATGGTG  
CATCATACTGGGAACGCGCGTGAAACAGCAGAGTCCATTTCGTAAGGGCCGTCCAGATTTGCGTGGCCCCGTTGTCTG  
AACATCCACATCGCGCCCCGATGGAACCGTTACACTTGTGCGCGCAGGTGTTTGTCTGGCACGCCGGTGCCGGGTCA  
TACCCGTGGTTACCTACCAATAATGCCAATTGGCATATGATCGGAATTGAATGCGCATGGCCTACTATTTCGTCCG  
AACGGGACATACGACGAGCGCGAGCCTTGGCCCCGATGCGCAAATTATCGCTATGCGCGATACGTGTGCCGCCTTA  
ACCAAACGTCTGGGCTGGGACGCCTCGCGCGTTATTGGCCACAAGGAATATGCCGGGGCTTCTCAGGGAAAATGG  
GATCCAGGGAATTTGGATATGGGTTGGTTCCGTGGTGAGGTTGCTAAAGCGATGCGCGGCGAGTTCGATCCAAAG  
GCGCCAGCACCAGCACCAACCCACCGGCAGACAATGACAATGGGGGCTTCCTTATGGCGCTTAACGATAAGCAA  
CAACATGATTTATACAATGCGGTTATGACTATCGCAGCAGTCGCTGCCGACATCCAAACACAATTACGCGGTCCC  
GGCCTTCGTGGTTGGCCCCAATTGGGCCGCAATGCGAACGGTGAGGCATTAACCCTGGTGGATGCTGTGGGAGTC  
ATCAAGGCCATTGCGGATCGCGAGGCCGGGCGTTGA Length: 485 Molecular weight: 52.71 kDa Type:

protein Feature: contains the following domains: Lysozyme like domain superfamily; 20.fwdarw.190 N-acetylmuramoyl-L-alanine amidase (Am\_2); 233.fwdarw.380 Peptidoglycan binding domain; 225.fwdarw.396

Other information: LysA-DS6A Sequence ID No: 8  
MLTVESFAAAMGNSLSVDRYRQLFPAAVESMVACGCTTVNRAAMWLAQVGHESGGLRWMEELASGAAYEWRSDLG  
NTQAGDGVRFKGRGPIQITGRYNYRKVSEWAHAQGIVPTPTYFVDNPTQLASDQYGFIVSWYVQHGGPRPGQIN  
GFADAGDILSGSRCVNGWVTTTPNGMPDRTERWNRGRAMGDQILPAGAGTDNGGDMAWTGDPVWLEDVLRPVLGD  
RLRVLPSWQMYGHGDFKDIRGVMVHHTGNARETAESIRKGRPDLRGPLSNIIHAPDGTVTLVAAGVCWHAGAGSY  
PWLPTNNANWHMIGIECAWPTIRPNGTYDEREPWPDAQIIAMRDTCAALTKRLGWDASRVIGHKEYAGASQKWD  
PGNLDMGWFRGEVAKAMRGEFDPKAPAPAPNPPADNDNGGFLMALNDKQQHDLYNAVMTIAAVAADIQTQLRGP  
LRGWPQLGRNANGEALTLVDAVGVIKAIADREAGR Length: 1209 Type: DNA Other information: LysA-

Giles Sequence ID No: 9  
ATGCCTGTCTATGCGATTCACTGCTGGAAGTGTATTTACGCCGGTGCCGCATCGGGATATGGTGGTCCTGACCTT  
GCAGGCTGGCTTGTATTGATTCTGATGATGCCGAGGGTGGCGGCTGTTTAGAGTATGGTCATATTGTCCGTGAG  
GTAAATCGTGGTGATCATGTGACGGCGGGTCAACGTATTGGACATATTAATCCAAATAATCGTACGAATGGTGGA  
GTGGCCCCGCATCTTCATGTAAGTACTGGCCACATGCGTATGGGCAAGGCAGCCGTCAAATGTGATGGCACGC  
TTGAGTGGAGCCCGCGAGCCAGAAGCCCAAGCGGCCCAACCCCAACAGAGCAAGGCACTGTTGTTGGTGACCCG  
GTTTGGTTGGCGGATGTAGTGCGCCCAACTGTAGCTAAATTTGCGGAGTATCCTGGCTGGCGTAATCGTGGTCAC  
GGTGATTTTAAAGGATATCCGTGGAGTTATGGTTCATCATAAGGTGGGCCCGCCTCTGCAGCCTCAATTGCGAAT  
GGCCGCCCAGACCTTGCCGGCCCTCTTGCACAGCTGCATATTTCCGCGTATGGGACAGTTACTGTCTGATGCTGTA  
GGAGTGGCTTGGCATGCGGGTGCAGGCAGCTATCCATGGTTACCGACCAACATGGGTAATTGGCACTTGATTGGT  
ATTGAATGTGAGTGGCCATATGGTGAGCCGGGAATTAATGAGCGTAATGCCTATACAGTACGCTGGCGTGATCCA  
GAGATTATTGCGCTGCGTAATACATGTGCGGCAATTTTACTGCGCCTTGGCCTCGGGGTAGATCGCCTGATTGGC  
CATAAGGATTATGCCGGCCGTGCTCAAGGCAAGTGGGACCCGGGAAATATGAGCATGGACTGGCTGCGTGGCGAG  
GTGCGTAAAGATATGGATGGCTTTGTATTTCCCGGTGAGGATATTGTAAATGTGACCCCGCCACCAGTCCCGGCC  
CCTGTCCCTGCCCCGCCAGCGACTGCGAATGTTCTTCTCCATCGTGGTATGAGTGGACCTAATGTTGTCAAATTA  
CAGACAACCTCTCCGTGCTTGGTATTCAAACTGGCGGTAGACGGTGATTTTGGCCCCCATAAGAGGCATGTGTA  
CGCGATCGCCAACGCATTTATGGGTTGGACGTGGATGGTATTGTCGGACCATTAAGTGGGCCAAATCGGCCTG  
GTTTTGTGA Length: 402 Molecular weight: 43 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following

domains: Peptidase family M23; 2.fwdarw.93 Amidase\_2; N-acetyl-β-D-muramidase; 123.fwdarw.298 Cell wall binding domain; 320.fwdarw.350 Peptidoglycan binding domain; 351.fwdarw.398 Other information:

LysA-Giles Sequence ID No: 10  
MPVYAIQSGTVIYAGAASGYGGPDPAGWLVIDSDDAEGGGCLEYGHIVREVNRGDHVTAGQRIGHINPNNRTNGG  
VAPHLHVTDWPHAYGQGSRQNVMARLSGAREPEAQAAPTPTEQGTVVGDVWLVADVVVRPTVAKFAEYPGWNRNGH  
GDFKDIRGVMVHHTGGPASAASIANGRPDLAQLHISRDGTVTVVAVGVAWHAGAGSYVWLPTNMGNWHLIG  
IECEWPYGEPIGNERNAYTVRWRDPEIIALRNTCAAILRLGLGVDRLLIGHKDYAGRAQGWDPGNMSMDWLRGE  
VRKDMMDGFVFPGEDIVNVTPPPVPAPVPAPPATANVLLHRGMSGPNVVKLQTTLRRWYSKLAVDGDFGPHTACV  
RDRQRIYGLDVDGIVGPLTAAKIGLVL Length: 1155 Type: DNA Other information: LysA-Ms6 Sequence

ID No: 11  
ATGACTACAAAGGACCAGGTAGCGCAGATTACAATTGCAGAGGCAAAAGCCCGTGGGTATACTCGTTCAGAGTGT  
TTAGCCATTATGTCTACGTTTTATCAGGAAAGCGGTTGGAATGATACTATTTGGGATCCTACGCATACAACGTAT  
GGAATCGCGCAACAAGATGGTAGTTATCCCCATCGTTTTGATGGCGCGGCCGCGCAGATTAAGGGTTTCTTTGAT



AAACTGGGATGTTTGGCGTGCAAAGCCGGGCGCATCGACAGACATTTGGCTTAAATTTTGGTGGTGAACAAAGCG  
CCGAATTGGCCGTCGGCCGATTATTGGTATGCGAATGGTCGTCGTGCTTATCTGACAGAGATTAAAAGTCGTATT  
GCGACGGTTACGCCGTATCTGGATAAATATTGGCCTGCTGACGGCGGCACGGCGGTTCCAGATGAGCCTCGTCCG  
GACTTTAATGAGTTCCCAATTTGGTCAAATAATAATTCGGCGCGTTTCAGGTAAACCGACTATGTTTCTGATTTCAT  
ACGCAGGAAGGCGGTGGTGGTATGCCGCAGCTGAAAATTTGGCCAAATGGTTTCAAATGGTAATGGAGTGTCC  
TATCATTATACCATTAGCCAGGCAAGCGACGGCGGCGTAACCGTAGTGGACTGTGTAGATACGGATCGTGCGGCG  
TGGAGCGTCGGAAATGCTAATAGTATTAGTATTAATTTGTGTTTTGCTGGATCACGCGCGAGCTGGATGCGCGAC  
CAATGGATGAAACAATCGAATGCTATTGATGTTGCCGCGTATCTGGCTGTTCAAGATGCCAAGAAATATGGTTTT  
ACGCCCTTGGTTCGTACCGCCGCCGTACACCAACGGCCGTCCGGGGATTAGCGATCATCGCTGGGTACTGATGTA  
TTTAAATGGGGTACCCATACGGATGTTGGTGATTGGTTTCCTTGGGATTATTTTTCGGGAGCGCGTTAATCATTGG  
GCAAATGGCGGTAAAACGGAACCGGAGCCACCTAAAGTTAAGCGTTTTTCCTGATGATTGGAGCGATCGTGAGATT  
CTGGTTGAAATTCTTCGCCAGTTACGTGGGTATAATTTGACCGGGTGGCCACAATTGGGTGGCAAGACACTGGTA  
GATGCTGTGGCGGAGTTGCTGGGACATTGA Length: 384 Molecular weight: 43 kDa Type: protein  
Feature: contains the following domains: Hydrolase; 5.fwdarw.154 Amidase\_2; N-acetyl- $\beta$ -D-muramidase;  
175.fwdarw.299 Cell wall binding domain; 313.fwdarw.376 Other information: LysA-Ms6 Sequence ID  
No: 12

MTTKDQVAQITIAEAKARGYTRSECLAIMSTFYQESGWNNDTIWDPHTHTTYGIAQQDGSYPHRFDGAAAQIKGFFD  
KLDVWRAKPGASTDIWLNICWMQAPNWPASDYWYANGRRAYLTEIKSRIATVTPYLDKYWPADGGTAVPDEPRP  
DENEFPWSNNNSARSGKPTMFLIHTQEGGGGDAAENLAKWFQNGNGVSYHYTISQASDGGVTVVDCVDTDRAA  
WSVGNANSISINLCFAGSRASWMRDQWMKQSNADVAAYLAVQDAKKYGFTPLVPPPYTNGRPGISDHRWVTDV  
FKWGTHTDVGDFWPDYFAERVNHWANGGKTEPEPPKVKRFPDDWSDREILVEILRQLRGYNLTGWPQLGGKTLV  
DAVAELLGH Length: 1644 Type: DNA Other information: LysA-TM4 Sequence ID No: 13  
ATGTCATTTACGCGCTTTCTCCAAGACGATCCCTTGCTGACTCGTGAACAGGTAATGGCAGAACTCATCCGCGTT  
GCTGATGAATTGAATATGCCTGATAAACGTGGAGCATGTGTGATCGCAGGAATGACTATCTCACAGGAAGTTGGT  
GTGAAAGATAATGATCCCCATTTGAACGCCGTTTCTGGTGTCCAGCAAATCGTGCGGATCCAGAGTCTTTTAAAT  
TATCCACATGATAGTGAGTCCAATGATGGACGTTTCAGTGGGGTATTTTCAACAACAAAAGGGCCCCAAATGGTGAA  
CTTTGGTGGGGCACTACCGCGAGTGAAATGAATTTACATAGTGCAGCCACCCAATTCATGACTCGTTTAAAAGCC  
GCGGGTTATAATGCCTCTAATGCGCAAGCCGCAAATGATTCTGCTCAAGCTATTCAACGTTTCAGGTGTTCCACAA  
GCCTATAAACAGTGGTGGGATGATATCAATCGTTTATATGATAAAGTAAAAGGTAGCGGCGGCGGACCCGACCG  
GCTCCCAAACCACTCAAAGCGGTCTTGGACTGGTATCCTGTTTGGTTAGCAGATGTATTACGTGCAGAAGGC  
TTGAATGTTGTTGAACTCCCTGGTTGGTTAGATCGTGGTCATGGAGATATGGGTCGTCTGTGGGGCGTCGTATGT  
CACCATACTGGTAGTGACAATACTCCAAGCTCTGAAATCGCATTCCATCCCAGCCTGGGTCTTTGTTCCCAAATC  
CATCTTGCCCGTAATGGTACGGTTACACTTTGTGGCGTTGGTATTGCGTGGCACGCAGGAGTGGGATCGTACCCG  
GGGTTGCCGGAAGATAATGCAAATGCCGTGACAATTGGTATTGAAGCACAAAATTCGGGTACATACGATGGTGCT  
CCTCATCGCACCAACTGGCCGGATGCACAGTATGATGCGTACGTCAAATGTTGTGCGGCTATTTGTCTGCTCTG  
GGAGTCCGTGCAGACCATGTAATTTTCGCATAAAGAGTGGGCGGGCCGTAAACAGGGTAAGTGGGACCCGGGAGCG  
ATTGATATGAATATTTTCCGTGCGGATGTTCAACGTCGTATTGATGCGCACCAAGCCGAATGGTGAAGATGACTTT  
ATGGCGGCTCTGAGCGCGGATGAACAACGTGAAGTTTTGAATCTTTTTCGTGTTTTAGCGGATCGCCGCTTTGTG  
AGTCGTTACCTTTTCGTCTATCTCGGTGAAGGTCCATCCGAGACGGTAGCGGGCTTTGGTTTAAATACGGATGGA  
CTGAACCATGCTCAATATACCATCGAACTCGCACGTCTCGGGGATCCTACCCATTTAGCGTTACTCCGTGAAGTA  
GCTAGTGCAGGAAGGGGATTCTCGTTACCCGGATCGCCAATATGATGCGAAATTGGCGAAACGTGTCTTGGCTGAG  
ATTGAAGGTGCGGCGACCGCGCCTGCGAAACCTTCTACTCCTTCAGCGCCAACGGAACCAGCACCGGAAGCACCT  
ACTCCACCGGTGAAAGCGGCTTGTGCACTCAGCGCCGCGGGCTGTGTAGTAGCGGGGAGCACTTCAGGTGGTGGT  
TGTGCGTTATCGACAGATGGTACGGGGAAATGTGTGGTCACTGCGGCCACTGATGGTGGCGCGGCATGA  
Length: 547 Molecular weight: 58.58 kDa Feature: contains the following domains: M23B Peptidase;  
67.fwdarw.165 Amidase\_2; N-acetyl- $\beta$ -D-muramidase; 187.fwdarw.357 Cell wall binding domain;  
401.fwdarw.484 Other information: LysA-TM4 Sequence ID No: 14

MSFTRFLQDDPLLTREQVMAELIRVADELNMPDKRGACVIAGMTISQEVGVKDNDPPFERRFWCPANRADPESEN  
YPHDSSENDGRSVGYFQQQKGPNGELWWGTTASEMNLHSAATQFMTRLKAAGYNASNAQAANDSAQAIQRSGVPQ  
AYKQWWDDINRLYDKVKGSGGGPAPAPKPPQSGPWTGDPVWLADVLRAEGLNVVELPGWLDGRHGDMDGRLWGVV  
HHTGSDNTPSSEIAFHPSLGLCSQIHLARNGTVTLCGVGIAWHAGVGSYPGLPEDNANAVTIGIEAQNSGYDGA  
PHRTNWPDAQYDAYVKCCAAICRRLGVRADHVISHKEWAGRKQKWDPGAIDMNIFRADVQRRIDAHQPNGEDDF  
MAALSADEQREVLNLLRVLADRRFVSRSPFRHLGEGPSETVAGFGLNTDGLNHAQYTIELARLGDPTHALLREV  
ASAEGDSRYPDQYDAKLAKRVLAEIEGAATAPAKPSTPSAPTEPAPEAPTTPVKAACALSAAGCVVAGSTSGGG  
CALSTDGTGKCVVTAATDGGAA Length: 460 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EDA1 (SEQ ID NO: 313)  
TATTGTACCACAAGAAACGGGTTGGTGGTGCGGTCCGGCAGCGACGCAAGTTGTTCTGAATAGTCGTGGAATTAT  
TGTACCGGAAGCGACCCTGGCAAATGAAATTGAACAAATTGAAAATCCAGGTGCGGGTGACGATCGTGATGGAAC  
GGATTATGTGGGGCTTATTGAACAAGTGCTTGATCGCCGTGTGCCCCAAGCGAAATATACGAGCGTGTATATGCC  
TAATGATCCGCCCACCGCAGCCCAACGCGAAGCTTTATGGCAAATATTGTGCGCTCCATTAATGCGGGCTGGGG  
TGTCATTATGAATTGGGTGGCGCCGCCATCCAATAAACCACGCGGAGTCAAAGGTAGCCCCAATCCTAAATATTC  
AGGTGGTACAACCTTATCATTATGTGGCCTGTATGGGTTATGATGATACTCCGGGCGCCCGCGCCTTGTGGATTGC

GGATTCTGGG Length: 153 Molecular weight: 16.7 kDa Type: protein Feature: Peptidase\_C39\_2  
Sequence ID No: EADA1 (SEQ ID NO: 326)  
IVPQETGWWC GPAATQVVLNSRGIIVPEATLANEIEQIENPGRGDDRDGTDYVGLIEQVLD RRRVPEAKYTSVYMP  
NDPPTAAQREALWQNIVRSINAGWGVIMNWVAPPSNKP RGVKGSNP KYSGGTTYHYVACMGYDDTPGARALWIA  
DSG Length: 537 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA2 (SEQ ID NO: 314)  
GAAATCTTACCCACCTTTCGTGATGGTTT GCGCTTAGCTGAATGTAATAATGTTCCGCGCATTGCAATGTTTATT  
GCACAAACAGGCCACGAAAGCGATAATTTTAATGCCACTCAAGAATATGATCATGGCCGTAATTATGGCGATCCA  
AATGAAGCAACCGATCGTTG GAAATATAAAGGGCGTACGTGGATCCAAATTACATGGCGTG GTAATTATGAGCGT  
TTCTCACGTTGGTGTTTTGATCGTAAATTGGTGCTACCCCAACATATTTTG TAGATAATCCACGCGCACTCGCG  
GATGTTCTGGTGGG CAGGAATTGGCGCGGCGTG GTATTGGACGGTAGAACGTCCTTCCATTAATCGCCTGTGTGAT  
GAGCGTAATTTAACGGAAGTTACTCGTCTGATTAATGGTGGCACATCGTGGGAAGCCCCAACCTGGATGAAACAT  
CGTAAAGAACGTTATGATCGTGCGTTAGCTGTGGGTAATGATCTTTTAAAGCTGTTAGATGGCGAAGAAGAAGGG  
TTTCTGTCGGCG Length: 178 Molecular weight: 21 kDa Type: protein Feature: Lysozyme like domain  
Sequence ID No: EADA2 (SEQ ID NO: 327)  
EILPTFRDGLRLAECNNVPRIAMFIAQTGHESDNFNATQEYDHGRNYGDPNEATDRWKYKGRTWIQITWRGN YER  
FSRWC FDRKLVPTPTYFVDNPRALADVRWAGIGAAWYWTVERPSINRLCDERNL TEVTRLINGGTSWEAPTWMKH  
RKERYDRALAVGNDLLKLLDGEEGELSA Length: 189 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA3 (SEQ ID  
NO: 315)  
AGCTCGAATCATTTGTCTGGA ACTGCAATGGATCTTAATTGGAATACACATCCTTTTCAAGTTCCCGATGCGGGT  
TTTGATGCTGCCAAGAAGGCTCGTGTA AAGGAAGCTGTTGGATTCTATGAAGGAATGGTCTTTTGGGGTAATGAT  
TGGAGCTCACCGAAAGACGCAATGCATTTTCAACTGGCT Length: 63 Molecular weight: 7.12 kDa  
Type: protein Feature: Peptidase\_M15\_4 Sequence ID No: EADA3 (SEQ ID NO: 328)  
SSNHLSGTAMD LNWNTHPFQVPDAGFDA AKKARVKELLD FYEGMVFWGNDWSSPKDAMHFQLA Length:  
423 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA4 (SEQ ID NO: 316)  
AGCGGTCTGCGTGAGAGTGAATGTACTAATGTGAATCGTATTGCCATGTGGTTGGCGCAAATTGGCCACGAGAGC  
GGAAGTTTTCAATATACAGAAGAAATTGCGAAGAATGGTCGCTATGCACCATATATTGGTCGCACCTGGATCCAA  
ATTACTTGGGATTATAATTATCGTTCTTTTAGCCAATGGGCCTATGCCTTTGGTATGGTCCCTACACCAGATTAT  
TTTGTGTGA AATTATCGTGA ACTGGCGGACTTAAAATGGGCGGGAATTGGTCCGGCGTG GTATTGGACTGTTGCG  
CGTCCCGATATTAATGAATTAAGTGATCGTCGTGATTTGAATACCGTA ACTCGTCGCATTAATGGTGGTACGAAT  
GGTCTGGCTGACCGCCAGGCGCGTTATAATCGTGCATTGGCTCAAGGT Length: 141 Molecular weight:  
16.3 kDa Type: protein Feature: Lysozyme like domain Sequence ID No: EADA4 (SEQ ID NO:  
329)  
SGLRESECTNVNRIAMWLAQIGHESGSFYQYTEEIAKNGRYAPYIGRTWIQITWDYNYRSFSQWAYAFGMVPTPDY  
FVVNYRELADLKWAGIGPAWYWTVARPDINELSDRRDLNTVTRRINGGTNGLADRQARYNRALAQG Length:  
507 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA5 (SEQ ID NO: 317)  
GCCGCGCCAATTTTGGCAGCAGCGACGGGTCTTTCGGAAGCGCGTGCCGCAGAAATTTTACCAGCAGTGCGTAGC  
GGTCTGCGTGAGAGTGAATGTACTAATGTGAATCGTATTGCCATGTGGTTGGCGCAAATTGGCCACGAGAGCGGA  
AGTTTTCAATATACAGAAGAAATTGCGAAGAATGGTCGCTATGCACCATATATTGGTCGCACCTGGATCCAAATT  
ACTTGGGATTATAATTATCGTTCTTTTAGCCAATGGGCCTATGCCTTTGGTATGGTCCCTACACCAGATTATTTT  
GTTGTAAATTATCGTGA ACTGGCGGACTTAAAATGGGCGGGAATTGGTCCGGCGTG GTATTGGACTGTTGCGCGT  
CCCGATATTAATGAATTAAGTGATCGTCGTGATTTGAATACCGTA ACTCGTCGCATTAATGGTGGTACGAATGGT  
CTGGCTGACCGCCAGGCGCGTTATAATCGTGCATTGGCTCAAGGTGACGCCCTCTTG Length: 168  
Molecular weight: 19 kDa Type: protein Feature: Chitinase, GH19 family Sequence ID No: EADA5  
(SEQ ID NO: 330)  
AAPILAAATGLSEARAAEILPAVRSGLRESECTNVNRIAMWLAQIGHESGSFYQYTEEIAKNGRYAPYIGRTWIQI  
TWDYNYRSFSQWAYAFGMVPTPDYFVVNYRELADLKWAGIGPAWYWTVARPDINELSDRRDLNTVTRRINGGTNG  
LADRQARYNRALAQGDAL Length: 525 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA6 (SEQ ID NO: 318)  
ACCTTGATTGTAACGCGCGACCATGCGCAATGGGTACACGACATGTGTCGTGCCCGTGCGGGTAATCGTTATGGG  
TATGGTGGTGCC TTTACCCTGAATCCGCGTGATACGACG GATTGTT CAGGATTAGTGTTACAAACCGCCGCGTG  
TATGGTGGCCGTAAAGATTGGATTGGCAATCGCTATGGATCAACCGAATCCTTTTCGCTTAGATCATAAAATTGTT  
TATGATTTAGGATTTGCGCGTCTGCCACCCGGCGGTGTCGCAGCGCTCGGCTTTACGCCTGTGATGCTGGTGGGA  
TTACAACATGGTGGTGGTGGTCGCTATAGCCATACTGCGTGTACCCTCATGACCATGGATATTCCGGGCGGTCCA  
GTAAAAGTATCACAGCGTGGTGTTGATTGGGAAAGCCGTGGTGAGGTGAATGGGGTTGGCGTATTCTTATATGAT  
GGTGCCCGTGCGTGGAATGATCCTCTGTTTCATGATTTCTGGTATTTGGATGCCAAATTGGAAGATGGTCCTACC  
Length: 175 Molecular weight: 19.32 kDa Type: protein Feature: Cysteine protease Sequence ID No:  
EADA6 (SEQ ID NO: 331)  
TLIVTRDHAQWVHDMCRARAGNRYGYGGAFTLNPRD TDCSGLVLQTA AWYGGRKDWIGNRYGSTESFRLD HKIV  
YDLGFRRLLPPGGVAALGFTPVMLVGLQHGGGGRYSH TACTLMTMDIPGGPVKVSQRGVDWESRGEVNGVGVFLYD  
GARAWN DPLFHDFWYLD AKLEDGPT Length: 555 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA7 (SEQ ID NO:  
319)  
CAATCCGTGGATGCAGCAGAGATTCTGGCGCGTGCCACCGGACTGGCATATAATCGCGCTGTGCGCTTACTTCCT

CGGTCGCGACGGGTTAATTCAAGCAGATTGTACGAATCCTAACCGTATTGCCATGTGGCTGGCTCAAATTGGA  
CACGAATCTGATGACTTTAAAGCAACAGCAGAATATGCGAGTGGCGACGCATATGATACTCGTACAGATTTGGGG  
AATACTCCCGAAGTTGATGGTGATGGACGCCTGTATAAAGGACGCAGTTGGATTATGATTACTGGGAAAGATAAT  
TATCGCGATTTTAGTCGCTGGGCGCATGGGCGCGGGCTTGTACCGACACCTGATTATTTTGTCTGTCATCCTTTG  
GAACTTAGCGAATTACGTTGGGCGGGAATTGGCGCAGCTTGGTATTGGACTGTGGAACGTCCGGATATTAATGCG  
TTATCGGATCGTCGTGATCTGGAGACTGTGACTCGTCGTATTAATGGCGGTCTGACGAATCTGGACGATCGTCGC  
CGTCGCTATAATTTAGCGCTGGCAGTTGGG Length: 185 Molecular weight: 20.7 kDa Type: protein  
Feature: Glyco\_hydro\_19 Sequence ID No: EADA7 (SEQ ID NO: 332)  
QSVDAAEILARATGLAYNRAVALLPAVRDGLIQADCTNPNRIAMWLAQIGHESDDFKATAEYASGDAYDTRTDLG  
NTPEVDGDGRLYKGRSWIMITGKDNRYRDFSRAHGRGLVPTPDYFVVHPLELSELRWAGIGAAWYWTVERPDINA  
LSDRRDLETVTRRINGGLTNLDDRRRRYNLALAVG Length: 582 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA8  
(SEQ ID NO: 320)  
TTAACTGTAGAGAGCTTCGCTGCTGCTATGGGTAACAGCTTGTTCAGTTGACCGTTACCGCCAACTGTTTCCAGCG  
GCGGTTGAGTCAATGGTGGCTTGTGGATGCACCACCGTGAATCGCGCGGCGATGTGGCTGGCACAGGTCGGCCAT  
GAGTCTGGGGGTTTTCGCTGGATGGAGGAGTTAGCGTCAGGAGCCGCATATGAGTGGCGCTCGGACCTTGGAAC  
ACGCAGGCGGGAGACGGCGTACGCTTTAAAGGCCGCGGACCCATCCAAATCACGGGGCGTTATAATTATCGTAAA  
GTGAGTGAGTGGGCTCATGCGCAGGGCATTGTGCCTACGCCGACATACTTCGTGGATAACCCAACTCAATTGGCA  
TCGGATCAATACGGCTTCATCGGTGTTTCATGGTACTGGCAGCACGGCGGGGCCACGTCCAGGCCAAATTAACGGC  
TTCGCAGACGCAGGGGACATCCTGTCTGGGATCGCGCTGCGTGAACGGATGGGTGACAACGCCAAACGGGATGCCC  
GACCGTACTGAACGTTGGAATCGTTGTCTCGCTATGGGAGATCAAATCCTTCCGGCA Length: 194  
Molecular weight: 21.51 kDa Type: protein Feature: Glyco\_hydro\_19 Sequence ID No: EADA8  
(SEQ ID NO: 333)  
LTVESFAAAMGNSLSVDYRQLFPAAVESMVACGCTTVNRAAMWLAQVGHESGGLRWMEELASGAAYEWRSDLGN  
TQAGDGVRFKGRGPIQITGRYNYRKVSEWAHAQGIVPTPTYFVDNPTQLASDQYGFIVSWYWQHGGPRPGQING  
FADAGDILSGSRCVNGWVTPNGMPDRTERWNRGRAMGDQILPA Length: 525 Type: DNA Sequence ID:  
EADA9 (SEQ ID NO: 321)  
GATCGTCTTCGTGTGCTTCCCTCCTGGCAGATGTACGGTCATGGCGATTTTAAAGATATCCGCGGCGTTATGGTC  
CACCATACTGGTAACGCTCGCGAAACTGCCGAGTCTATCCGTAAAGGACGCCCTGATTTACGTGGTCCGCTGTCC  
AATATTCACATCGCACCGGATGGCACGGTGACATTAGTCGCCGCCGGAGTCTGTTGGCATGCAGGAGCCGGGTGC  
TACCCATGGTTACCAACTAATAACGCCAACTGGCACATGATCGGTATTGAATGCGCTTGGCCTACAATCCGTCCA  
AACGGAACGTATGATGAACGCGAGCCATGGCCTGATGCTCAAATCATCGCTATGCGTGACACCTGCGCTGCACTT  
ACCAAACGTCTGGGATGGGACGCATCTCGCGTGATCGGTCATAAAGAGTACGCTGGCGCTTCGCAAGGTAAATGG  
GACCCCGGCAACTTGGATATGGGATGGTTTCGTGGAGAGGTAGCTAAGGCAATGCGTGGTGAATTTGACCCTAAA  
Length: 175 Molecular weight: 19.5 kDa Type: protein Feature: Amid2B Sequence ID No: EADA9  
(SEQ ID NO: 334)  
DRLRVLPWQMYGHGDFKDIRGVMVHHTGNARETAESIRKGRPDLRGPLSNIHIAPDGTVTLVAAAGVCWHAGAGS  
YPWLPTNNANWHMIGIECAWPTIRPNGTYDEREPWPDAQIIAMRDTCAALTKRLGWDASRVIGHKEYAGASQGW  
DPGNLDMGWFRGEVAKAMRGEFDPK Length: 279 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA10 (SEQ ID  
NO: 322)  
CCTGTCTATGCGATTCAGTCTGGAACCTGTTATTTACGCCGGTGGCGCATCGGGATATGGTGGTCCTGACCCTGCA  
GGCTGGCTTGTATTATTGATTCTGATGATGCCGAGGGTGGCGGCTGTTTAGAGTATGGTCATATTGTCCGTGAGGTA  
AATCGTGGTGATCATGTGACGGCGGGTCAACGTATTGGACATATTAATCCAAATAATCGTACGAATGGTGGAGTG  
GCCCCGCATCTTCATGTAAGTACTGGCCACATGCGTATGGGCAAGGCAGCCGT Length: 93 Molecular  
weight: 9.72 kDa Type: protein Feature: Peptidase M23 Sequence ID No: EADA10 (SEQ ID NO:  
335)  
PVYAIQSGTVIYAGAASGYGGPDAGWLVIDSDDAEGGGCLEYGHIVREVNRGDHVTAGQRIGHINPNNRNTNGGV  
APHLHVTDWPHAYGQGSRL Length: 447 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA11 (SEQ ID NO: 323)  
TATCCTGGCTGGCGTAATCGTGGTCACGGTGATTTTAAAGATATCCGTGGAGTTATGGTTCATCATAACAGGTGGG  
CCCGCCTCTGCAGCCTCAATTGCGAATGGCCGCCAGACCTTGCCGGCCCTCTTGCACAGCTGCATATTTCCGCT  
GATGGGACAGTTACTGTCGTAGCTGTAGGAGTGGCTTGGCATGCGGGTGCAGGCAGCTATCCATGGTTACCGACC  
AACATGGGTAATTGGCACTTGATTGGTATTGAATGTGAGTGGCCATATGGTGAGCCGGGAATTAATGAGCGTAAT  
GCCTATACAGTACGCTGGCGTGATCCAGAGATTATTGCGCTGCGTAATACATGTGCGGCAATTTTACTGCGCCTT  
GGCCTCGGGGTAGATCGCCTGATTGGCCATAAGGATTATGCCGGCCGTGCTCAAGGCAAGTGGGACCCGGGA  
Length: 149 Molecular weight: 16.18 kDa Type: protein Feature: Amidase 2 Sequence ID No:  
EADA11 (SEQ ID NO: 336)  
YPGWRNRHGHGDFKDIRGVMVHHTGGPASAASIANGRPDLAQLHISRDGTVTTVAVGVAVWHAGAGSYPWLPT  
NMGNWHLIGIECEWPYGEPIGINERNAYTVRWRDPEIIALRNTCAAILRLGLGVDRLLIGHKDYAGRAQGWDPG  
Length: 297 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA12 (SEQ ID NO: 324)  
GCAAATCGTGCGGATCCAGAGTCTTTTAAATTATCCACATGATAGTGAGTCCAATGATGGACGTTTCACTGGGGTAT  
TTTCAACAACAAAAGGGCCCAAATGGTGAACCTTTGGTGGGGCACTACCGCGAGTGAAATGAATTTACATAGTGCA  
GCCACCCAATTCATGACTCGTTTAAAGCCGCGGGTTATAATGCCTCTAATGCGCAAGCCGCAATGATTCTGCT

CAAGCTATTCAACGTTTCAGGTGTTCCACAAGCTATAAACAGTGGTGATGATCAATCGTTTATATGAT

Length: 99 Molecular weight: 11.07 kDa Type: protein Feature: M23B peptidase Sequence ID No:

EADA12 (SEQ ID NO: 337)

ANRADPESFNYPHDSNDGRSVGYFQQKGPNGLWWGTTASEMNLHSAATQFMTRLKAAGYNASNAQAANDSA

QAIQRSGVPQAYKQWWDDINRLYD Length: 384 Type: DNA Sequence ID: EADA13 (SEQ ID NO:

325)

TGGGGCGTCGTATGTCACCATACTGGTAGTGACAATACTCCAAGCTCTGAAATCGCATTCCATCCCAGCCTGGGT  
CTTTGTTCCCAAATCCATCTTGCCCGTAATGGTACGGTTACACTTTGTGGCGTTGGTATTGCGTGGCACGCAGGA  
GTGGGATCGTACCCGGGGTTGCCGGAAGATAATGCAAATGCCGTGACAATTGGTATTGAAGCACAAAATTCGGGT  
ACATACGATGGTGCTCCTCATCGCACCAACTGGCCGGATGCACAGTATGATGCGTACGTCAAATGTTGTGCGGCT  
ATTTGTCGTCTGTCTGGGAGTCCGTGCAGACCATGTAATTTTCGCATAAAGAGTGGGCGGGCCGTAAACAGGGTAAG

TGGGACCCG Length: 128 Molecular weight: 13.72 kDa Type: protein Feature: M23B peptidase

Sequence ID No: EADA13 (SEQ ID NO: 338)

WGVVCHHTGSDNTPSSEIAFHPSLGLCSQIHLARNGTVTLGCVGIAWHAGVGSYPGLPEDNANAVTIGIEAQNSG

TYDGAPHRTNWPDAQYDAYVKCCAAICRRLGVRADHVISHKEWAGRKQGWDP

[0058] A domain (e.g. a second domain) with activity specific to an ester linkage may be specific to the ester linkage between mycolic acid and arabinogalactan. By “activity specific to an ester linkage” we include the meaning that the domain is capable of binding or associating with an ester linkage, and/or that the domain enacts a change (for example, the breakdown of the target entity) on an ester linkage. For example, the domain may be capable of cleaving ester linkages/ester bonds in the cell wall. For example, the second domain may target an ester link between any one of more of the following components: trehalose, mycolates, arabinogalactan, peptidoglycan, muramic acid; optionally wherein the components are in the following pairs: arabinogalactan and mycolates; trehalose and mycolates; arabinogalactan and peptidoglycan linkages; and/or arabinogalactan and muramic acid.

[0059] The domain with activity specific to an ester linkage may be an enzyme or a domain derived from an enzyme which retains the functional activity of the enzyme, e.g. an enzyme active domain (EAD). Thus, in one embodiment, the second domain exerts enzyme activity on an ester linkage. In one embodiment the domain is an enzyme with lipolytic activity.

[0060] In one embodiment the domain is selected from any member of the alpha/beta hydrolase family, or a domain derived from a member of the alpha/beta hydrolase family. Such a domain may be a mycolyl arabinogalactan esterase, for example a LysB and/or at least one EAD thereof. For example, such a domain may be a mycolyl-arabinogalactan-peptidoglycan (mAGP) hydrolase. Such a domain may act specifically on particular components of the aforementioned targets. For example, the domain may target the ester linkage of mycolic acids. In a further example, the domain may have one or more of the following enzyme activities: alpha/beta hydrolase, esterase, lipase, cutinase, trehalose dimycolate hydrolase (TDMH), Pectinesterase, CheB methylesterase, Glycerophosphoryl diester phosphodiesterase, Plant invertase/pectin methylesterase inhibitor, Carboxylesterase family, Calcineurin-like phosphoesterase, Putative esterase, Thioesterase domain, Hemagglutinin esterase, Calcineurin-like phosphoesterase superfamily domain, Pectinacylesterase, Putative serine esterase, Esterase PHB depolymerase, Esterase-like activity of phytase, Chitin recognition protein, Glycosyl hydrolase all families, Amidase, Lipase all families, GDSL-like Lipase/Acylhydrolase, Partial alpha/beta-hydrolase lipase region, GDSL-like Lipase/Acylhydrolase family, Secretory lipase, Patatin-like phospholipase, Carboxylesterase, Variant-surface-glycoprotein phospholipases all families, Putative lysophospholipase, Alpha/beta-hydrolase superfamily, Hydrolase, haloacid dehalogenase-like hydrolase, epoxide hydrolase and dehalogenases, peroxidase, or combinations thereof.

[0061] In one embodiment the domain is a mycolylarabinogalactan esterase, such as LysB. Thus, in one embodiment the domain is LysB and/or at least one enzyme active domain (EAD) thereof.

[0062] The targeting of the ester linkage (also termed “ester bond”, both of which are interchangeable herein) refers to an ester link or bond between two entities. For example, the ester link may be between a mycolic acid (MA) that is bonded (i.e. via an ester bond) to the terminal pentaarabinofuranosyl units of arabinogalactan (AG). Accordingly, in some embodiments, the domain targeting (or having specificity/affinity for) an ester link may be a domain that targets and/or disrupts the binding of MA to the terminal pentaarabinofuranosyl units of AG. This may be achieved by at least one Lysin B, for example at least one LysB. LysB are made up of enzyme active domains (EAD) that may have mechanisms of actions corresponding to (i.e. specific activity resembling): alpha/beta hydrolase activity, esterase activity, lipase activity, protease activity, TDMH, cutinase activity, trehalose dimycolate hydrolase (TDMH), Pectinesterase, CheB methylesterase, Glycerophosphoryl diester phosphodiesterase, Plant invertase/pectin methylesterase inhibitor, Carboxylesterase family, Calcineurin-like phosphoesterase, Putative esterase, Thioesterase domain, Hemagglutinin esterase, Calcineurin-like phosphoesterase superfamily domain, Pectinacylesterase, Putative serine esterase, Esterase PHB depolymerase, Esterase-like activity of phytase, Chitin recognition protein, Glycosyl hydrolase all families, Amidase, Lipase all families, GDSL-like Lipase/Acylhydrolase, Partial alpha/beta-hydrolase lipase region, GDSL-like Lipase/Acylhydrolase family, Secretory lipase, Patatin-like phospholipase, Carboxylesterase, Variant-surface-glycoprotein phospholipases all families, Putative lysophospholipase, Alpha/beta-hydrolase superfamily, Hydrolase, haloacid dehalogenase-like hydrolase, epoxide hydrolase and dehalogenases, peroxidase, or any combinations thereof. Accordingly, in one embodiment, the targeting of the ester linkage is with LysB.

[0063] Each of the above activities may arise from a single EAD that is derived from a LysB. However, each LysB may comprise different EADs. For example, a LysB may comprise EADs with at least alpha/beta hydrolase activity, esterase activity, lipase activity, protease activity, TDMH, and/or cutinase activity; or a LysB may comprise only EAD with alpha/beta hydrolase activity, esterase activity, lipase activity, protease activity, TDMH, and/or cutinase.

[0064] Alternatively, or additionally, the targeting of the ester linkage may be achieved using at least one EAD derived from a LysB. EAD derived from LysB may be fused with any other domain component contemplated herein. EAD derived from LysB may be fused to further LysB and/or EAD derived from LysB. For example, a first EAD derived from LysB with lipase activity (and/or any previously specified activity) may be fused to a second EAD derived from LysB with cutinase activity (and/or any previously specified activity). Fusions may comprise 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 or more EADs derived from LysB. "Derived from LysB" is to be construed as encompassing EADs derived from the same LysB or from different LysB. For example, a first EAD (with any of the above listed activities) derived from a first LysB may be fused with a second EAD (with any of the above listed activities, whether the same or different compared with the first EAD) derived from the first and/or a second LysB.

[0065] The domain with activity specific to an ester linkage may further comprise at least one cell wall binding domain (CBD). The CBD may be specific for the target cells of interest. For example, the CBD may confer specificity of a peptide to at least one mycobacteria. Alternatively, or additionally, the CBD may be classified as one that does not have specificity for Gram-negative bacteria and/or Gram-positive bacteria. For example, the CBD of a peptide described herein may be specific for mycobacteria only and not specific for Gram-negative bacteria. Multiple CBD may be present, for example as tandem repeats, and/or as multiple copies at different positions within a peptide. The presence of multiple CBD may refer to multiple copies of the same CBD and/or different CBD. For example, a peptide may comprise multiple copies of a first CBD and only one copy of a second (or further) CBD; or comprise multiple copies of a first CBD and multiple copies of a second (and/or further) CBD. In one embodiment, the CBD of this domain may be LysB Saal.

[0066] The wildtype forms of lytic enzymes of interest for the present invention (e.g. LysA and LysB) comprise more than one catalytic domain (i.e. EAD) representing the different classes of peptidoglycan hydrolases and esterases (or in general alpha/beta hydrolases). Accordingly, LysA and/or LysB may refer to enzymes that have a single type of activity (whether comprised of one domain with this activity or multiple domains with the same activity) or with multiple types of activity (as discussed in Payne et al., 2012, PLOS One, 7 (3), e34052). Types of activity may also be referred to as mechanisms of action. Although wildtype LysA is composed of 1-3 EAD and 1-3 cell binding domains (CBD), the activity required of the first domain can be achieved with one or more of EAD and/or CBD.

[0067] The LysA (and/or EAD derived therefrom) and LysB (and/or EAD derived therefrom) may derive from the same organism or different organisms. For example, at least one LysA may be derived from the same source (e.g. the same mycobacteriophage) as the LysB (or EAD derived from either). Alternatively, at least one LysA (or EAD therefrom) may be derived from a different source (e.g. different mycobacteriophages, phages, bacteria, human, animal, and/or plant sources) as the LysB (or EAD therefrom). Where multiple LysA and/or LysB are present in a fusion peptide, some may derive from the same organism, while others derive from different organisms. For example, in a fusion peptide comprising 2 LysA and 2 LysB, a first LysA may be derived from the same organism as a first LysB, while a second LysA is derived from a different organism to a second LysB (either of which may derive from the same or different organism as the first LysA and LysB).

[0068] An EAD derived from a lysin would be considered "a portion thereof" with respect to that lysin. For example, an EAD (or multiple EAD) from a specific LysA would be considered a portion thereof said LysA. Thus, use of a LysA and/or LysB throughout is intended to also mean LysA (and/or LysB) or a portion thereof.

[0069] In one embodiment, the amino acid sequence of the domain with activity specific to an ester linkage may be selected from any one or more of the amino acid sequences of SEQ ID NOs: 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 26, 28, 30 or 32, or may be encoded by any one or more of the nucleotide sequences of SEQ ID NOs: 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 25, 27, 29 or 31, as follows:

TABLE-US-00002 Length: 756 Type: DNA Other information: LysB-D29 Sequence ID No: 15  
ATGAGCAAGCCCTGGCTGTTACCGTTCACGGCACGGGCCAGCCCCGATCCCCCTCGGGCCTGGCCTGCCTGCCGAT  
ACGGCACGCGACGTACTTGACATCTACCGGTGGCAGCCCATCGGCAACTACCCCGCTGCGGCCTTCCCGATGTGG  
CCGTCCGGTCGAGAAGGGTGTGCGCCGAGCTGATCCTGCAGATCGAGCTGAAGCTGGACGCGGACCCCTACGCGGAC  
TTCGCGATGGCGGGTTACTCGCAGGGAGCCATCGTGTTGGCCAGGTGCTCAAGCACCACATCCTGCCTCCGACG  
GGCAGGCTCCACAGGTTCTGACACCGGCTCAAGAAGGTCATCTTCTGGGGTAATCCCATGCGGCAGAAAGGGCTTT  
GCCCACTCTGACGAGTGGATCCACCCGGTCGCTGCCCTGACACCCTCGGAATCCTCGAGGACCGGCTCGAAAAC  
CTGGAGCAGTACGGCTTCGAGGTCCGCGACTACGCCACGACGGTGACATGTACGCCTCCATCAAAGAGGACGAC  
CTGCACGAATACGAGGTCCGATCGGCCGGATCGTGATGAAGGCCAGCGGCTTCATCGGTGGCCGGGACTCCGTG  
GTAGCCCAGCTCATCGAGCTTGGCCAGCGTCCGATCACCGAGGGAATTGCGTTGGCGGGAGCCATCATCGACGCC  
CTCACGTTCTTCGCCCCGCTCTCGTATGGGCGACAAGTGGCCGCACCTCTACAACCGCTACCCGGCGGTTCGAGTTC  
CTACGACAGATCTGA Length: 254 Molecular weight: 28.5 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the  
following domains: Cutinase domain; 41.fwdarw.69 LysinB C-terminal linker domain; 176.fwdarw.244 PE-  
PPE; 51.fwdarw.125 Other information: LysB-D29 Sequence ID No: 16  
MSKPWLFTVHGTGQPDPLGPGLPADTARDVLDIYRWQPIGNYPAAAFPMWPSVEKGVAELILQIELKLDADPYAD  
FAMAGYSQGAIVVGQVLKHHILPPTGRLHRLKLVIFWGNPMRQKGFHSDSEWIHPVAAPDTLGILEDRLEN

LEQYGFVEYHEDYKDDMYAIDSHEDDHEHEIVAGIRVIMKASGFIIGRDSVVAQLIELGQRPITEGIALAGAIIDA  
LTTFFARSRMGDKWPHLYNRYPAVEFLRQI Length: 846 Type: DNA Other information: LysB-Omega

Sequence ID No: 17

ATGTTGAACGGTGAATTTTACGTTCCGGCAGGGACAATCATTACTGCCAACGGGACAGGGGTTCCAGATGGTGCG  
GGGCCCCGATTGTTGCTGCCGATCTGGCTCGCGAACTGGAGCGTGTGGCTGAAGGCATGTGGATTTGAAATGGATC  
AACTACCCAGCAGCAGTAATGCCGATGCGTCCGAGCATTAAACGTTGCGTTTGGCTTTAAAAGAGATGATCCGT  
ACCACTCCGGGCAAATTTGTTTTATCGGCGTACTCTCAATCGGCCGTGGCTTTTGCTTACGTATGGCGCGACGAC  
ATTCTTAACCCCGATGGTGAACCTTACGACCGCCTGGATGATATTGTAGCAGTAATCTTGTACGGCAACCCAGTT  
CGCGCCCCTGGGATTGCTTATGGCAACGAGTTAGGCGGTCAATCTGCCCCCGGCAAGCTGAATGGGCATGTCACC  
GGCGGCATCGCCGGGCTGATTGTTTGCGCCCGGAAGAGTGCCTCCATCCCGTCACTGGGCGTCGCATTGTACTG  
GACTTCGCTAATGCCGGTGATTGTACGCTGCTGCACCCGTTGGCGCGGAACCCIGGGTCAAAGAGACTGAGGTA  
GGCCATAACGAGACGCTTATTTACGAAGCTGTTATGGATTTTAATGGCCGCGATATCCTTGCATTCCGCCAAAGAG  
ATCGCACAGATTCTTACAATGCCCTTGAGCCAGGTGCTACCGCTGGTACAAGCAATTATCAACGGGTAAAGCTTT  
CTTGTCCAGGGCCCCGAAAGCTCCGCACTGGACGTACACGATTGGCCCGGCAGTCGATTACTTAGTCCGCACGGGC  
AATGAACTTCGTAAAAATTGA Length: 281 Molecular weight: 30.3 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains

Cutinase domain; 21.fwdarw.139 Other information: LysB-Omega Sequence ID No: 18

MLNGEFYVPAGTIITANGTGVPDGAGPGFGADLARELERVAEGMWIWKWINYPAAVMPMRPSINTLRLALKEMIR  
TTPGKIVLSAYSQSAFAFAYVWRDDILNPDGELHDLRDDIVAVILYGNPVRAPGIAYGNELGGQSAPGKLNGHVT  
GGIAGPDCLRPEECVHPVTGRRIVLDFANAGDLYAAAPVGAEPWVKETEYVGHNETLIYEAVMDENGRDILAFKE  
IAQILTMPLSQVVPLVQAIINGLSFLVQGPKAPHWYTYTIGPAVDYLVRTGNELRKN Length: 1002 Type: DNA

Other information: LysB-Saal Sequence ID No: 19

ATGCGCATCGACGGTCAATATGTGGGACTGGGGCTTGGGGATTCTTCAGACGAGATCCGTAAAATCAAGGCGTTC  
ATGCGCCGCAAATTCGCGAGCTATGCCGGAGATTTAGCGGATACTCCTTTGTACGATGAAGCTATGACCGCAGCA  
GTGGCCGAGATGCAAGCGCGCTACAGTGCGGCTGGTCAACTICGTGCTGGATTGTACATTCCCGGTATCGTAGGA  
GCCGAACTAAGTATGTGATGGGTACTTACCCCGCCCCGCTCGTTGATACTCGTCCGGTACTGATCACTGTGTGT  
GGTACGGGTGTTCCATGGTGGATTGGGCCTGATGCAGATACTGCTCGCGCTGTGGAGGATAAGTACCTGTGGCAA  
CCGATCGGTTATCCTGCAGCCCCCTTTTCCAATGGGAAAATCCATCGCGGCGGCTATTACCGAGACTCACAACCAA  
GCCAATCGCTGGCGCGAGCGCATCGAACTCACGGCGCGGCCTTGGCTGGCTATAGCCAGGGTGCAGTGGTAGTG  
TCAGAGCTTTGGATGAACCACATTGCGCCGGAGGATGGTTCCTTCATTGGATGAAACCACACATTGAAAAAGCC  
GTCATTGGGGGAACCCAAATCGCGAGTTGGGGCACGTATGGGGGGACCACGGGGGTTCTCCTCGTGCGCCGTCT  
AATACCCAAGGCGTTTCAAGTAACGGAATGCGTGATACGCCCCCATGGTGGCGTGATTATGCTCACCAGGGIGAC  
CITTATGCGTGATACAGAGCCAGGGGATACTCAAGAGGTGCGTAACGCGATTTGGCAAATTGTACGCGACTTGGAT  
TTATTTACAGGGCCCGACAGTTTGTAGCCCAGGTTGTAGAGTTGGTGCAGGCCCTCTGCCCGAAGCTATCGCT  
ATCACAAGGCGCTTTTGGATGCCGGTATGTTCTTCGCTAAACGTACAGGCCACATGTGGACTATAACGTACAG  
CCAGCGATCGATTACCTGCGCACATGA Length: 308 Molecular weight: 33.8 kDa Type: protein Feature:

contains the following domains: Putative peptidoglycan binding domain; 38.fwdarw.58 PE-PPE;

136.fwdarw.224 Cutinase domain; 120.fwdarw.208 Other information: LysB-Saal Sequence ID No: 20

MRRKFASYAGDLADTPLYDEAMTAAVAEMQARYSAAGQLRAGLYIPGIVGAETKYVMGYLPRPVVDTRPVLITVC  
GTGVPWWIGPDADTARAVEDKYLWQPIGYPAAPFPMGKSIAAATETHNQANRWRERIETHGAALAGYSQGAVVV  
SELWMNHIAPEDGSLHWMKPHIEKAVTWGNPNRELGHVWADHGGSPRAPSNTQGVSSNGMRDTPPWWRDYAHQGD  
LYACTEPGDTQEVRNAIWQIVRDLDFTPDLSLLAQVVELVQAPLPEAIAITKALLDAGMFFAKRTGPHVDYNVQ

PAIDYLRT Length: 1038 Type: DNA Other information: LysB-Ds6A Sequence ID No: 21

ATGACCTGGATTGGCTGGCAGCAAGGTATGGGGGGAGAGCCGGTAGCCGCTGCGAAGCGTGAGCTTCGTGCGCAA  
TTCAGTTATGCTAAACATCTGGATGACAGCGACGTATTTGATCTGGAGTTATTGGCCGTTTTGATCGAGTACCAA  
CAAAAAAAGAACGCGACTGGTTATACACCTCGCCTGCGCGAAGACGGCGTTCTTGATTGGGCCACTCAAGTTGCG  
ATTGGTACGGTGCAAACCTGGGCCCCCTCCTAAGGCAGGCACGTTATTTACTGTGCAAGGAACCTGGCGTTGATATG  
TGGACAGGACCCCCGGCGGACACGGCTCGTGCCGTGGAGGGCGACTGGGAATGGCAGCCGATTGGCAATTACCCT  
GCTTCACCGTTCCCAATGTGGGCTTCCATCTGGCAGGGGATTGAAGAACTGCGCTTTCAGATTCTGCGCCATGCT  
ACGGAAAAACCGGGGAAAGCCATTGCCCTGGCAGGTTTCTCACAGGGTGCCGTAGTCGTAAGTTGGGTCTACAAG  
TGGGACATTGCACTGCCCGGTGGCATGCTGCACGACTTGCTGCCACAGGTGGCAGCGGGTGTAACGTGGGGTAAT  
CCCATGGCAGAAAAAGGCAAGTTTCATGGTAACCGCTTCGCCGGCTGGCCTGTGCCTGCCGGAATGGGGATCAAC  
CGTGACCGCTTGGAATAACCCCGCATATGGCTTGACTTTGGGCACGGTCGCAATTCACCTTGGGGCCAAGAT  
ATTTATTGCGACCGCCCGGATAATTTGGCTGGTCAGGACATGGAGCTTATTTGTGACCTGGTCATGGCTCAGGAC  
CTGTGGCGCTTTGTGACAGACTTCGCAGTAAAAGCTGGGAACGTGATGGCGTCGCTGAGACGGAGTTACCCGCA  
ATCTTGGATGCAGTTACACAAGCTGGTATGTTTTTCATTGTTAATCGTACTGCCCCGCATCTGACTTATGACGTA  
GGTCCTGCCATCGATTACCTTCGCCAAGTTGCGCGCGACCGCCGCTTGGCTTTAGCCGCGTGA Length: 345

Molecular weight: 38.17 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following domains: LysinB C-

terminal linker domain; 260.fwdarw.325 PE-PPE; 132.fwdarw.219 Cutinase domain; 119.fwdarw.206 Other

information: LysB-Ds6A Sequence ID No: 22

MTWIGWQQGMAGEPVAAAKRELRRKFSYAKHLDDSDVEDLELLAVLIEYQQKKNATGYTPRLREDGVLDWATQVA  
IGTVQTGPPPKAGTLFTVQGTGVDMWTGPPADTARAVEGDWEWQPIGNYPASPFPMWASIWQGIEELRFQIRRA

TEKPGKALAGKVAALAGVAVVSWYKWDLPGLDHLKQVAAAGVTVGNPMAEKKGKFGHNRFAAGWPPVPAAGMGIN  
RDRLNTPALWLDFGHGRNSPWGQDIYCDRPNLAGQDMELICDLVMAQDLWRFVTDFAVKAGNVMASPETELPA  
ILDAVTQAGMFFIVNRTAPHLTYDVGPAIDYLRQVARDRRLALAA Length: 981 Type: DNA Other  
information: LysB-Obama12 Sequence ID No: 23  
ATGCTGAAGTTAGGATCAAACGGGCTGATGGTTGCGGCGTGGACGGCAGTTATGCGTATCCGTTTTCGCTTCGTAT  
GCTCTTGGTGTAACGGTTTACCGATCAAGGTAGATGGCTACTTTGGTTATGATGAAGAAAAAGTGCAAAAGGAG  
TATCAACGTCGTACAGGACAGTTCCCGTCTGGACAAGTATCGCGCGAGGATCTGCATCGTCTGGGTTTATTGCCA  
ACTTTAATCAGCATTACGGCACAGGTCAAGCAGACCCTTTTGGCATCGGGTACCCGGCAGACATTGCTCGCCGC  
GTGCTTGATCTTTATTGGTGGCAGCCGTTAGGCAACTACCCGGCGAAAGCTGTCCCTATGAACGGATCGGTTGAC  
CAGGGTGAACGTGAGGGCGTCCGTTTGATCTCTGACCCCCTTATCGTGCCAGGTCCAACAGCGTTTGTAGATTAT  
TCCCAAGGTTCACTGATTGGAGGGCGCTTACGCAACCGCATGCGCCGTAAGGAGCTGCGCGGAGAGCTTGTCCGC  
GCAGCCAGTTTTTGAAATCCAATGCGTCTGCGCGGCCATTACGCAGGCAACGTAGACCCTGGCGGTGAAGGTATT  
GATCCACGTCAAGAGCTGGCTGCTGAACCATTCCGCATCGAGTTAGCTGCGAAAGGCGACTTGTACACGACTTGC  
CCTGGCGGTCACTCAGGCGAAATGGAACGCGCCATTTATCATGCGTTTTTACCAAGTTCATCGGAGAAGATACT  
CTTATCGAGCAAGTATGGGAACCTTGCTAAAAATCCATTTCTGTAAGTCCCGGCCCGCGTGAAGGCTATTGTGCGC  
GGCGGAATGTTGCGCATCCGTGGCACAGGTCCTCATGTTGCTACCATATTGATCAATGCCCAGGGACGGGAATG  
ACATATTACGAATACGCGGTCAAGCATTGCGCGACACCGCAGATGCGCGTTTGGCGCCGATTGTGCGCTCTGTA  
ACATGA Length: 317 Molecular weight: 35 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains LysinB C-terminal  
linker domain; 221.fwdarw.383 Other information: LysB-Obama12 Sequence ID No: 24  
MVAAWTAVMRIRFASYALGVNGLPIKVDGYFGYDEEKVQKEYQRRTGQFSPSGQVSREDLHRLGLLPTLISIHGTG  
QADPFGIGYPADIARRVLDLYWWQPLGNYPKAVPMNGSVDQGEREGVRLISDPLIVPGPTAFVDYSQGSVIGGR  
LRNRMRRKELRGELVAAASFGNPMRLRGHYAGNVDPGGEGIDPRQELAAEPFRIELAAKGDLYTTCPGGQSGEME  
RAIYHAVFSKFIGEDTLIEQVWELAKNPFREVPAAVKAIVRGGMF AIRGTGPHVRYHIDQCPGTGMTYYEYAVKH  
LRDTADARLRRIVASVT Length: 759 Type: DNA Other information: LysB-Enkosi Sequence ID No: 25  
ATGTCTAAGCCTGTGCTGTTGACTGCTAGTGGGACGGGTGCGGATATGTGGTCTGGATATCCGGCGGATCTTGCG  
CGTCCGCTCGAGGACCTTTACTACTTTCAGCCAATCTACTATGGTCCAGGTGGGATTCCGGCGACGGTACCAATG  
GGGGCGAGCGCACAGTCTGGCGTAGATATGGGAGTACGTCTGGTACTGGAGTGCGAGGCTCGTCCGTCGCGCGAC  
GTCCCTGATGGGTATGCCTTGTGTGGCTACTCTCAAGGGGGCATGTTGTATCCGCGTTGTTGGACGAGTTTCGC  
ACGGGCCGCTTCGCCACTTGAATGGCAAATTGATGGCGGGCAGCACCTTTGGAAACCCGTGGCGCGAGCTTGAT  
TCTAACGGGGGGCGCGGCATCAGCGACCGTCGCATTGTGGGGACCCCCGACTTCTGGGTGGATGAGTTCGACCCA  
GGAGACATTTATGCAAACGTGCCTAACAATGATGTGCGGGATGATATGACTGCCATTTTTAAGCTGGTACAGCTG  
CGCTCACTGGCTGACCTGATCGGTATTGGATCGATTATGGATCGCGTAATGGACGTTCTTCGCGGCCCATTGAGC  
GGGATGCGCTCCGTAGTTGAGGCGATTGTTTCGTGGCTTATTATTTTTTCGGCCGTAAGCCGCCAACAGCGCCCCAT  
ACAGAGTACCATTTGCGCGAGGTCCGTCCGGGAGTGACGTATTTTGAACATGCAGTCGCCCACATGCGCGCTATG  
GCCGCTGA Length: 237 Molecular weight: 26 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following  
domains : LysinB C-terminal linker domain; 147.fwdarw.218 Alpha/Beta hydrolase family 1.fwdarw.224  
Other information: LysB-Enkosi Sequence ID No: 26  
MWSGYPADLARRVEDLYYFQPIYYGPGGIPATVPMGASAQSGVDMGVRLVLECEARPSRDVPDGYALCGYSQGGM  
VVSALLDEFRTGRLRHLNGLKLMAGSTEGNPWRELDNSNGGRGISDRRIVGTPDFWVDEFDPGDIYANVPNNDVGDD  
MTAIFKLVQIRSLADLIGISIMDRVMDVLRGPLSGMRSVVEAIVRGLLFFGRKPPTAPHTEYHLREVRPGVTYF  
EHAVAHMRAMAA Length: 966 Type: DNA Other information: LysB-Bxz2 Sequence ID No: 27  
ATGCCGTTACGCGTGGGCAGCAATGATGCAAATACCGGTGGTCTTGTATCACGCTGGCAAAAGACCATGTTAGCG  
CGTTATGCCGCGTATGCGAAAGCTTATGATGGCGGCCCATACGTGTGGATGGGTACTTTGGTTATGATGATGCC  
GATGTGCAACGTGAATATGAGCGTCGTACACATCAAGTTGTGGATGGGGAAGTTAGCGATGCGGATCTGCGTGCC  
TTGGGGTTGGAAGCCGCAAAACGTTGGCTTTTACCCTGTCATGGAAGTGGCCAAGCAGATCCTCTTGGGCCAGGC  
TTGCCTGCAGATACCGCCCGTGCCGTCTGGATAAATATACGTGGCAACCGATTGGAAATTATCCTGCACGTGCA  
TTTCCAATGTGGTTCGTCCATTATGGATGGCGCGCGCGAACTCCGTTTCGCAAATTGCTTCCAAAAGTGGCGAAGTT  
AATCTCGCAGGTTATAGTCAGGGTGCAGTAGTGGTTGGGCAAGTTCTGAAACATGATATTATGGATCCTAAAGGT  
TCTCTCCATCATCGCTTAGGTGACGTGCGTAAAGTTGTACTTTGGGGTAACCCGATGCGTCAACGTGGCATTGCC  
CATTTTGACGAATGGATCCATCCTGTCGCTGGACCCGATTCTTATGGTATTTTGGACGATCGCCTGGAAGGATTG  
GAGAAAGCGCCTTTTGAATTCGTGATTATGCCCATGCCGGCGATATGTATGCGAGCATTACCGATGGTGATAAA  
GATGAATATAAAATTGCCATTTGTAAAATTGTGATGACCGCTACCGATTTCTATCGCGGTCCAAATAGCGTGGTC  
AGCCAGCTCATTGAATTGGGTCAACGCCCTCTGACTGAAGGTATTGCGATGGCGCTTGCAATTATTGATACCCTT  
CGTTCTTTACCAATACGGCTCATGGGTATAATATTGGTCCGGCGATTGATTTTCTTCGCTCATGA Length: 321  
Molecular weight: 35.41 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following domains: PE-PPE;  
130.fwdarw.199 Cutinase 149.fwdarw.200 LysinB C-terminal linker domain; 221.fwdarw.283 Other  
information: LysB-Bxz2 Sequence ID No: 28  
MPLRVGSNDANTGGLVSRWQKTM LARYAAYAKAYDGGPLRVDGYFGYDDADVQREYERRTHQVVDGEVSDADLRA  
LGLEAAKRWLFTVHGTGQADPLGPGLPADTARAVLDKYTWQPIGNYPARA FPMWSSIMDGARELRSQIASKSGEV  
NLAGYSQGAVVVGQVLKHDIMDPKGS LHHRLGDVRKVVLWGNPMRQRGIAHFDEWIHPVAGPDSYGILDDRLEGL  
EKAPFEIRDYAHAGDMYASITDGD KDEYKIAICKIVMTATDFYRGPNSSVVSQ LIELGQRPLTEGIAMALAIIDTL

RFFNTNAGHYNIQPAIDFLRS Length: 765 Type: DNA Other information: LysB-L5 Sequence ID No: 29  
 ATGAGTAAACCGTGGTTATTTACTGTGCATGGAACCGGACAACCCGATCCTCTTGGTCCCGGGCTCCCGGCAGAC  
 ACAGCTCGTGATGTTTTGGATATTTATCGTTGGCAACCAATTGGTAATTATCCAGCCGCCGCATTTCCCATGTGG  
 CCCAGCGTGGAGAAAGGGGTTGCCGAATTAATTCTCCAAATTGAACTTAAATTGGATGCGGACCCATATGCCGAT  
 TTTGCCCTTGGCGGGTTATTCTCAAGGTGCGATTGTTGTAGGACAAGTTCTGAAACATCATATTATTAATCCTCGC  
 GGACGTTTGCATCGTTTTCTTCATCGTCTGCGCAAAGTAATTTCTGGGGCAACCCCATGCGTCAGAAAGGTTTC  
 GCGCATACTGATGAATGGATCCATCAAGTGGCCGCAAGTGATACTATGGGTATTCTGGAAGATCGTTTGGAAAAT  
 CTTGAACAGTATGGTTTCGAAGTTCGTGATTATGCGCATGATGGTGATATGTACGCGAGTATTAAAGAAGATGAT  
 ATGCATGAATATGAAGTTGCGATCGGTCGTATTGTTATGTCTGCGCGTCGCTTTATTGGCGGAAAAGATTCAAGTA  
 ATTGCGCAACTGATTGAACTGGGCCAACGCCCAATTTGGGAAGGCATTGCAATGGCTCGCGCTATTATTGATGCG  
 CTTACCTTCTTCGCGAAATCTACACAGGGGCTTCGTGGCCTCACCTTTATAATCGTTTTCCAGCCGTAGAATTT  
 CTGCGTTCGCAATTTGA Length: 254 Molecular weight: 28.84 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the  
 following domains: Alpha/Beta hydrolase family 176.fwdarw.244 LysinB C-terminal linker domain;  
 3.fwdarw.251 Other information: LysB-L5 Sequence ID No: 28  
 MSKPWLFTVHGTGQPDPLGPGLPADTARDVLDIYRWQPIGNYPAAAFPMWPSVEKGVAELILQIELKLDADPYAD  
 FALAGYSQGAIVVGQVLKHHIINPRGRLHRLHRLKRVIFWGNPMPRQKGFHTDEWIHQVAASDTMGILEDRLN  
 LEQYGFVVRDYAHDGDMYASIKEDDMHEYEVAIGRIVMSARRFIGGKDSVIAQLIELGQRPIWEGIAMARAIIDA  
 LTFFAKSTQGPSWPHLYNRFPAVEFLRRI Sequence ID No: 31 Length: 999 Type: DNA Other  
 information: LysB-Ms6 Sequence ID No: 30  
 ATGCGTATCGACGGCCAATATGTTGGATTAGGACCAGGGGATCGTTCGGACGAGATCCGCAAGATCAAAGCGTTC  
 ATGCGTCGCAAGTTCTCCTACGCAGCGACGCTGGCCGACACTGAGTTCTACGACGAGGCCATGACCGCTGTAGTC  
 GCCGAGATGCAATCCCGTTACAACACTGCTGGTCAGCTCCGCGACGGGTTGTACATCCCCGGGATTATCAACGCT  
 GAAACCAAGTACGTTATGGGATATTTGTCACGTCCAGTAATCGACACACGTCCAGTCCTGTTTACCGTATGCGGA  
 ACCGGCGTGCTTGGTGGGTCGGCCCAGACGCCGACACCGCTCGCGCTGTTGAGGACCAATATTTATGGCAACCG  
 ATTGGTTATCCGGCCGCGCCCTTCCCAATGGGTTCGTTCCATCACCGCGGGGATCACTGAGGCACACAACCAGGCG  
 AACCGCTGGCGCGAACGTATCGAAACTCACGGCACCGCCCTCGCAGGTTATTCTCAAGGCGCAGTCGTTCTTTCT  
 GAGTTATGGATGAACCACATCGCACCGGAAGACGGCTCGCTTCGCTGGATGAAACCACATGTACGTAAAGCAGTG  
 ACGTGGGGCAACCCGAACCGCGAATTAGGCCACGTGTGGGCGGATCACGGCGGCTCTCCTATGGCGCCAAGTAAC  
 ACTCAGGGCGTGTCGTCAAACGGAATGCGCAACACGCCTGACTGGTGGCGCGACTACGCCCACCAAGGCGACCTG  
 TACGCTTGACCGAACCGGGAGACACCCAAGAGGTTTCGCAACGCGATCTGGCAGATCGTCCGCGACCTGGACCTG  
 TTCACCGGACCAGATTCACTCCTTGCCCAAGTGATCGAACTGGCCCAAGCCCCTCTCCCTGAGACGATCGCGATC  
 ACTCGCGCGATCCTGGACGCGGGTATGTTCTTCGCGAAACGCACAGGCCACACGTAGACTACAACCCGCGAGCCA  
 GCGATCGACTATCTCCGCACGTGA Length: 307 Molecular weight: 34.21 kDa Type: protein Feature:  
 contains the following domains: Putative peptidoglycan binding domain; 15.fwdarw.58 PE-PPE;  
 134.fwdarw.224 Cutinase; 120.fwdarw.208 LysinB C-terminal linker domain; 234.fwdarw.298 Other  
 information: LysB-Ms6 Sequence ID No: 32  
 MRRKFSYAATLADTEFYDEAMTAVVAEMQSRYNAGQLRDGLYIPGIINAETKYVMGYLSRPVIDTRPVLFTVCG  
 TGVPPWVGPADTARAVEDQYLWQPIGYPAAPFPMGRSITAGITEAHNQANRWRIETHGTALAGYSQGAVVLS  
 ELWMNHIAPEDGSLRWMKPHVRKAVTWGNPNRELGHVWADHGGSPMAPSNTQGVSSNGMRNTPDWWRDYAHQGGD  
 YACTEPGDTQEVRNAIWQIVRDLDLFTGPDSLLAQVIELAQAPLPETIAITRAILDAGMFFAKRTGPHVDYNPQP  
 AIDYLRT

[0070] In some embodiments, the domain with activity specific to an ester linkage is selected from the group consisting of D29 (SEQ ID NO: 6), Omega (SEQ ID NO: 18), Saal (SEQ ID NO: 20), Obama12 (SEQ ID NO: 24), Bxz2 (SEQ ID NO: 28), L5 (SEQ ID NO: 30), MS6 (SEQ ID NO: 32) and TDMH (SEQ ID NO: 34).

[0071] A domain (e.g. a third domain) with membrane permeabilising, destabilising and/or disrupting activity includes anything capable of causing membrane disruption (which may be termed “membrane lysers” (i.e. domains which are capable of lysing a membrane), “membrane permeabilisers” (i.e. domains which are capable of permeabilising a membrane), “membrane disrupters” (i.e. domains which are capable of disrupting a membrane) and/or “membrane destabilizers” (i.e. domains which are capable of destabilizing a membrane)). Such a domain is any domain which is capable of permeabilising and/or disrupting a membrane, preferably the outer membrane/outer leaflet. Such a domain may be an antimicrobial peptide (AMP), such as AMPs that are polycationic, hydrophobic, amphipathic, nano peptides, synthetic natural, Synthetic Mimics of Antimicrobial Peptides (SMAMPs), peptidomimetic oligomer, small molecules, polymeric mimics of AMPs, native AMPs, modified AMPs, or combinations thereof. AMPs may be derived from the same or different origins, for example AMPs may be derived from bacteria (e.g. bacteriocins), viruses, animals (including insects and mammals, e.g. human (such as defensins, including alpha and beta defensins)) and/or plants (such as defensins, thionins,  $\alpha$ -hairpinins (hairpin-like peptides), hevein-like peptides, knottins, snakins, lipid-transfer proteins, and cyclotides). AMPs may be selected from the group consisting of: Cathelicidin-BF; Ci-MAM-A24 (Ciona-molecule against microbes A 24-residues); Ranalexin; Nigrocin-2; D-Piscidin 1 [I9K], Chain A, Moronecidin; Cecropin A; Protegrin-1, Chain A; SMAP-29, Sheep myeloid antimicrobial peptide; Lactoferricin B (LfcinB); IR2 (IR) 2-Protegrin-1 (8-13)-(RI) 2; (FR) 2-Protegrin-1 (8-13)-(FR) 2; CEM1; LL-37, Cathelicidin antimicrobial peptide preproprotein; Indolicidin, Cathelicidin-4 precursor; Magainin-2, Chain A; Cecropin A2; Cecropin P1; Pleurocidin precursor; Buforin II;



Asipine 5; Tilapia Piscidin 4 (TP4); Epinecidin-1 prepropeptide; Chrysophsin-1; Piscidin-like peptide; Myxinidin; PAM2 (platypus antimicrobial 2); Pleurocidin-like peptide AP3 (23-45), NRC-13; 3IQ2 Ras GTPase-activating-like protein IQGAP3 (759-781); SSL-25, Variant and derivative from Dermcidin; KK-Temporin-B (G6A), (Chain A, temporinB\_KKG6A); Fowlicidin-2 (1-31); E7K\_19K\_IsCT Chain A, Cytotoxic linear peptide IsCT; PCNP, Polycationic nonapeptide; E7K\_IsCT, Chain A, Cytotoxic linear peptide IsCT; and combinations thereof.

[0072] The domains with membrane permeabilising, destabilising and/or disrupting activity may have been demonstrated to have activity against Gram-positive or Gram-negative bacteria, but may not have activity against mycobacteria when used in isolation. For example, Ranalexin has activity against Gram-positive and Gram-negative bacteria, but has not been shown to have activity against mycobacteria (as can be seen in the Database of Antimicrobial Activity and Structure of Peptides (DBAASP), see Peptide Card ID: 13797). However, use of Ranalexin as an AMP fused with a LysA and LysB has been shown herein to have activity against mycobacteria. Therefore, in some embodiments, the domain with membrane permeabilising, destabilising and/or disrupting activity may be a domain that does not have activity against mycobacteria in isolation (i.e. not fused to LysA and/or LysB), but exerts antimycobacterial activity following fusion to LysA and LysB.

[0073] In some embodiments, the domain may be an AMP that can permeabilise a cell membrane as defined herein, and/or the domain may be an AMP that destabilises (and/or disrupts) a cell membrane as defined herein. Membranes may be destabilised and/or disrupted (e.g. with an AMP) through chelating or competitively displacing the divalent cations that stabilise the membrane.

[0074] Such a domain may be a holin. By “Holins” we include proteins capable of forming pores in a host cell membrane. Holins are small proteins produced by dsDNA bacteriophages which are capable of triggering and controlling the permeabilization of a cell membrane. Holins form pores in the cell membrane, which can facilitate access for enzymes (such as those described for the first and second domains, above, e.g. lysins) to access other cell wall components, such as the peptidoglycan layer and/or other components of the cell wall. The other domains are then able to act on their respective targets.

[0075] By “Holins” we include Class I holins, Class II holins and Class III holins, and members of all seven (I to VII) Holin superfamilies. We also include pinholins. Also included are portions of holins that retain their required activity. For example, a holin of the present invention may be a holin or a portion thereof. For example, a portion thereof may be a transmembrane domain of holins, which may have a similar function as the full protein length. Pinholins form small heptameric pores that collapse the membrane potential (the PMF) across the inner membrane, while the more conventional holins form large multi-subunit pores of variable sizes. Holins are classified according to the topology of the seven superfamilies, and according to the mechanism into holins and pinholins.

[0076] Such a domain may be a spanin, such as those defined in Kongari et al., 2018 and available in the CPT Spanin Database (<https://cpt.tamu.edu/spanindb/#/phages>). By “spanin” we include bacteriophage peptides that span the outer membrane of gram-negative bacteria. Spanins include two-component spanins and unimolecular spanins. Prototype two-components spanins include the Rz-Rz1 from phage lambda comprising an integral inner membrane protein (i-spanin) and an outer membrane lipoprotein (o-spanin).

[0077] Such a domain may be a cationic or amphipathic domain present in the N- or C-terminus of a bacteriophage lysin. This domain may adopt a helix, random coil or sheet conformation and interact without the outer membrane. This domain may take over the role of a spanin in spanin-less phages. Such a domain may be selected from Lys1521, OBPgp279, PlyE146, EndoT5, SPN9CC, Cfp1, LysAB2, LysAB3, LysAB4, PlyAB1, PlyF307, LysABP-01, ABgp46, LysPA26, LysAm24, LysECD7 and/or LysSi3 (Gutierrez Fernandez and Briers, 2020).

[0078] In one embodiment, the amino acid sequence of the domain with membrane permeabilising, destabilising and/or disrupting activity may be selected from any one or more of SEQ ID NOs: 34, 36, 38, 40, 42, 44, 46, 48, 50, 52, 54, 56, 58, 60, 62, 64, 66, 68, 70, 72, 74, 76, 78, 80, 82, 84, 86, 88, 90, 92, 94, 96, 98, 100 or 102; or may be encoded by any one or more of the nucleotide sequences of SEQ ID NO: 33, 35, 37, 39, 41, 43, 45, 47, 49, 51, 53, 55, 57, 59, 61, 63, 65, 67, 69, 71, 73, 75, 77, 79, 81, 83, 85, 87, 89, 91, 93, 95, 97, 99 or 101; as follows:

TABLE-US-00003 Length: 678 Type: DNA Other information: Trehalose dimycolate hydrolase (TDMH)  
Sequence ID No: 33

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ATGACCATGGCCATCGTTATCTCCCTGCGTAAACCAGCGCGCTTAGCGGCTTTTGCTAGCGCGGTTTTATGTGCG
GGAGCGGCCTTAGCTACCGGTCCTGCTCCAGTTGCGTCTGCCGAACCGTGTAAGTGAAGTCGTTTTCGCC
CGTGGTACCAGCGAGCCTGCAGGAATTGGGCGTGTGGGTCAAGCACTCACGGACGCCATTCGTAACCAAGTAGGC
GGTCGTACCGTGAGTACATATGGTGTAAATTATCCTGCGACTTATGATTTTCTTGCTGCCGCTGATGGTGCGAAT
GATGCTACGAATCGTATTGCCACATTAGCGGAACAATGTCCAAGTACCCGTGTGGTCTTAGGCGGGTATAGTCAA
GGTGCAGCAGTAGTAGATATGCTCTTAGGCATTCCACCGCTCGGGAATAAAGTTGGTAATTTTGGCAGTGACCCC
CCATTGCCTTCGAATCTGATGAATAATGTAGCAGCAGTGGCCGTCTTTGGTAATCCTTCTGCGAAATTTGGGATT
CCTGTGACATCGCGCTTTGGTGGTTCGTGCCATTGATGCATGTTTCAGATGGAGATCCCATTTGCAGCGATGGCCGT
AATCCATTTGCCCATACACACTATGAATCAAGCCCATTATTCTCAAGCGGCCGGCTTAATTGCCGGCTTAGTA
TGA
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Length: 225 Molecular weight: 22.68 kDa Type: protein Feature: contains the following domains:  
Signal peptide Gram-positive entry; 1.fwdarw.39 Cutinase; 41.fwdarw.212 Other information: Trehalose dimycolate hydrolase (TDMH) Sequence ID No: 34

MTMAIVISLRKPARLAFAVAVLCAGAAALATGPAPVASAEPCSDIEVVFARGTSEPAGIGRVGQALTDAIRNQVG

GRTVSTYGVNYPATYDFLAAADYDANATRIATLAEQCPSTRVVLGGYSQGAQAVVDMLLGIPPLGNKVGNFGSAP  
 PLPSNLMNNAVAVAVFGNPSAKFGIPVTSRFGGRAIDACSDGDPICSDGRNPFAHTHYESSPFIPQAAGLIAGLV  
 Length: 90 Type: DNA Organism: Snake venom of *Bungarus fasciatus* Other information: Cathelicidin-BF Sequence ID No: 35  
 AAATTTTTTCGGAAACTGAAAAAGTCCGTGAAAAAGCGCGCGGAAAGAATTTTTCAAAAAGCCGCGGGTAATCGGC  
 GTGTCCATTCTTTT Length: 30 Molecular weight: 3.63 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Snake venom  
 of *Bungarus fasciatus* Feature: Helix Other information: Cathelicidin-BF Sequence ID No: 36  
 KFFRKLKKS VKKRAKEFFKKPRVIGVSIPIF Length: 72 Type: DNA Organism: Haemocytes of *Ciona  
 intestinalis* Other information: Ci-MAM-A24 (Ciona-molecule against microbes A 24-residues) Sequence  
 ID No: 37  
 TGGCGCTCCCTGGGTCGTACGCTGTTACGTCTGTCCCATGCTCTGAAACCGCTGGCGCGCCGTTCCGGGTGG  
 Length: 24 Molecular weight: 2.83 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Haemocytes of *Ciona intestinalis*  
 Feature: Helix, cationic Other information: Ci-MAM-A24 (Ciona-molecule against microbes A 24-  
 residues) Sequence ID No: 38 WRS LGRTLLRLSHALKPLARRSGW Length: 61 Type: DNA Organism:  
 skin of *Rana catesbeiana* (Bull frog) Other information: Ranalexin Sequence ID No: 39  
 TTTTTGGGAGGCTTAATAAAGATCGTTCCAGCAATGATTTGTGCAGTGACCAAAAAAATGTT Length: 20  
 Molecular weight: 2.1 kDa Type: Protein Organism: skin of *Rana catesbeiana* (Bull frog) Feature:  
 helix Other information: Ranalexin Sequence ID No: 40 FLGGLIKIVPAMICAVTKKC Length: 62 Type:  
 DNA Organism: skin of *Pelophylax nigromaculatus* (dark-spotted frog) Other information: Nigrocine-2  
 Sequence ID No: 41  
 GGTCTCCTGTCCAAAGTACTGGGCGTTGGCAAAAAAGTGCTGTGCGGTGTCTCTGGTCTGGT Length: 21  
 Molecular weight: 2.03 kDa Type: Protein Organism: skin of *Pelophylax nigromaculatus* (dark-spotted  
 frog) Feature: Amphipathic,  $\alpha$ -helix Other information: Nigrocine-2 Sequence ID No: 42  
 GLLSKVLGVGKKVLCGVSGLC Length: 66 Type: DNA Organism: Mast cells of *Morone saxatilis*  
 Other information: D-Piscidin 1 [I9K], Chain A, Moronecidin Sequence ID No: 43  
 TTCTTCCATCATATTTTCCGCGGCAAAGTCCATGTGGGCAAGACCATTCATCGCTTAGTAACGGGT Length: 22  
 Molecular weight: 2.58 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Mast cells of *Morone saxatilis* Feature: Helix  
 Other information: D-Piscidin 1 [I9K], Chain A, Moronecidin Sequence ID No: 44  
 FFHHIFRGKVHVHGKTIHRLVTG Length: 120 Type: DNA Organism: *Drosophila melanogaster* Other  
 information: Cecropin A Sequence ID No: 45  
 GGCTGGCTGAAAAAAATTGGCAAAAAAATCGAACGCGTGGGCCAGCACACGCGTGATGCAACCATCCAGGGTCTG  
 GGTATCCACAGCAGGCAGCTAACGTAGCCGCGACTGCTCGTGGT Length: 40 Molecular weight: 4.23  
 kDa Type: Protein Organism: *Drosophila melanogaster* Feature: cationic, helical Other information:  
 Cecropin A Sequence ID No: 46 GWLKKIGKKIERVQHQTRDATIQGLGIPQQAANVAATARG Length: 54  
 Type: DNA Organism: Leukocytes of *Sus scrofa* Other information: Protegrin-1, Chain A Sequence  
 ID No: 47 CGTGGCGGTCGTCTGTGTTACTGCCGTCGCCGTTTCTGCGTGTGTGTTGGTCGT Length: 18  
 Molecular weight: 2.16 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Leukocytes of *Sus scrofa* Feature: Cyclic,  
 Cationic Other information: Protegrin-1, Chain A Sequence ID No: 48 RGGRLCYCRRRFCVVCVGR  
 Length: 87 Type: DNA Organism: Leukocytes of *Ovis aries* Other information: SMAP-29, Sheep  
 myeloid antimicrobial peptide Sequence ID No: 49  
 CGTGGTCTGCGTCGCCTGGGTCGCAAAATTGCGCACGGCGTCAAAAAATACGGCCCGACCGTGCTGCGCATTATC  
 CGCATCGCTGGT Length: 29 Molecular weight: 3.25 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Leukocytes of  
*Ovis aries* Feature: helical Other information: SMAP-29, Sheep myeloid antimicrobial peptide Sequence  
 ID No: 50 RGLRRLGRKIAHG VKKYGPTVLRRIIAG Length: 45 Type: DNA Organism: *Bos taurus*  
 Other information: Lactoferricin B (LfcinB) Sequence ID No: 51  
 TTAAATGTCGTCGCTGGCAATGGCGTATGAAAAAACTGGGGGCG Length: 15 Molecular weight: 1.994  
 kDa Type: Protein Organism: *Bos taurus* Feature: Beta, cationic Other information: Lactoferricin B  
 (LfcinB) Sequence ID No: 52 FKCRRWQWRMKKLGA Length: 42 Type: DNA Organism: synthetic  
 variant of Protegrin-1 Other information: IR2 (IR) 2-Protegrin-1 (8-13)-(RI) 2 Sequence ID No: 53  
 ATCCGGATCCGTTGCCGTCGCCGTTCTGCCGCATTCGTATT Length: 14 Molecular weight: 2.41 kDa  
 Type: Protein Organism: synthetic variant of Protegrin-1 Feature: helix Other information: IR2 (IR) 2-  
 Protegrin-1 (8-13)-(RI) 2 Sequence ID No: 54 IRIRCRRRFCRIRI Length: 42 Type: DNA Organism:  
 synthetic variant of Protegrin-1 Other information: (FR) 2-Protegrin-1 (8-13)-(FR) 2 Sequence ID  
 No: 55 TTCCGCTTTCGTTGTCGCCGGCGTTTTTGTGCGTTCCGCTTC Length: 14 Molecular weight: 2.05  
 kDa Type: Protein Organism: synthetic variant of Protegrin-1 Feature: helix Other information: (FR) 2-  
 Protegrin-1 (8-13)-(FR) 2 Sequence ID No: 56 FRFRCRRRFCRFRF Length: 36 Type: DNA Organism:  
 synthetic variant of MSI-78 (1-12) Other information: CEM1 Sequence ID No: 57  
 GGCATTGGTAAGTTCCTGAAAAAAGCGAAGAAATTT Length: 12 Molecular weight: 1.364 kDa Type:  
 Protein Organism: synthetic variant of MSI-78 (1-12) Feature: helix Other information: CEM1 Sequence  
 ID No: 58 GIGKFLKKAKKF Length: 111 Type: DNA Organism: Neutrophil specific granules of  
*Homo sapiens* Other information: LL-37, Cathelicidin antimicrobial peptide preproprotein Sequence ID

No: 59

CTCCTGGGTGACTTCTTTTCGCAAATCCAAAGAGAAAATCGGCAAAGAGTTCAAACGTATCGTGCAGCGCATTAAG  
GACTTTCTGCGTAACCTGGTTCCGCGTACCGAATCT Length: 37 Molecular weight: 3.25 kDa Type:  
Protein Organism: Neutrophil specific granules of *Homo sapiens* Feature: Amphipathic, helical Other  
information: LL-37, Cathelicidin antimicrobial peptide preproprotein Sequence ID No: 60  
LLGDFFRKSKEKIGKEFKRIVQRIKDFLRNLVPRTES Length: 39 Type: DNA Organism: Neutrophils of  
*Bos taurus* [Bovine] Other information: Indolicidin, Cathelicidin-4 precursor Sequence ID No: 61  
ATCCTGCCGTGGAAATGGCCGTGGTGGCCATGGCGTTCG Length: 13 Molecular weight: 1.907 kDa  
Type: Protein Organism: Neutrophils of *Bos taurus* [Bovine] Other information: Indolicidin,  
Cathelicidin-4 precursor Sequence ID No: 62 ILPWKWPWWPWR Length: 69 Type: DNA Organism:  
skin and Stomach of African clawed frog *Xenopus laevis* Other information: Magainin-2, Chain A  
Sequence ID No: 63

GGTATCGGCAAATTCCTGCACTCCGCAAAAAAATTCGGCAAAGCTTTCTGTGGGCGAAATTATGAACTCT  
Length: 23 Molecular weight: 2.46 kDa Type: Protein Organism: skin and Stomach of African  
clawed frog *Xenopus laevis* Feature: Helical, cationic Other information: Magainin-2, Chain A  
Sequence ID No: 64 GIGKFLHSAKKFGKAFVGEIMNS Length: 108 Type: DNA Organism: *Aedes aegypti*  
Other information: Cecropin A2 Sequence ID No: 65

GGCGGCCTGAAAAAACTGGGCAAAAAAAGTGAAGGTGCCGGCAAACGTGTGTTCAACGCTGCAGAAAAAGCACTC  
CCGGTTGTAGCTGGTGCTAAAGCTCTCCGTAAA Length: 36 Molecular weight: 3.67 kDa Type: Protein  
Organism: *Aedes aegypti* Feature: Helix Other information: Cecropin A2 Sequence ID No: 66  
GGLKKLGKKLEGAGKRVFNAAEKALPVVAGAKALRK Length: 93 Type: DNA Organism: *Ascaris suum*  
Other information: Cecropin P1 Sequence ID No: 67

TCTTGGCTGAGCAAACCGCGCAAAAAAAGTGAAGGTGCCGGCAAACGTGTGTTCAACGCTGCAGAAAAAGCACTC  
ATCCAGGGTGGTCCGCGT Length: 31 Molecular weight: 3.67 kDa Type: Protein Organism: *Ascaris*  
*suum* Feature: Helix Other information: Cecropin P1 Sequence ID No: 68

SWLSKTAKKLENSAKKRISGIAIAIQGGPR Length: 75 Type: DNA Organism: the skin mucous  
secretions of Winter flounder *Pleuronectes americanus* Other information: Pleurocidin precursor Sequence  
ID No: 69

GGCTGGGGTTCTTTCTTTAAAAAAGCGGCTCACGTTGGCAAACATGTAGGTAAAGCAGCTCTGACCCACTATCTG  
Length: 25 Molecular weight: 2.71 kDa Type: Protein Organism: the skin mucous secretions of  
Winter flounder *Pleuronectes americanus* Feature: Helix Other information: Pleurocidin precursor Sequence  
ID No: 70 GWGSFFKKAHVGVKGVKAAALHYL Length: 63 Type: DNA Organism: derivative of  
buforin I (from stomach of *Bufo bufo*) after treatment with endoproteinase Other information:  
Buforin II Sequence ID No: 71

ACCCGTAGCTCTCGTGCTGGCCTGCAGTTTCCGGTTGGTCGCGTGCACCGTCTGCTCCGCAAA Length: 21  
Molecular weight: 2.43 kDa Type: Protein Organism: derivative of buforin I (from stomach of  
*Bufo bufo*) after treatment with endoproteinase Feature: Helix, cationic Other information: Buforin II  
Sequence ID No: 72 TRSSRAGLQFPVGRVHRLLRK Length: 72 Type: DNA Organism: skin of  
*Ascaphus truei* (tailed frog) Other information: Ascaphine 5 Sequence ID No: 73

GGTATCAAAGATTGGATCAAAGGCGCAGCGAAAAAAGTGAAGGTGCCGGCAAACGTGTGTTCAACGCTCTCACATTGCTAACCAG  
Length: 24 Molecular weight: 2.59 kDa Type: Protein Organism: skin of *Ascaphus truei* (tailed frog)  
Feature: helix Other information: Ascaphine 5 Sequence ID No: 74 GIKDWIKGAACKLIKTIVASHIANQ

Length: 75 Type: DNA Organism: gills of Nile Tilapia, *Oreochromis niloticus* Other information:  
Tilapia Piscidin 4 (TP4) Sequence ID No: 75

TTTATCCATCACATTATTGGTGGTCTGTTCTCCGCAGGTAAAGCAATTCATCGCTGATTGGCGCTCGTCGGCGC  
Length: 25 Molecular weight: 2.98 kDa Type: Protein Organism: gills of Nile Tilapia, *Oreochromis*  
*niloticus* Other information: Tilapia Piscidin 4 (TP4) Sequence ID No: 76

FIHHIIGGLESAGKAIHRLIRRRR Length: 75 Type: DNA Organism: orange-spotted grouper, *Epinephelus*  
*coioides* Other information: Epinecidin-1 prepropeptide Sequence ID No: 77

TTTATCTTTCACATTATTAAAGGTCTGTTCCATGCGGGGAAAATGATCCACGGCTTAGTGACCCGGCGTCGCCAT  
Length: 25 Molecular weight: 2.98 kDa Type: Protein Organism: orange-spotted grouper, *Epinephelus*  
*coioides* Other information: Epinecidin-1 prepropeptide Sequence ID No: 78

FIFHIKGLFHAGKMIHGLVTRRRH Length: 75 Type: DNA Organism: the pyloric caeca and gills of  
Red sea bream *Chrysophrys major* or *Pagrus major* Other information: Chrysophsin-1 Sequence ID  
No: 79

TTCTTTGGATGGCTTATCAAAGGCGCAATTCATGCTGGGAAAGCGATTTCATGGCCTTATCCATCGCCGTCGTCAT  
Length: 25 Molecular weight: 2.89 kDa Type: Protein Organism: the pyloric caeca and gills of  
Red sea bream, *Chrysophrys major* or *Pagrus major* Feature: Helix Other information: Chrysophsin-1  
Sequence ID No: 80 FFGWLIKGAIHAGKAIHGLIHRRRH Length: 66 Type: DNA Organism: Spleen of  
*Larimichthys crocea* (large yellow croaker) Other information: Piscidin-like peptide Sequence ID No:  
81 ATCTGGGGCTTAATCGCGCACGGGGTGGGTCATGTTGGACGTCTGATTCATGGCCTGATTGCGGT

Length: 22 Molecular weight: 2.33 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Spleen of *Larimichthys crocea* (large yellow croaker) Feature: Helix Other information: Piscidin-like peptide Sequence ID No: 82  
IWGLIAHGVGHVGRGLIHGLIRG Length: 36 Type: DNA Organism: Epidermal mucus of *Myxine glutinosa*  
Other information: Myxinidin Sequence ID No: 83 GGTATTCATGATATCCTGAAATATGGCAAACCGAGC  
Length: 12 Molecular weight: 1.32 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Epidermal mucus of *Myxine glutinosa* Feature: Helix Other information: Myxinidin Sequence ID No: 84 GIHDILKYGKPS Length: 66  
Type: DNA Organism: *Ornithorhynchus anatinus* Other information: PAM2 (platypus antimicrobial 2) Sequence ID No: 85  
CGCCCGTGGGCGGGCAACGGCAGCGTGCATCGCTATACCGTGCTGAGCCCGCGCCTGAAAACCCAG  
Length: 22 Molecular weight: 2.52 kDa Type: Protein Organism: *Ornithorhynchus anatinus* Other information: PAM2 (platypus antimicrobial 2) Sequence ID No: 86 RPWAGNGSVHRYTVLSPRLKTQ  
Length: 69 Type: DNA Organism: *Hippoglossoides platessoides* Other information: Pleurocidin-like peptide AP3 (23-45) , NRC-13 Sequence ID No: 87  
GGCTGGCGCACCCCTGCTGAAAAAAGCGGAAGTGAAAACCGTGGGCAAACCTGGCGCTGAAACATTATCTG  
Length: 23 Molecular weight: 2.65 kDa Type: Protein Organism: *Hippoglossoides platessoides* Other information: Pleurocidin-like peptide AP3 (23-45) , NRC-13 Sequence ID No: 88  
GWRTLLKKAIEVKTGKLALKHYL Length: 69 Type: DNA Organism: Synthetic construct from Human cytoskeletal scaffolding proteins IQGAP3 Other information: 31Q2 Ras GTPase-activating-like protein IQGAP3 (759-781) Sequence ID No: 89  
ACCTGGCTCCCAGCAGTAATTAAGATCCAGGCGCATTGGCGGGGCTATCGTCAGCGTAAGATTTATCTG  
Length: 23 Molecular weight: 2.89 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Synthetic construct from Human cytoskeletal scaffolding proteins IQGAP3 Feature: hydrophobic Other information: 31Q2 Ras GTPase-activating-like protein IQGAP3 (759-781) Sequence ID No: 90 TWLPAVIKIAHWRGYRQRKIYL  
Length: 75 Type: DNA Organism: Eccrine sweat glands, skin, Homo sapiens Other information: SSL-25, Variant and derivative from Dermcidin Sequence ID No: 91  
AGCTCGCTTCTGGAAAAAGGGTTGGACGGCGCCAAAAAAGCGGTTGGCGGCCTTGGTAAACTGGGGAAAGACGCC  
Length: 25 Molecular weight: 2.41 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Eccrine sweat glands, skin, Homo sapiens Feature: helix Other information: SSL-25, Variant and derivative from Dermcidin Sequence ID No: 92 SSLLEKGLDGAKKAVGGLGKLKDA Length: 45 Type: DNA Organism: synthetic Other information: KK-Temporin-B (G6A) , (Chain A, temporinB\_KKG6A) Sequence ID No: 93  
AAAAAATTACTGCCCATCGTCGCCAATCTCCTGAAATCCCTTTTA Length: 15 Molecular weight: 1.663 kDa Type: Protein Organism: synthetic Other information: KK-Temporin-B (G6A) , (Chain A, temporinB\_KKG6A) Sequence ID No: 94 KKLLPIVANLLKSL Length: 93 Type: DNA Organism: *Gallus gallus* Other information: Fowlicidin-2 (1-31) Sequence ID No: 95  
TTAGTACAGCGCGGGCGTTTTGGTCGTTTCCTGCGCAAAATCCGTCGTTTTCTGCCAAAAGTCACGATTACGATC  
CAGGGTAGTGCCCGTTTT Length: 31 Molecular weight: 3.76 kDa Type: Protein Organism: *Gallus gallus* Feature: Helix Other information: Fowlicidin-2 (1-31) Sequence ID No: 96  
LVQGRGFRFLRKIRFRPKVTITIQGSARF Length: 39 Type: DNA Organism: Scorpion venom of *Opisthacanthus madagascariensis* Other information: E7K 19K IsCT Chain A, Cytotoxic linear peptide IsCT Sequence ID No: 97 ATTCTGGGCAAAATTTGGAAAGGCAAAAAAAGCCTGTTT Length: 13  
Molecular weight: 1.517 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Scorpion venom of *Opisthacanthus madagascariensis* Feature: Helix Other information: E7K 19K IsCT, Chain A, Cytotoxic linear peptide IsCT Sequence ID No: 98 ILGKIWKGGKSLF Length: 27 Type: DNA Organism: Synthetic Other information: PCNP, Polycationic nonapeptide Sequence ID No: 99  
AAACGCAAGAAACGTAAGAAACGCAAA Length: 9 Molecular weight: 1.255 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Synthetic Feature: Polycationic Other information: PCNP, Polycationic nonapeptide Sequence ID No: 100 KRKKRKKRK Length: 39 Type: DNA Organism: Scorpion venom of *Opisthacanthus madagascariensis* Other information: E7K IsCT, Chain A, Cytotoxic linear peptide IsCT Sequence ID No: 101 ATTCTGGGCAAAATTTGGAAAGGCATTAAAAGCCTGTTT Length: 13 Molecular weight: 1.502 kDa Type: Protein Organism: Scorpion venom of *Opisthacanthus madagascariensis* Feature: Helix Other information: E7K IsCT, Chain A, Cytotoxic linear peptide IsCT Sequence ID No: 102  
ILGKIWKGIKSLF

[0079] As discussed above, the peptides of the present invention (comprising the three domains as outlined above) are capable of targeting cell envelopes and acting on these to exert an effect on the membrane as well as the cell wall. Such peptides may permeabilise the membrane and break down the cell wall to disrupt bacteria and exert an antibacterial effect.

[0080] Membranes/cell walls of interest for the present invention (e.g. membranes targeted by peptides of the present invention) are comprised of multiple components (see FIG. 1). Target membranes (or target organisms comprising such membranes) may comprise any one or more of the following components: (i) an outer leaflet (also known as the outer membrane); (ii) an inner leaflet; (iii) an arabinogalactan layer; and/or (iv) a peptidoglycan layer. Target membranes (or organisms) may further comprise: (v) a periplasmic space; (vi) a granular layer; and/or (vii) an inner membrane. By “cell envelope” we also include the meaning of the equivalent terms “cell wall” and “cell membrane”.

[0081] The compositions of the layers are as described in Vincent et al., 2018. The granular layer is between the peptidoglycan layer and plasma membrane, which may be linked to the plasma membrane and composed of penicillin-binding proteins, lipoproteins, and lipoteichoic acids (or teichuronic acid in some species). The peptidoglycan layer is comprised of short peptides and glycan strands that are composed of N-acetylglucosamine and N-acetylmuramic acid residues linked by  $\beta$ -1,4 bonds. The arabinogalactan layer may also be attached to the peptidoglycan layer (such as via covalent links to the N-acetylmuramic acid residues and Lcp1). The inner leaflet of the external mycomembrane is homogeneous and mainly composed of mycolic acids (MAS). These MAs are long chain fatty acids that are exclusive to the order Corynebacteriales, and can form a barrier to hydrophilic molecules, including some antibiotics. The outer leaflet is highly heterogeneous and consists of lipids (such as phthiocerol dimycocerosate (PDIM), phenolic glycolipid (PGL, phenolphthiocerol-based glycolipids that share a similar long-chain fatty acid backbone with PDIM), and lipooligosaccharides (LOS)), lipoglycans and proteins. The outer leaflet may also contain trehalose monomycolate (TMM) and trehalose dimycolate (TDM), which consist of glucose disaccharides ( $\alpha$ -D-glucopyranosyl- $\alpha$ -D-glucopyranoside) esterified with MAS.

[0082] Accordingly, peptides of the present invention may be defined by the type of membrane they are capable of targeting. In one embodiment the peptide is capable of targeting a mycobacterial cell envelope (including a cell wall/cell membrane, for example, the mycomembrane). Membranes of interest may also be defined by their thickness. For example, a mycobacterial cell envelope is typically made up of: (i) an outer leaflet and inner leaflet of about 7.5 nm (collectively also known as the mycomembrane); (ii) arabinogalactan and peptidoglycan layers of about 6.3 nm (total); a periplasmic space of about 14.1 nm; a granular layer of about 3.8 nm; and an inner membrane of about 6.3 nm. Thus, a typical mycobacterial cell envelope is a total of about 38 nm. Mycobacterial strains with drug resistance may have a thicker cell envelope. Velayati et al., 2009 demonstrated through transmission electron microscopy (TEM) that there are marked differences in the thickness of cell envelopes between extensively drug-resistant (XDR;  $20.2 \pm 1.5$  nm), multidrug-resistant (MDR;  $17.1 \pm 1.03$  nm) and susceptible tuberculosis (TB;  $15.6 \pm 1.3$  nm) bacilli.

[0083] Thus, peptides of the present invention may be peptides capable of causing lysis of a membrane that is at least 10 nm, 15 nm, 20 nm, 25 nm, 30 nm, 35 nm, 40 nm, 45 nm, 50 nm or more in thickness.

[0084] The outer leaflet and inner leaflet may collectively be termed the “outer membrane”. Therefore, domains of the present invention that have membrane permeabilising activity may be outer membrane permeabilisers that may target the outer membrane (or component thereof). Membrane permeabilisers may target an inner membrane (or component thereof). Membrane permeabilisers may target the outer leaflet, inner leaflet, both the outer and inner leaflet, and/or the inner membrane. For example, membrane permeabilisers may target the inner leaflet of the outer membrane and the inner membrane, but not the outer leaflet of the outer membrane. Alternatively, membrane permeabilisers may target only the outer leaflet of the outer membrane or only the inner leaflet of the outer membrane. Alternatively, membrane permeabilisers may target each leaflet of the outer membrane and the inner membrane.

[0085] The targeting of the outer leaflet, inner leaflet and/or inner membrane may be achieved by using multiple membrane permeabilisers. For example, a first membrane permeabiliser that targets the outer leaflet may be used in combination (for example, as a fusion peptide) with a second membrane permeabiliser that targets the inner leaflet. Alternatively, or additionally, a first membrane permeabiliser may target the outer leaflet, inner leaflet and inner membrane, and at least one further membrane permeabiliser is included that targets any one or more of these layers. Combinations of membrane permeabilisers are contemplated that may work additively or synergistically with each other. Accordingly, the requirement to target the outer leaflet, inner leaflet and inner membrane (if required for the target cell membrane and/or organism comprising said membrane) may be built up (and/or enhanced) by including multiple membrane permeabilisers, whether as multiple copies of the same membrane permeabilisers or as multiple different membrane permeabilisers.

[0086] In some embodiments, the membrane permeabiliser is an antimicrobial peptide (AMP) or portion thereof. The AMP or a portion thereof may be cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic, amphipathic, synthetic, natural, native or modified, or any combination thereof, whether from different origins (for example, bacteria, fungi, viruses, animals, insects, humans) or the same origin. For example, an AMP may be cationic. Alternatively, an AMP may be cationic in a portion and amphipathic in a different portion of the same AMP. Alternatively, or additionally, multiple AMPs with the same or different properties may be present in a peptide of the present invention.

[0087] In some embodiments, the membrane permeabiliser is associated with a non-AMP mechanism, for example the membrane permeabiliser may be at least one holin, as described above. Holins and AMPs may be used in combination.

[0088] A domain (e.g. a fourth domain) may correspond to a protein transduction domain (PTD). These may also be referred to as protein transducing domains. Such domains may be added to peptides of the present invention to facilitate transduction (e.g. protein/peptide transduction). By “transduction” we include the meaning that internalization is facilitated, or allowing the passage across a cell membrane or portion thereof. Further, a PTD may also be classified as a cell-penetrating peptide (CPP), which may be capable of targeting intracellularly components, including intracellular proteins. For example, a peptide further comprising a fourth domain that is at least one PTD/CPP (use of “PTD” herein is to be construed as also including “CPP”) may have improved transduction efficiency compared with the same peptide lacking such a domain. Key benefits to a PTD domain include, but are not limited to, improved efficacy of fusion proteins, improved transduction efficiency, improved safety, and/or improved stability. The targeting of mycobacteria by peptides may be facilitated by at least one PTD if the mycobacteria are present inside of cells, such as macrophages.

Example PTDs include those described in Bechra and Sagan, 2013. For example, the PTD may be protein-derived (such as Penetratin, Tat peptide, pVEC); chimeric (such as Transportan, MPG, Pep-1); and/or synthetic (such as Polyarginines, MAP, R.sub.6W.sub.3). Accordingly, in some embodiments, one or more PTD is selected from the group consisting of Penetratin, Tat peptide, pVEC, Transportan, MPG, Pep-1, Polyarginines, MAP, R.sub.6W.sub.3. In some embodiments, the PTDs are cationic poly-Arg containing PTDs, for example PTD3 and/or TAT.

[0089] Any of the above that references a particular domain is intended to also be reference to a fragment (e.g. a truncated version), variant (which includes mutants), fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof of said domain, in addition to any wildtype domains. For example, at least one membrane permeabiliser may be a fragment (e.g. a fragment with substantially the same function) of a membrane permeabiliser, combined with at least one wildtype LysA, at least one variant LysB and at least one wildtype PTD. Any of these domains (if present in the fusion protein) may be presented as any “version” (i.e. fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof, wildtype) without limitation to the version of any other domain that is present. Any domains described herein may be natural (i.e. wildtype) or synthetic domains.

[0090] Any domain referred to herein may be a fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof. In one embodiment, the variant has an amino acid sequence which has at least 50% identity with the amino acid sequence according to a reference sequence (for example, the amino acid sequences of SEQ ID NOS: 1-102, or SEQ ID NOS: 326 to 338), or a fragment thereof, for example at least 55%, 60%, 65%, 70%, 75%, 80%, 85%, 90%, 95%, 96%, 97%, 98% or at least 99% identity, optionally wherein the fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof retains substantially the same level of activity of the wildtype domain. Substantially the same level of activity may be at least 10%, 20%, 30%, 40%, 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, 95%, 96%, 97%, 98%, 99%, 100% or higher activity compared with the wildtype domain.

[0091] In some embodiments, the peptide corresponds to the amino acid sequence (or a nucleic acid sequence that encodes the amino acid sequence) according to any one or more of SEQ ID NOS: 147-311, or a fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof. In one embodiment, the variant has an amino acid sequence which has at least 50% identity with the amino acid sequence (or a nucleic acid sequence that encodes the amino acid sequence) according to SEQ ID NOS: 147-311), or a fragment thereof, for example at least 55%, 60%, 65%, 70%, 75%, 80%, 85%, 90%, 95%, 96%, 97%, 98% or at least 99% identity, optionally wherein the fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof retains substantially the same level of activity of the wildtype domain. Substantially the same level of activity may be at least 10%, 20%, 30%, 40%, 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, 95%, 96%, 97%, 98%, 99%, 100% or higher activity compared with the wildtype domain.

[0092] Accordingly, exemplary active constructs of the present invention may be selected from SEQ ID NOS: 147-311, some of which are included below, as follows:

TABLE-US-00004 Sequence Id1 (1B4) (SEQ ID NO: 147)

ATGCACCATCATCATCATCATCTTCTGGTGTAGATCTGGGTACCGAGAACCTGTACTTCCAATCCATGCGTGGC  
GGTTCGTCTGTGTTACTGCCGTCGCCGTTTCTGCGTGTGTGTTGGTTCGTGGTGCAAGCAAGCCCTGGCTGTTACCC  
GTTACGGCACGGGCCAGCCCGATCCCTCGGGCCTGGCCTGCCTGCCGATACGGCACGCGACGTACTTGACATC  
TACCGGTGGCAGCCCATCGGCAACTACCCCGCTGCGGCCTTCCCGATGTGGCCGTCGGTCGAGAAGGGTGTGCC  
GAGCTGATCCTGCAGATCGAGCTGAAGCTGGACGCGGACCCCTACGCGGACTTCGCGATGGCGGGTTACTCGCAG  
GGAGCCATCGTGGTTGGCCAGGTGCTCAAGCACCACATCCTGCCTCCGACGGGCAGGCTCCACAGGTTCTCTGCAC  
CGGCTCAAGAAGGTCATCTTCTGGGGTAATCCCATGCGGCAGAAAGGGCTTTGCCCACTCTGACGAGTGGATCCAC  
CCGGTCGCTGCCCTGACACCCTCGGAATCCTCGAGGACCGGCTCGAAAACCTGGAGCAGTACGGCTTCGAGGTC  
CGCGACTACGCCCACGACGGTGACATGTACGCCTCCATCAAAGAGGACGACCTGCACGAATACGAGGTGCGCCATC  
GGCCGATCGTGATGAAGGCCAGCGGCTTCATCGGTGGCCGGGACTCCGTGGTAGCCAGCTCATCGAGCTTGGC  
CAGCGTCCGATCACCGAGGGAATTGCGTTGGCGGGAGCCATCATCGACGCCCTCACGTTCTTCGCCCGCTCTCGT  
ATGGGCGACAAGTGGCCGCACCTCTACAACCGCTACCCGGCGGTTCGAGTTCCTACGACAGATCGCAGGTCCAGCC  
GTTCCACCTCCGGGAAGCTCATTTACGCGCTTTCTCCAAGACGATCCCTTGCTGACTCGTGAACAGGTAATGGCA  
GAACTCATCCGCGTTGCTGATGATGAATTGAATATGCCTGATAAACGTGGAGCATGTGTGATCGCAGGAATGACT  
ATCTCACAGGAAGTTGGTGTGAAAGATAATGATCCCCATTTGAACGCCGTTTCTGGTGTCCAGCAAATCGTGCG  
GATCCAGAGTCTTTAATTATCCACATGATAGTGAGTCCAATGATGGACGTTTCAGTGGGGTATTTTCAACAACAA  
AAGGGCCCAAATGGTGAACCTTTGGTGGGGCACTACCGCGAGTGAAATGAATTTACATAGTGCAGCCACCCAATTC  
ATGACTCGTTTAAAAGCCGCGGGTTATAATGCCTCTAATGCGCAAGCCGCAAATGATTCTGCTCAAGCTATTCAA  
CGTTCAGGTGTTCCACAAGCCTATAAACAGTGGTGGGATGATATCAATCGTTTATATGATAAAGTAAAAGGTAGC  
GGCGGCGGACCCGCACCGGCTCCCAAACCACTCAAAGCGGTCCTTGGAAGTGGTATCCTGTTTGGTTAGCAGAT  
GTATTACGTGCAGAAGGCTTGAATGTTGTTGAACTCCCTGGTTGGTTAGATCGTGGTCATGGAGATATGGGTCTGT  
CTGTGGGGCGTCGTATGTCACCATACTGGTAGTGACAATACTCCAAGCTCTGAAATCGCATTCCATCCCAGCCTG  
GGTCTTTGTTCCCAAATCCATCTTGCCCGTAATGGTACGGTTACACTTTGTGGCGTTGGTATTGCGTGGCACGCA  
GGAGTGGGATCGTACCCGGGGTTGCCGGAAGATAATGCAAATGCCGTGACAATTGGTATTGAAGCACAAAATTGCG  
GGTACATACGATGGTGCTCCTCATCGCACCAACTGGCCGGATGCACAGTATGATGCGTACGTCAAATGTTGTGCG  
GCTATTTGTCTGTCGTCTGGGAGTCCGTGCAGACCATGTAATTTTCGCATAAAGAGTGGGCGGGCCGTAAACAGGGT  
AAGTGGGACCCGGGAGCGATTGATATGAATATTTTCCGTGCGGATGTTCAACGTCGTATTGATGCGCACCAAGCCG

AATGGTGAAGATGACTTTATGATGGCGGCTCTGAGCGCGGATGAACGATGAAGTTTGAATCTTTTGAAGTCTGTTTAA  
GCGGATCGCCGCTTTGTGAGTCGTTACCTTTTCGTCATCTCGGTGAAGGTCCATCCGAGACGGTAGCGGGCTTT  
GGTTTAAATACGGATGGACTGAACCATGCTCAATATACCATCGAACTCGCACGTCTCGGGGATCCTACCCATTTA  
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LVVPPPYTNGRPGISDHRWVTDVFKWGTHTDVGDWFPWDYFAERNVHWANGGKTEPEPPKVKRFPDDWSDREILV  
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TAATAG Sequence Id6 (SEQ ID NO: 152)

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DRALAVGNDLLKLLDGE EGFLSALTPKEQRELYDEIMKRGPSRSFLADDGRQIETLLGFIYNIDGNAWNIVNIL  
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Sequence Id7 (1C9) (SEQ ID NO: 153)

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TAG Sequence Id8 (SEQ ID NO: 154)

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GSYPWLPTNMGNWHLIGIECEWPYGEPIGNERNAYTVRWRDPEIIALRNTCAAILRLGLGVDRLIGHKDYAGRA  
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SKLAVDGDGDFPHTEACVRDRQRIYGLDVGIVGLPLTAAKIGLVLG Sequence Id9 (1E10) (SEQ ID  
NO: 155)

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 GGTGGAGTGGCCCCGCATCTTCATGTAAGTACTGGCCACATGCGTATGGGCAAGGCAGCCGTCAAATGTGATG  
 GCACGCTTGAGTGGAGCCCCGCGAGCCAGAAGCCCAAGCGGCCCAACCCCCACAGAGCAAGGCACTGTTGTTGGT  
 GACCCGGTTTTGGTTGGCGGATGTAGTGCGCCCAACTGTAGCTAAATTTGCGGAGTATCCTGGCTGGCGTAATCGT  
 GGTACGGTGATTTTAAGGATATCCGTGGAGTTATGGTTCATCATACAGGTGGGCCCCGCTCTGCAGCCTCAATT  
 GCGAATGGCCGCCCAGACCTTGCCGGCCCTCTTGACAGCTGCATATTTGCGGTGATGGGACAGTTACTGTGCTA  
 GCTGTAGGAGTGGCTTGGCATGCGGGTGCAGGCAGCTATCCATGGTTACCGACCAACATGGGTAATTGGCACTTG  
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 GATCCAGAGATTATTGCGCTGCGTAATACATGTGCGGCAATTTTACTGCGCCTTGGCCTCGGGGTAGATCGCCTG  
 ATTGGCCATAAGGATTATGCCGGCCGTGCTCAAGGCAAGTGGGACCCGGGAAATATGAGCATGGACTGGCTGCGT  
 GCGGAGGTGCGTAAAGATATGGATGGCTTTGTATTTCCCGGTGAGGATATTGTAAATGTGACCCCGCCACCAGTC  
 CCGGCCCCCTGTCCCTGCCCCGCCAGCGACTGCGAATGTTCTTCTCCATCGTGGTATGAGTGGACCTAATGTTGTC  
 AAATTACAGACAAGCTCTCCGTGCTTGGTATTCAAACTGGCGGTAGACGGTGATTTTGGCCCCCATAACAGAGGCA  
 TGTGTACGCGATCGCCAACGCATTTATGGGTGGACGTGGATGGTATTGTCGGACCATTAAGTGGGCCAAAATC  
 GGCCTGGTTTTTGGGCTCATAATAGTGATAATAG Sequence Id12 (SEQ ID NO: 158)  
 MHHHHHHSSGVDLGTENLYFQSMGIGKFLKAKKFGASKPWLFTHVHTGQPDPLGPLPADTARDVLDIYRWQPI  
 GNYPAAAFPMWPSVEKGVAELILQIELKLDADPYADFALAGYSQGAIVVGQVLKHHIINPRGLHRLHRLRKVI  
 FWGNPMRQKGFAHTDEWIHQVAASDTMGILEDRLLENLEQYGFVDRDYAHDGDMYASIKEDDMHEYEVAIGRIVMS  
 ARRFIGGKDSVIAQLIELGQRPIWEGIAMARAIIDALTFFAKSTQGPSWPHLYNRFPAVEFLRRIAGLSRFFHAE  
 LGSPVYAIQSGTVIYAGAASGYGGPDPAGWLVIDSDDAEGGGCLEYGHIVREVNRGDHVTAGQRIGHINPNRNTN  
 GGVAPHLHVTDWPHAYGQGSRQNVMARLSGAREPEAQAAPTPTAQGTVVGDVWLADVVRPTVAKFAEYPGWRNR  
 GHGDFKDIRGVMVHHTGGPASAASIANGRPDLAQLHISRDTVTTVAVGVAVHAGAGSYPWLPTNMGNWHL  
 IGIECEWPYPGEPGINERNAYTVRWRDPEIALLRLGLGVDRDLIGHKDYAGRAQGWDPGNMSMDWLR  
 GEVRKDMMDGFVFPGEDIVNVTPPPVPAPVPAPPATANVLLHRGMSGPNVVKLQTTLRRWYSKLAVDGDGFGPHTEA  
 CVRDRQRIYGLDVGIVGPLTAAKIGLVLS Sequence Id13 (1H4) (SEQ ID NO: 159)  
 ATGCACCATCATCATCATCATCTTCTTCTGGTGTAGATCTGGGTACCGAGAACCTGTACTTCCAATCCATGTTCTTC  
 CATCATATTTTCCGCGGCAAAGTCCATGTGGGCAAGACCATTCATCGCTTAGTAACGGGTGGTGCCTTCTAAGCCT  
 GTGCTGTTGACTGCTAGTGGGACGGGTGCGGATATGTGGTCTGGATATCCGGCGGATCTTGGCGCTCGCGTCTGAG  
 GACCTTTACTACTTTTACGCAATCTACTATGGTCCAGGTGGGATTCCGGCGACGGTACCAATGGGGGCGAGCGCA  
 CAGTCTGGCGTAGATATGGGAGTACGTCTGGTACTGGAGTGCAGAGGCTCGTCCGTCGCGCGACGTCCCTGATGGG  
 TATGCCTTGTGTGGCTACTCTCAAGGGGGCATGGTTGTATCCGCGTTGTTGGACGAGTTTCGCACGGGGCCGCTT  
 CGCCACTTGAATGGCAAATTGATGGCGGGCAGCACCTTTGGAACCCCGTGGCGCGAGCTTGATTCTAACGGCGGG  
 CGCGGCATCAGCGACCGTTCGCATTGTGGGGACCCCCGACTTCTGGGTGGATGAGTTCGACCCAGGAGACATTTAT

CGCAACGTCGATGCTAACAATGATGTCGGGGATGATGATGTCCTGACAGCTGCGCTCACTGCT  
GACCTGATCGGTATTGGATCGATTATGGATCGCGTAATGGACGTTCTTCGCGGCCCATTTGAGCGGGATGCGCTCC  
GTAGTTGAGGCGATTGTTTCGTGGCTTATTATTTTTTCGGCCGTAAGCCGCCAACAGCGCCCCATACAGAGTACCAT  
TTGCGCGAGGTCCGTCCGGGAGTGACGTATTTTGAACATGCAGTCGCCCCACATGCGCGCTATGGCCGCCGAGGT  
CCAGCCGTTCCACCTCCGGGAAGCCCTGTCTATGCGATTCACTCTGGAAGTGTATTATTTACGCCGGTGCCGCATCG  
GGATATGGTGGTCTTGACCCTGCAGGCTGGCTTGTATTATTCTGATGATGCCGAGGGTGGCGGCTGTTTAGAG  
TATGGTCATATTGTCCGTGAGGTAAATCGTGGTGATCATGTGACGGCGGGTCAACGTATTGGACATATTAATCCA  
AATAATCGTACGAATGGTGGAGTGGCCCCGCATCTTCATGTAAGTACTGAGTGGCCACATGCGTATGGGCAAGGCAGC  
CGTCAAAATGTGATGGCACGCTTGAGTGGAGCCCCGCGAGCCAGAAGCCCAAGCGGCCCAACCCCCACAGAGCAA  
GGCACTGTTGTTGGTGACCCGTTTGGTTGGCGGATGTAGTGCGCCCAACTGTAGCTAAATTTGCGGAGTATCCT  
GGCTGGCGTAATCGTGGTCACGGTGATTTTAAAGGATATCCGTGGAGTTATGGTTCATCATACAGGTGGGCCCCGCC  
TCTGCAGCCTCAATTGCGAATGGCCGCCAGACCTTGCCGGCCCTCTTGACAGCTGCATATTTGCGGTGATGGG  
ACAGTTACTGTCGTAGCTGTAGGAGTGGCTTGGCATGCGGGTGCAGGCAGCTATCCATGGTTACCGACCAACATG  
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ACAGTACGCTGGCGTGATCCAGAGATTATTGCGCTGCGTAATACATGTGCGGCAATTTTACTGCGCTTGGCCTC  
GGGGTAGATCGCCTGATTGGCCATAAGGATTATGCCGGCCGTGCTCAAGGCAAGTGGGACCCGGGAAATATGAGC  
ATGGACTGGCTGCGTGGCGAGGTGCGTAAAGATATGGATGGCTTTGTATTTCCCGGTGAGGATATTGTAAATGTG  
ACCCCGCCACCAGTCCCGGCCCTGTCCCTGCCCCGCCAGCGACTGCGAATGTTCTTCTCCATCGTGGTATGAGT  
GGACCTAATGTTGTCAAATTACAGACAACCTCTCCGTCGTTGGTATTCAAAGTGGCGGTAGACGGTGATTTTGGC  
CCCCATACAGAGGCATGTGTACGCGATCGCCAACGCATTTATGGGTGGACGTGGATGGTATTGTGCGGACCATT  
ACTGCGGCCAAAATCGGCCTGGTTTTGGGCTCATAATAGTATAATAG Sequence Id14 (SEQ ID NO:  
160)

MHHHHHHSSGVDLGTENLYFQSMFFHHIFRGKVHVHGKTIHRLVTGGASKPVLLTASGTGADMWSGYPADLARRVE  
DLYYFQPIYYGPGGIPATVPMGASASQSGVDMGVRLVLECEARPSRDVPDGYALCGYSQGGMVVSALLDEFRTGRL  
RHLNGKLMAGSTFGNPWRELDNSNGGRGISDRRIVGTPDFWVDEFDPGDIYANVPNNVGDMDTAIFKLVQLRSLA  
DLIGIGSIMDRVMDVLRGPLSGMRSVVEAIVRGLLFFGRKPPTAPHTEYHLREVRPGVTYFEHAVAHMRAMAAAG  
PAVPPPGSPVYAIQSGTVIYAGAASGYGGPDAGWLVIDSDDAEGGGCLEYGHIVREVNRGDHVTAGQRIGHINP  
NNRTNGGVAPHLHVTDWPHAYGQSRQNVMARLSGAREPEAQAAAPTPTQGTVVGDVWLADVVVRPTVAKFAEYP  
GWRNRGHGDFKDIRGVMVHHTGGPASAASIANGRPDLAQLHISRDGTVTVAVGVAVHWAGAGSYPLPTNM  
GNWHLIGIECEWPYGEPIGNERNAYTVRWRDPEIHALRNTCAAILRLGLGVDRLIGHKDYAGRAQGWDPGNMS  
MDWLRGEVRKDMMDGFVFPGEDIVNVTPPPVPAPVPAPPATANVLLHRGMSGPNVVKLQTTLRWYSKLAVDGDG  
PHTEACVRDRQRIYGLDVGIVGLPLTAAKIGLVLS Sequence 4D10 (SEQ ID NO: 292)  
WRSLGRTLRLSHALKPLARRSGWMSKPWLFTVHGTGQPDPLGPGLPADTARDVLDIYRWQPIGNYPAAAFPMWP  
SVEKGVAELILQIELKLDADPYADFAMAGYSQGAIVVGQVLKHHILPPTGRLHRFLHRLKKVIFWGNPMRQKGFA  
HSDEWIHPVAAPDTLGILEDRLNLEQYGFVDRDYAHDGDMYASIKEDDLHEYEVAGRIVMKASGFIGGRDSVV  
AQLIELGQRPITEGIALAGAIIDALTTFFARSRMGDKWPHLYNRYPAVEFLRQIAGAGAGMSFTRFLQDDPLLTRE  
QVMAELIRVADELNMPDKRGACVIAGMTISQEVGVKDNNDPPFERRFWCPANRADPESFNYPHDSNDGRSVGYF  
QQQKGPNGELWWGTTASEMNLHSAATQFMTRLKAAGYNASNAQAANDSAQAIQRSGVPQAYKQWWDDINRLYDKV  
KSGGGPAPAPKPPQSGPWTGDPVWLADVLRAEGLNVVELPGWLDRGHGDMGRLWGVVCHHTGSDNTPSSEIAFH  
PSLGLCSQIHLARNGTVTLCGVGIAWHAGVGSYPGLPEDNANAVTIGIEAQNSGTYDGAPHRTNWPDAQYDAYVK  
CCAAICRRLGVRADHVISHKEWAGRKQGWDPGAIDMNIFRADVQRRIDAHQPNGEDDFMAALSADEQREVLNLL  
RVLADRRFVSRSPFRHLGEGPSETVAGFGLNTDGLNHAQYTIELARLGDPHTLALLREVASAEGDSRYPPDRQYDA  
KLAKRVLAEIEGAATAPAKPSTPSAPTEPAPEAPTTPVKAACALSAAGCVVAGSTSGGGCALSTDGTGKCVVTAA  
TDGGAA Sequence 4D10 in reverse (SEQ ID NO: 312)

MSFTRFLQDDPLLTREQVMAELIRVADELNMPDKRGACVIAGMTISQEVGVKDNNDPPFERRFWCPANRADPESEN  
YPHDSNDGRSVGYFQQQKGPNGELWWGTTASEMNLHSAATQFMTRLKAAGYNASNAQAANDSAQAIQRSGVPQ  
AYKQWWDDINRLYDKVKSGGGPAPAPKPPQSGPWTGDPVWLADVLRAEGLNVVELPGWLDRGHGDMGRLWGVV  
HHTGSDNTPSSEIAFHPSLGLCSQIHLARNGTVTLCGVGIAWHAGVGSYPGLPEDNANAVTIGIEAQNSGTYDGA  
PHRTNWPDAQYDAYVKCCAAICRRLGVRADHVISHKEWAGRKQGWDPGAIDMNIFRADVQRRIDAHQPNGEDDE  
MAALSADEQREVLNLLRVLADRRFVSRSPFRHLGEGPSETVAGFGLNTDGLNHAQYTIELARLGDPHTLALLREV  
ASAEGDSRYPPDRQYDAKLAKRVLAEIEGAATAPAKPSTPSAPTEPAPEAPTTPVKAACALSAAGCVVAGSTSGGG  
CALSTDGTGKCVVTAATDGGAAAGAGAGMSKPWLFTVHGTGQPDPLGPGLPADTARDVLDIYRWQPIGNYPAAAF  
PMWPSVEKGVAELILQIELKLDADPYADFAMAGYSQGAIVVGQVLKHHILPPTGRLHRFLHRLKKVIFWGNPMRQ  
KGFAHSDEWIHPVAAPDTLGILEDRLNLEQYGFVDRDYAHDGDMYASIKEDDLHEYEVAGRIVMKASGFIGGR  
DSVVAQLIELGQRPITEGIALAGAIIDALTTFFARSRMGDKWPHLYNRYPAVEFLRQIWRSLGRTLRLSHALKPL  
ARRSGW

[0093] Fusion peptides of the invention may optionally comprise a purification fusion tag, e.g.

MHHHHHHSSGVDLGTENLYFQS (SEQ ID NO: 339). The skilled person will appreciate that inclusion of such a purification fusion tag is optional, and the scope of the invention encompasses sequences including these fusion tags, or corresponding sequences with the fusion tags removed. Additionally, the skilled person will appreciate that any suitable fusion tag can be used as an alternative.

[0094] A peptide according to the present invention may be selected from any one or more of libraries 1-3 and 12-16. In some embodiments, the peptide according to the present invention may be selected from library 1, for example selected from the group consisting of SEQ ID NOS: 147-160, 201-265, 267-270, 272, 273, 275-308 and 311. In other embodiments, the peptide according to the present invention may be selected from library 12, for example selected from the group consisting of SEQ ID NOS: 161-200, 266, 271, 274, 309 and 310.

[0095] A peptide according to the present invention may be selected from the exemplary peptides in Table A.

TABLE-US-00005 TABLE A Exemplary peptides of the invention. The following table includes in the white row a combination of four SEQ ID NOS (e.g. the first cell is a combination of SEQ ID NOS: 58, 12, 108 and 16), and the cell immediately underneath the combination denotes the SEQ ID NO for the corresponding fusion protein (e.g. the first cell as a fusion protein corresponds to SEQ ID NO: 161). 58 + 12 + 108 + 16 36 + 18 + 106 + 6 36 + 32 + 110 + 2 42 + 20 + 112 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 161 SEQ ID NO: 199 SEQ ID NO: 237 SEQ ID NO: 275 46 + 8 + 112 + 32 92 + 20 + 106 + 14 76 + 16 + 110 + 14 56 + 22 + 106 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 162 SEQ ID NO: 200 SEQ ID NO: 238 SEQ ID NO: 276 36 + 14 + 110 + 20 40 + 28 + 106 + 2 90 + 24 + 104 + 14 38 + 22 + 110 + 2 SEQ ID NO: 163 SEQ ID NO: 201 SEQ ID NO: 239 SEQ ID NO: 277 76 + 2 + 106 + 30 36 + 20 + 108 + 10 36 + 32 + 110 + 14 98 + 24 + 106 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 164 SEQ ID NO: 202 SEQ ID NO: 240 SEQ ID NO: 278 36 + 14 + 112 + 28 36 + 16 + 106 + 12 82 + 28 + 104 + 14 36 + 24 + 110 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 165 SEQ ID NO: 203 SEQ ID NO: 241 SEQ ID NO: 279 100 + 12 + 110 + 32 42 + 18 + 112 + 10 58 + 22 + 104 + 12 36 + 18 + 110 + 2 SEQ ID NO: 166 SEQ ID NO: 204 SEQ ID NO: 242 SEQ ID NO: 280 46 + 10 + 104 + 32 50 + 16 + 112 + 2 44 + 20 + 108 + 2 36 + 26 + 112 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 167 SEQ ID NO: 205 SEQ ID NO: 243 SEQ ID NO: 281 88 + 14 + 108 + 28 36 + 26 + 112 + 2 66 + 20 + 110 + 10 72 + 22 + 106 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 168 SEQ ID NO: 206 SEQ ID NO: 244 SEQ ID NO: 282 38 + 14 + 104 + 18 48 + 16 + 112 + 14 36 + 34 + 112 + 10 36 + 26 + 106 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 169 SEQ ID NO: 207 SEQ ID NO: 245 SEQ ID NO: 283 42 + 12 + 108 + 28 66 + 20 + 114 + 10 80 + 16 + 108 + 2 58 + 28 + 106 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 170 SEQ ID NO: 208 SEQ ID NO: 246 SEQ ID NO: 284 96 + 2 + 110 + 18 102 + 16 + 108 + 10 44 + 20 + 106 + 14 44 + 30 + 108 + 6 SEQ ID NO: 171 SEQ ID NO: 209 SEQ ID NO: 247 SEQ ID NO: 285 44 + 10 + 104 + 18 100 + 18 + 112 + 12 74 + 28 + 112 + 14 52 + 16 + 112 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 172 SEQ ID NO: 210 SEQ ID NO: 248 SEQ ID NO: 286 64 + 10 + 112 + 30 92 + 28 + 106 + 14 36 + 20 + 112 + 10 46 + 30 + 104 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 173 SEQ ID NO: 211 SEQ ID NO: 249 SEQ ID NO: 287 68 + 12 + 106 + 18 36 + 18 + 110 + 14 38 + 26 + 112 + 10 44 + 22 + 110 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 174 SEQ ID NO: 212 SEQ ID NO: 250 SEQ ID NO: 288 100 + 12 + 104 + 16 58 + 20 + 110 + 14 36 + 20 + 112 + 4 38 + 32 + 106 + 12 SEQ ID NO: 175 SEQ ID NO: 213 SEQ ID NO: 251 SEQ ID NO: 289 88 + 8 + 110 + 20 40 + 32 + 104 + 14 52 + 20 + 108 + 2 40 + 16 + 112 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 176 SEQ ID NO: 214 SEQ ID NO: 252 SEQ ID NO: 290 98 + 8 + 110 + 24 102 + 34 + 112 + 10 36 + 24 + 112 + 10 38 + 24 + 114 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 177 SEQ ID NO: 215 SEQ ID NO: 253 SEQ ID NO: 291 92 + 12 + 104 + 18 48 + 16 + 104 + 2 38 + 20 + 110 + 2 38 + 16 + 104 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 178 SEQ ID NO: 216 SEQ ID NO: 254 SEQ ID NO: 292 100 + 12 + 104 + 16 40 + 20 + 106 + 14 42 + 20 + 110 + 14 98 + 34 + 112 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 179 SEQ ID NO: 217 SEQ ID NO: 255 SEQ ID NO: 293 52 + 2 + 112 + 30 36 + 18 + 112 + 14 78 + 16 + 104 + 14 66 + 20 + 112 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 180 SEQ ID NO: 218 SEQ ID NO: 256 SEQ ID NO: 294 44 + 6 + 110 + 30 38 + 16 + 112 + 4 38 + 22 + 112 + 2 36 + 30 + 112 + 6 SEQ ID NO: 181 SEQ ID NO: 219 SEQ ID NO: 257 SEQ ID NO: 295 38 + 10 + 112 + 16 86 + 20 + 106 + 14 38 + 34 + 108 + 14 36 + 16 + 112 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 182 SEQ ID NO: 220 SEQ ID NO: 258 SEQ ID NO: 296 94 + 10 + 108 + 16 96 + 16 + 106 + 10 36 + 26 + 104 + 10 94 + 30 + 106 + 4 SEQ ID NO: 183 SEQ ID NO: 221 SEQ ID NO: 259 SEQ ID NO: 297 52 + 2 + 112 + 16 44 + 26 + 110 + 10 86 + 30 + 104 + 14 90 + 16 + 112 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 184 SEQ ID NO: 222 SEQ ID NO: 260 SEQ ID NO: 298 96 + 6 + 112 + 22 40 + 32 + 110 + 2 36 + 26 + 106 + 6 40 + 24 + 110 + 6 SEQ ID NO: 185 SEQ ID NO: 223 SEQ ID NO: 261 SEQ ID NO: 299 98 + 10 + 108 + 18 38 + 16 + 104 + 4 40 + 26 + 110 + 8 36 + 24 + 104 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 186 SEQ ID NO: 224 SEQ ID NO: 262 SEQ ID NO: 300 56 + 2 + 104 + 32 36 + 20 + 106 + 12 36 + 28 + 112 + 10 38 + 24 + 104 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 187 SEQ ID NO: 225 SEQ ID NO: 263 SEQ ID NO: 301 68 + 8 + 104 + 18 48 + 34 + 110 + 14 36 + 20 + 104 + 14 36 + 20 + 104 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 188 SEQ ID NO: 226 SEQ ID NO: 264 SEQ ID NO: 302 44 + 6 + 112 + 32 38 + 30 + 112 + 14 78 + 20 + 104 + 10 38 + 18 + 108 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 189 SEQ ID NO: 227 SEQ ID NO: 265 SEQ ID NO: 303 52 + 6 + 112 + 24 38 + 18 + 106 + 10 52 + 14 + 104 + 28 96 + 32 + 104 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 190 SEQ ID NO: 228 SEQ ID NO: 266 SEQ ID NO: 304 42 + 12 + 110 + 26 36 + 26 + 112 + 2 58 + 24 + 104 + 14 66 + 20 + 108 + 12 SEQ ID NO: 191 SEQ ID NO: 229 SEQ ID NO: 267 SEQ ID NO: 305 40 + 2 + 110 + 24 36 + 20 + 106 + 14 66 + 20 + 110 + 6 36 + 32 + 104 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 192 SEQ ID NO: 230 SEQ ID NO: 268 SEQ ID NO: 306 60 + 2 + 104 + 18 36 + 24 + 110 + 10 86 + 16 + 110 + 2 52 + 22 + 108 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 193 SEQ ID NO: 231 SEQ ID NO: 269 SEQ ID NO: 307 38 + 4 + 110 + 26 36 + 18 + 104 + 2 86 + 34 + 112 + 10 36 + 22 + 110 + 10 SEQ ID NO: 194 SEQ ID NO: 232 SEQ ID NO: 270 SEQ ID NO: 308 62 + 10 + 104 + 32 76 + 26 + 104 + 4 36 + 14 + 106 + 28 68 + 6 + 104 + 16 SEQ ID NO: 195 SEQ ID NO: 233 SEQ ID NO: 271 SEQ ID NO: 309 40 + 14 + 106 + 18 36 + 20 + 106 + 2 36 + 22 + 110 + 2 92 + 2 + 106 + 18 SEQ ID NO: 196 SEQ ID NO: 234 SEQ ID NO: 272 SEQ ID NO: 310 62 + 8 + 110 + 24 58 + 30 + 110 + 10 44 + 26 + 110 + 10 36 + 28 + 110 + 14 SEQ ID NO: 197 SEQ ID NO: 235 SEQ ID NO: 273 SEQ ID NO: 311 88 + 8 + 108 + 28 38 + 20 + 112 + 14 98 + 12 + 106 + 28 14 + 104 + 16 + 38 SEQ ID NO: 198 SEQ ID NO: 236 SEQ ID NO: 274 SEQ ID NO: 312

[0096] A peptide according to the present invention may be used in combination with any one or more different peptides according to the present invention.

[0097] A fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof may comprise or consist of at least 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90, 100,

120, 140, 160, 180, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700, 800, 900, 1000, 1100, 1200, 1300, 1400, 1500 or 1600 contiguous amino acids of the wildtype domain.

[0098] Peptides of the present invention, including fragments, variants, fusions or derivatives thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivatives thereof, may be prepared using known protein engineering techniques. Protein engineering is the field that mimics natural evolution in the lab and aims for the development of proteins with designed features. Protein engineering techniques can be subdivided in mutagenesis and shuffling. In mutagenesis single or multiple nucleotides are substituted/deleted/added, whereas in shuffling longer DNA fragments are exchanged (Harayama, 1998). These techniques serve as tools for directed evolution of proteins, i.e., the creation of diversity by either mutagenesis or shuffling, followed by the selection of variants with desired features (Cobb et al., 2013; Lane & Seelig, 2014).

[0099] Both mutagenesis and shuffling can be performed in a rational manner. For site-directed mutagenesis this means the creation of site-directed point mutations, whereas for shuffling this implies the assembly of predefined gene fragments by restriction and ligation (Tee & Wong, 2013). In contrast, random mutagenesis creates randomly distributed mutations over the length of a selected DNA sequence. For example, error-prone PCR uses modified PCR parameters (DNA polymerase fidelity, dNTP, Mg.sup.2+ and Mn.sup.2+ concentrations) to introduce random mutations during amplification (Pritchard et al., 2005). Unlike mutagenesis, random shuffling is until today only possible for highly homologous genes (>70% similarity) (Nordwald et al., 2013). E.g., family shuffling uses DnaseI to randomly digest members of the same gene family followed by recombination between homologous regions and creation of a hybrid gene (Cramer et al., 1998).

[0100] An alternative method, Golden Gate shuffling, has been developed by (Engler et al., 2009) to shuffle both rationally and randomly fragments of homologous genes. Herein, Type II restriction enzymes inherent ability to directionally cut outside their recognition site is exploited to reduce both restriction and ligation to a one step, one pot reaction (Engler et al., 2009; Engler et al., 2008). This method can be used to simultaneously clone multiple fragments with a high efficiency. However, Golden Gate shuffling is limited in that only one variant of a peptide can be created at a time, which causes time limitations and is lab/labour intensive.

[0101] VersaTile shuffling has now been developed to efficiently shuffle and assemble fragments from non-homologous genes (Grimon et al., 2019), which can be used to develop libraries of peptides. Due to technological constraints the high-throughput rational and random assembly of nonhomologous genes was before not yet possible without reliance on time-consuming techniques, such as Golden Gate assembly. VersaTile shuffling, which is optimized for high yield in a shorter time, thus expands the possibilities of protein engineering towards the shuffling of non-homologous genes, hereby enabling the creation of totally new hybrid proteins with new protein functionalities. This novel technique can be exploited to generate and clone an unprecedented amount of new modular fusion peptides, for example those of the present invention. New fusion peptides falling within the scope of the present invention can therefore be generated starting from a repository of different Tiles (e.g. AMPs, LysB, LysA, optionally connected together via linkers).

[0102] Peptides of the present invention, including fragments, variants, fusions or derivatives thereof, or a fusion of said fragment, variant or derivatives thereof, may be purified using known purification techniques, thereby obtaining an isolated peptide, fragment, variant, fusion or derivative thereof, or an isolated fusion of said fragment, variant or derivative thereof. For example, purification may be by affinity chromatography, ion exchange chromatography, hydrophobic interactions, multimodal chromatography, gel filtration and/or size exclusion. In some embodiments, purification is by affinity chromatography, for example Immobilized Metal Affinity Chromatography (IMAC). The skilled person will appreciate that any suitable IMAC matrix can be used, for example a nickel column. In some embodiments, purification may be performed by using a HisTrap FF™ nickel column (GE Healthcare Bio-Sciences AB, Uppsala, Sweden).

[0103] At a minimum, the present invention refers to a peptide comprising three domains, wherein the domains have: (i) activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof (a first domain); (ii) activity specific to an ester linkage (a second domain); and (iii) membrane permeabilising activity (a third domain). However, the peptide may further comprise additional domains that correspond to a first, second and/or third domain. For example, a peptide may comprise at least one first domain, at least one second domain, and at least one third domain. For example, a peptide may comprise two (or more) first domains without limitation to the number of second or third domains (e.g. 1, 2, or more) are present.

[0104] The arrangement of the domains may be in any order. Thus, the term “first position” in exemplary embodiments below merely refers to the first domain in a chain of domains that make up the peptides of the present invention. The nomenclature of first, second, third, fourth position and so on is merely to illustrate an optional order for the domains within a peptide.

[0105] For example, a peptide may comprise the first, second and third domains in any of the following orders (positions in order from N to C terminal): [0106] (i) third domain-second domain-first domain (e.g. AMP-LysB-LysA) [0107] (ii) third domain-first domain-second domain (e.g. AMP-LysA-LysB) [0108] (iii) first domain-second domain-third domain (e.g. LysA-LysB-AMP) [0109] (iv) second domain-first domain-third domain (e.g. LysB-LysA-AMP) [0110] (v) first domain-third domain-second domain (e.g. LysA-AMP-LysB); or [0111] (vi) second domain-third domain-first domain (e.g. LysB-AMP-LysA)

[0112] Additionally, as discussed in more detail below, multiple copies or versions of each domain may be present, for example there may be multiple first domains in the peptide and/or multiple second domains in the peptide and/or multiple

third domains in the peptide.

[0113] Thus, in example embodiments, a peptide may be comprised of the following domains from N-terminal to C-terminal:

TABLE-US-00006 First Second Third Fourth Fifth position position position position Third domain Second domain First domain — — (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysB) (e.g. LysA) Third domain Second domain First domain Fourth domain — (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysB) (e.g. LysA) (e.g. PTD) Third domain First domain Second domain — — (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysA) (e.g. LysB) First domain Third domain Third domain Second domain — (e.g. LysA) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysB) Fourth domain Third domain First domain Second domain Third domain (e.g. PTD) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysA) (e.g. LysB) (e.g. AMP) Second domain Fourth domain Third domain First domain — (e.g. LysB) (e.g. PTD) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysA) Third domain Third domain Third domain First domain Second domain (e.g. AMP) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysA) (e.g. LysB) First domain Second domain First domain Third domain Fourth domain (e.g. LysA) (e.g. LysB) (e.g. LysA) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. PTD) Second domain First domain Third domain — — (e.g. LysB) (e.g. LysA) (e.g. AMP) First domain Second domain Third domain — — (e.g. LysA) (e.g. LysB) (e.g. AMP) Second domain Third domain First domain — — (e.g. LysB) (e.g. AMP) (e.g. LysA)

[0114] Accordingly, the domains are interchangeable within the peptides provided the minimum three domains are present, as described above. Additional domains, including repeats of the type of domain, or linkers may be introduced at the N-terminus, C-terminus, and/or between any of the first, second, third, fourth or fifth positions above. In some embodiments, a peptide may comprise a linker between every domain in each position above, but not present at the C- or N-terminus. In some embodiments, a peptide may comprise no linkers. In some embodiments, a peptide may comprise only one linker between two domains. In some embodiments, the LysA may be in the form of an EAD derived from the LysA. Exemplary EAD include amino acid sequences corresponding to SEQ ID NOS: 326-338, as encoded by the nucleic acid sequences corresponding to SEQ ID NOs: 313-325, respectively.

[0115] In some embodiments, the peptide may comprise at least one first domain (e.g. at least one LysA), at least one second domain (e.g. LysB) and at least one third domain (membrane permeabiliser, e.g. an AMP or holin). In some embodiments, the peptide may comprise at least one first domain (e.g. LysA), at least one second domain (e.g. LysB), and at least one third domain (membrane permeabiliser), optionally further comprising at least one fourth domain (PTD/CPP). Either of these embodiments, or any further embodiments described herein, may further comprise at least one linker at any position between domains.

[0116] In some embodiments, a peptide may comprise multiple iterations of a particular domain (or of multiple domains, including multiple iterations of all domains). For example, a peptide may comprise 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, or more domains with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof (first domain); 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, or more domains with activity specific to an ester linkage (second domain); and/or 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, or more domains with membrane permeabilising activity (third domain); and/or 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, or more protein transduction domains (PTDs). Each domain may be in any order and thus fused to any other domain (either directly or indirectly). By “directly” we include the meaning that the domains are fused to each other without a linker between each domain. By “indirectly” we include the meaning that the domains are fused to each other either via a linker or via at least one other domain in-between. For example, at least one LysA could be indirectly linked to at least one AMP via at least one LysB, or via at least one linker.

[0117] When multiple iterations of a particular domain are present (e.g. multiple first domains) these may be multiple copies of the same domain (e.g. multiple LysA domains) or different ‘first domains’ which differ in sequence/structure, but all share the common functional property of activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof (e.g. multiple different EADs).

[0118] In one embodiment, the peptide comprises of the following domains from N-terminal to C-terminal: third domain (e.g. AMP), second domain (e.g. LysB), first domain (e.g. LysA). In the same or different embodiments, the peptide may also comprise a linker between the second and first domain and/or may comprise one or more PTD domains at the C terminal end of the arrangement. For example, the peptide may comprise AMP-LysB-LysA, AMP-LysB-LysA-PTDs, AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA or AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTDs.

[0119] In one embodiment, the peptide does not comprise the following domains from N-terminal to C-terminal: third domain (e.g. AMP), second domain (e.g. LysB), first domain (e.g. LysA). In another embodiment the peptide does not comprise the following domains from N-terminal to C-terminal: third domain (e.g. AMP), second domain (e.g. LysB), first domain (e.g. LysA) wherein there is a linker between the second and first domain. Thus, in one embodiment the peptide does not comprise the following arrangement: AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD. In another embodiment, the peptide does not comprise the following arrangement: AMP-LysB-EAD.

[0120] Accordingly in some embodiments, the peptide does not comprise one or more of the following arrangements:

[0121] (a) AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA [0122] (b) AMP-LysB-LysA [0123] (c) AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD [0124] (d) AMP-LysB-EAD [0125] (e) AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD [0126] (f) AMP-LysB-LysA-PTD.

[0127] In some embodiments, the peptides of the invention do not exceed 120 kDa. For example, a peptide may be about 10 kDa, 20 kDa, 30 kDa, 40 kDa, 50 kDa, 60 kDa, 70 kDa, 80 kDa, 90 kDa, 100 kDa, 110 kDa, or 120 kDa.

[0128] As specified above, peptides of the present invention optionally further comprise at least one linker (i.e. linker peptides). Linkers are comprised of at least one amino acid, more typically a chain of two or more amino acids, that are fused to and between domains of peptides. In some embodiments, a linker may not be required at all. In some

embodiments, a linker may be required between particular domains. For example, a linker may be required to prevent steric hindrance between two domains (i.e. where an entire LysA and LysB are present, depending on their sizes, a linker may be beneficial, albeit not necessarily compulsory, to retaining their function). In some embodiments, where an entire LysA and/or LysB is included, a linker may be of higher importance (especially for certain LysA that are known to be particularly large in size) to reduce risk of steric hindrance.

[0129] Any of the domains described herein that are fused to or between any other domain may be considered a linker. For example, in a fusion peptide comprised of LysA-LysB-AMP, the LysB may be considered a linker between LysA and AMP, and/or the AMP or LysA may be considered a linker attached to LysB (which optionally may link LysB to further domains and/or components/portions thereof). In some embodiments, linkers do not correspond to any of the domains (i.e. the domains with specified activity), but instead correspond to further amino acids or stretches thereof. In another example, in a fusion peptide comprised of LysB-AMP-LysA, the AMP may be considered a linker between LysB and LysA, and/or the LysB or LysA may be considered a linker attached to AMP (which optionally may link AMP to further domains and/or components/portions thereof).

[0130] Accordingly, the purpose of a linker is to connect to a domain. In some embodiments, at least one linker connects:

[0131] 1. the first domain to the second domain; [0132] 2. the second domain to the third domain; [0133] 3. the first domain to the third domain; [0134] 4. the first domain to the fourth domain; [0135] 5. the second domain to the fourth domain; [0136] 6. the third domain to the fourth domain; and/or [0137] 7. a domain to a further linker.

[0138] Linkers may be present in tandem (either as repeats of the same linker, or as two or more linkers connected to each other). All linkers of the present invention can be in either orientation. For example, where a sequence is provided for a linker, that sequence may be fused to any other domain or linker by its N- and/or C-terminus, and so any sequence written N- to C-terminally would equally be valid written C- to N-terminally in a fusion peptide.

[0139] Linkers can be of any length. In some embodiments, linkers are between 1 and 100 amino acids in length, for example, between 5 and 50 amino acids in length, between 10 and 30 amino acids in length, and/or between 15 and 20 amino acids in length. Where more than one linker is present in a peptide, each linker may correspond to the same sequence or different sequences. Preferably, the linker is of a length that does not disrupt any one or more of the beneficial activities of the peptide of the invention.

[0140] In one embodiment, linkers that are not domains may comprise any one or more (or multiple repeats) of the amino acid sequences (in either orientation) selected from any one or more of SEQ ID NOs: 104, 106, 108, 110, 112 or 114; or said linkers may be encoded by any one or more of the nucleotide sequences of SEQ ID NO: 103, 105, 107, 109, 111 or 113, as follows:

TABLE-US-00007 Length: 18 Type: DNA Other information: Linker-A (also known as "L1") Sequence ID No: 103 GCGGGTGC GGGTGC GGGT Length: 6 Molecular weight: 0.4 kDa Type: Protein Feature: Flexible short linker Other information: Linker-A (also known as "L1") Sequence ID No: 104 AGAGAG Length: 27 Type: DNA Other information: Linker-B (also known as "L4") Sequence ID No: 105 CTGTCTCGTTTCTTCCACGCGGA ACTG Length: 9 Molecular weight: 1.119 kDa Type: Protein Feature: Rigid short helix Other information: Linker-B (also known as "L4") Sequence ID No: 106 LSRFFHAEL Length: 42 Type: DNA Other information: Linker-C (also known as "L5") Sequence ID No: 107 GTTTTCAACCAGCGTAAAGAACACAAAGGTTACATGCTGGCG Length: 14 Molecular weight: 1.721 kDa Type: Protein Feature: Rigid long helix Other information: Linker-C (also known as "L5") Sequence ID No: 108 VFNQRKEHKG YMLA Length: 48 Type: DNA Other information: Linker-D (also known as "L6") Sequence ID No: 109 ATCCCGCAGGGTC GTTCTACCCGGTTCAGCCGTACCCGGGTGCGTTC Length: 16 Molecular weight: 1.75 kDa Type: Protein Feature: Rigid long coil Other information: Linker-D (also known as "L6") Sequence ID No: 110 IPQGRSHPVQYPGAF Length: 18 Type: DNA Other information: Linker-E (also known as "L7") Sequence ID No: 111 CCGGCGGTTCCGCCGCCG Length: 6 Molecular weight: 0.576 kDa Type: Protein Feature: Rigid short coil Other information: Linker-E (also known as "L7") Sequence ID No: 112 PAVPPP Length: 39 Type: DNA Other information: Linker-F (also known as "L8") Sequence ID No: 113 GAAGCGGCGGCGAAAGAAGCGGCGAAAGAAGCGGCGAAA Length: 13 Molecular weight: 1.287 kDa Type: Protein Feature: Rigid optimal helix Other information: Linker-F (also known as "L8") Sequence ID No: 114 EAAAKEAAKEAAK

[0141] Alternatively or additionally, the linkers may also be variants, fragments, fusions or derivatives of the sequences given above, or fusions of said fragments, variants and derivatives thereof.

[0142] In some embodiments, the peptide comprises at least one lysin as defined herein (e.g. an endolysin, such as LysA, and/or an enzyme with lipolytic activity, such as LysB; or a portion of any of the aforementioned (e.g. an EAD)) that is effective against the phylum Actinobacteria; derived from the class Actinobacteridae; derived from the order Actinomycetales, and/or Bifidobacteriales. Optionally wherein at least one lysin is effective against a subclass and/or family selected from the list consisting of: Actinomycineae: Actinomycetaceae (*Actinomyces*, *Mobiluncus*); Corynebacterineae: Mycobacteriaceae (*Mycobacterium*), Nocardaceae; Frankineae: Frankiaceae; Micrococcineae: Brevibacteriaceae; Propionibacteriaceae (*Propionibacterium*); Bifidobacteriaceae (*Bifidobacterium*, *Falcivibrio*, *Gardnerella*); Acidimicrobidae, Coriobacteridae, Rubrobacteridae, Sphaerobacteridae.

[0143] In some embodiments, at least one domain defined herein, such as a lysin as defined herein (e.g. an endolysin,

such as LysA, or a portion of any of the aforementioned (e.g. an EAD)) may be derived from a bacteriophage capable of infecting gram positive bacteria and/or gram negative bacteria and/or mycobacteria. In some embodiments, at least one domain defined herein, such as a lysin as defined herein (e.g. an enzyme with lipolytic activity, such as LysB; or a portion of any of the aforementioned (e.g. an EAD)) may be derived from a bacteriophage capable of infecting mycobacteria. [0144] In some embodiments, at least one domain defined herein, such as a lysin as defined herein (e.g. an endolysin, such as LysA, and/or an enzyme with lipolytic activity, such as LysB; or a portion of any of the aforementioned (e.g. an EAD)) may comprise or consist of the amino acid sequence corresponding to any one of SEQ ID NOS: 1-32.

[0145] In one embodiment one or more domains are derived from a mycobacteriophage capable of infecting *mycobacterium*. Mycobacteriophages may be in the form of a prophage, wherein the genetic material of a bacteriophage is incorporated into a host (bacterium), and the host is able to produce phages. The term “mycobacteriophage” therefore includes phages produced by a prophage of said mycobacteriophage. Thus, in some embodiments, the peptide comprises at least one domain defined here, such as a lysin as defined herein (e.g. an endolysin, such as LysA, and/or an enzyme with lipolytic activity, such as LysB; or a portion of any of the aforementioned (e.g. an EAD)) that is derived from a mycobacteriophage or a *Mycobacterium* prophage selected from the group consisting of: TM4, D29, L5, Bxz2, Saal, Enkosi, Ms6, Omega, Obama12, Echid, DS6A, Pumpkin or any other mycobacteriophage as listed in The Actinobacteriophage Database (see [phagesdb.org/hosts/genera/1/](http://phagesdb.org/hosts/genera/1/)). Peptides described herein may comprise lysins and/or components/portions thereof all derived from the same mycobacteriophage or from multiple mycobacteriophages. For example, a peptide may be a fusion of domains derived from at least 2 mycobacteriophages, optionally at least 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 or more mycobacteriophages. For example, a peptide may be a fusion of at least one LysA (and/or portion thereof) derived from TM4 and at least one LysB (and/or portion thereof) derived from D29.

[0146] Peptide of the present invention have antimicrobial properties. In one embodiment, the peptides are for use treating bacterial infection, for example mycobacterial infection. The peptides may be used for treating any bacterial infection caused by a bacterial species with mycolic acids present in the cell envelope or substantially free from mycolic acid. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the peptide is capable of disrupting the cell membrane of gram-positive bacteria that have mycolic acids in their cell membrane. In some embodiments, the peptides are capable of disrupting the cell membrane of mycobacteria. Species of *Mycobacterium* include, but are not limited to: *Mycobacterium abscessus*, *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium microti*, *Mycobacterium africanum*, *Mycobacterium bovis*, *Mycobacterium canettii*, *Mycobacterium pinnipedii*, *Mycobacterium caprae*, *Mycobacterium mungi*, *Mycobacterium leprae*, *Mycobacterium ulcerans*, *Mycobacterium xenopi*, *Mycobacterium shottsii*, *Mycobacterium avium*, *Mycobacterium avium* subsp. *paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium intracellulare*, *Mycobacterium smegmatis*, *Mycobacterium kansasii*, *Mycobacterium terrae*, *Mycobacterium nonchromogenicum*, *Mycobacterium gordonae*, and *Mycobacterium triviale*, and non-tuberculosis mycobacteria (NTM). In one preferable embodiment, the peptides are capable of disrupting the cell membrane of *Mycobacterium abscessus*.

[0147] In some embodiments, the bacterium (e.g. *mycobacterium*) may be drug resistant (e.g. multidrug resistant). For example, the target bacteria may be resistant to at least one drug, optionally at least 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 or more drugs. By “drug resistant” we include the meaning that the bacterium (e.g. *mycobacterium*) is not susceptible to treatment with an antibacterial (or antimycobacterial) agent. Accordingly, the bacteria may be multidrug-resistant (MDR), extremely drug-resistant (XDR), or totally drug-resistant (TDR). The uses described herein may facilitate the function of further therapeutic agents. Drug resistance may arise due to specific components and/or configurations of the cell wall. Drug resistant strains of bacteria, for example, tend to have thicker cell walls. Thus, peptides and uses thereof described herein may affect the cell envelope in such a way as to facilitate the function of a further therapeutic agent (for example, an agent that acts intracellularly to the bacteria). However, the composition of MDR, XDR and/or TDR strains remains largely the same. Accordingly, the effectiveness of various peptides herein against the MDR strain *M. abscessus* means it is likely that other drug resistant strains would also be susceptible. In one embodiment, the peptide is effective in treating the MDR strain *M. abscessus*. For example, the peptide may cause disruption of the cell membrane of the MDR strain *M. abscessus*, thereby resulting in osmotic shock and death of the *mycobacterium*.

[0148] Tuberculosis, for example, which results from an infection with *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, can be cured with a combination of first-line drugs taken daily for several months. MDR TB occurs when a *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* strain is resistant to isoniazid and rifampin, two of the most powerful first-line drugs. To cure MDR TB, healthcare providers must turn to a combination of second-line drugs, several of which are shown here. Second-line drugs may have more side effects, the treatment may last much longer, and the cost may be up to 100 times more than first-line therapy. MDR TB strains can also grow resistant to second-line drugs, further complicating treatment. XDR TB occurs when a *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* strain is resistant to isoniazid and rifampin, two of the most powerful first-line drugs, as well as key drugs of the second line regimen-any fluoroquinolone and at least one of the three injectable drugs shown above. XDR TB strains may also be resistant to additional drugs, greatly complicating therapy.

[0149] In some embodiments, the peptides are for use in treating co-infections. For example, the peptides may be for use in treating someone that has a viral infection who may be more susceptible to, or already infected with, a bacterial (e.g. infection) infection. In some embodiments, the viral infection is selected from one or more of the groups consisting of: coronavirus, HIV, influenza, viral pneumonia, enterovirus and norovirus.

[0150] In some embodiments, the peptide of the present invention is not the following: a peptide which comprises an outer membrane acting biologic and a mycobacterial chemotherapeutic, but which lacks a domain with specific activity to



a peptidoglycan layer.

[0151] In other embodiments, the peptide of the invention is not a peptide which has an outer membrane acting biologic that is LysB or D29 phage LysB and which further comprises a mycobacterial chemotherapeutic, but which lacks a domain with specific activity to a peptidoglycan layer.

[0152] In yet other embodiments, the peptide of the invention is not a peptide which has an outer membrane acting biologic that is LysB or D29 phage LysB and which further comprises a mycobacterial chemotherapeutic, but which lacks a LysA domain with specific activity to a peptidoglycan layer.

[0153] In another embodiments, the peptides of the present invention are not: [0154] a fusion protein comprising a LysA and AMP (but not comprising a LysB) or [0155] a fusion peptide comprising a LysB and AMP (but not comprising a LysA).

[0156] Thus in one embodiment any peptide which does not comprise, as a single peptide, at least a LysA, a LysB and an AMP, is excluded.

[0157] In a second aspect of the invention, the peptide may be in the form of a composition (e.g. a pharmaceutical composition. Accordingly, a composition comprising a peptide may be any one or more of the peptides as defined herein, in any combination or permutation, provided that the composition retains the intended activity (or at least a portion of the intended activity). In some embodiments a composition may comprise a further agent, for example a pharmaceutically acceptable excipient, diluent, carrier, buffer and/or adjuvant.

[0158] Additional compounds may also be included in the pharmaceutical compositions, such as other peptides, low molecular weight immunomodulating agents, receptor agonists and antagonists, and antimicrobial agents. Other examples include chelating agents such as EDTA, citrate, EGTA or glutathione.

[0159] The pharmaceutical compositions may be prepared in a manner known in the art that is sufficiently storage stable and suitable for administration to humans and animals. The pharmaceutical compositions may be lyophilised, e.g. through freeze drying, spray drying, spray cooling, or through use of particle formation from supercritical particle formation.

[0160] By “pharmaceutically acceptable” we mean a non-toxic material that does not decrease the effectiveness of the biological activity of the active ingredients, i.e. the antimicrobial polypeptide(s) of the composition. Such pharmaceutically acceptable buffers, carriers or excipients are well-known in the art (see Remington's Pharmaceutical Sciences, 18th edition, A. R Gennaro, Ed., Mack Publishing Company (1990) and handbook of Pharmaceutical Excipients, 3rd edition, A. Kibbe, Ed., Pharmaceutical Press (2000)).

[0161] The term “buffer” is intended to mean an aqueous solution containing an acid-base mixture with the purpose of stabilising pH. Examples of buffers are Trizma, Bicine, Tricine, MOPS, MOPSO, MOBS, Tris, Hepes, HEPBS, MES, phosphate, carbonate, acetate, citrate, glycolate, lactate, borate, ACES, ADA, tartrate, AMP, AMPD, AMPSO, BES, CABS, cacodylate, CHES, DIPSO, EPPS, ethanolamine, glycine, HEPPSO, imidazole, imidazolelactic acid, PIPES, SSC, SSPE, POPSO, TAPS, TABS, TAPSO and TES.

[0162] The term “diluent” is intended to mean an aqueous or non-aqueous solution with the purpose of diluting the peptide in the pharmaceutical preparation. The diluent may be one or more of saline, water, polyethylene glycol, propylene glycol, ethanol or oils (such as safflower oil, corn oil, peanut oil, cottonseed oil or sesame oil).

[0163] The term “adjuvant” is intended to mean any compound added to the formulation to increase the biological effect of the peptide of the composition. The adjuvant may be one or more of colloidal silver, or zinc, copper or silver salts with different anions, for example, but not limited to fluoride, chloride, bromide, iodide, thiocyanate, sulfite, hydroxide, phosphate, carbonate, lactate, glycolate, citrate, borate, tartrate, and acetates of different acyl composition. The adjuvant may also be cationic polymers such as PHMB, cationic cellulose ethers, cationic cellulose esters, deacetylated hyaluronic acid, chitosan, cationic dendrimers, cationic synthetic polymers such as poly(vinyl imidazole), and cationic polypeptides such as polyhistidine, polylysine, polyarginine, and peptides containing these amino acids.

[0164] The excipient may be one or more of carbohydrates, polymers, lipids, detergents and minerals. Examples of carbohydrates include lactose, sucrose, mannitol, and cyclodextrines, which are added to the composition, e.g., for facilitating lyophilisation. Examples of polymers are starch, cellulose ethers, cellulose, carboxymethylcellulose, hydroxypropylmethyl cellulose, hydroxyethyl cellulose, ethylhydroxyethyl cellulose, ethyl cellulose, methyl cellulose, propyl cellulose, alginates, carageenans, hyaluronic acid and derivatives thereof, polyacrylic acid, polysulphonate, polyethyleneglycol/polyethylene oxide, polyethyleneoxide/polypropylene oxide copolymers, polyvinylalcohol/polyvinylacetate of different degree of hydrolysis, poly(lactic acid), poly(glycolic acid) or copolymers thereof with various composition, and polyvinylpyrrolidone, all of different molecular weight, which are added to the composition, e.g. for viscosity control, for achieving bioadhesion, or for protecting the active ingredient (applies to A-C as well) from chemical and proteolytic degradation. Examples of lipids are fatty acids, phospholipids, mono-, di-, and triglycerides, ceramides, sphingolipids and glycolipids, all of different acyl chain length and saturation, egg lecithin, soy lecithin, hydrogenated egg and soy lecithin, which are added to the composition for reasons similar to those for polymers. Examples of minerals are talc, magnesium oxide, zinc oxide and titanium oxide, which are added to the composition to obtain benefits such as reduction of liquid accumulation or advantageous pigment properties.

[0165] The pharmaceutical composition may also contain one or more mono- or di-saccharides such as xylitol, sorbitol, mannitol, lactitol, isomalt, maltitol, glycerol or xylosides, and/or monoacylglycerols, such as monolaurin. The characteristics of the carrier are dependent on the route of administration. One route of administration is topical administration. For example, for topical administrations, a preferred carrier is an emulsified cream comprising the active

peptide, but other common carriers such as certain petrolatum/mineral-based and vegetable-based ointments can be used, as well as polymer gels, liquid crystalline phases and microemulsions.

[0166] The pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may also be in the form of a liposome, in which the peptide is combined, in addition to other pharmaceutically acceptable carriers, with amphipathic agents such as lipids, which exist in aggregated forms as micelles, insoluble monolayers and liquid crystals. Suitable lipids for liposomal formulation include, without limitation, monoglycerides, diglycerides, sulfatides, lysolecithin, phospholipids, saponin, bile acids, and the like. Suitable lipids also include the lipids above modified by poly (ethylene glycol) in the polar headgroup for prolonging bloodstream circulation time. Preparation of such liposomal formulations can be found in for example U.S. Pat. No. 4,235,871.

[0167] The pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may also be in the form of biodegradable microspheres. Aliphatic polyesters, such as poly(lactic acid) (PLA), poly(glycolic acid) (PGA), copolymers of PLA and PGA (PLGA) or poly(caprolactone) (PCL), and polyanhydrides have been widely used as biodegradable polymers in the production of microspheres. Preparations of such microspheres can be found in U.S. Pat. No. 5,851,451 and in EP 213 303.

[0168] The pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may also be formulated with micellar systems formed by surfactants and block copolymers, preferably those containing poly(ethylene oxide) moieties for prolonging bloodstream circulation time.

[0169] The pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may also be in the form of polymer gels, where polymers such as starch, cellulose ethers, cellulose, carboxymethylcellulose, hydroxypropylmethyl cellulose, hydroxyethyl cellulose, ethylhydroxyethyl cellulose, ethyl cellulose, methyl cellulose, propyl cellulose, alginates, chitosan, carrageenan, hyaluronic acid and derivatives thereof, polyacrylic acid, polyvinyl imidazole, polysulphonate, polyethylenglycol/polyethylene oxide, polyethylene-oxide/polypropylene oxide copolymers, polyvinylalcohol/polyvinylacetate of different degree of hydrolysis, and polyvinylpyrrolidone are used for thickening of the solution containing the peptide. The polymers may also comprise gelatin or collagen.

[0170] The pharmaceutical composition may also include ions and a defined pH for potentiation of action of the activities of peptides (e.g. the activity as described above for any of the domains).

[0171] The above compositions of the invention may be subjected to conventional pharmaceutical operations such as sterilisation and/or may contain conventional adjuvants such as preservatives, stabilisers, wetting agents, emulsifiers, buffers, fillers, etc., e.g., as disclosed elsewhere herein.

[0172] It will be appreciated by persons skilled in the art that the pharmaceutical compositions and/or peptides of the invention may be administered locally or systemically. Routes of administration include topical (e.g. ophthalmic), ocular, nasal, pulmonary, buccal, parenteral (intravenous, subcutaneous, and intramuscular), oral, vaginal and rectal. In one embodiment the administration may be respiratory, for example by inhalation either orally or nasally. Such administration is also referred to as inhalation or pulmonary administration. Also, administration from implants is possible. Suitable preparation forms are, for example granules, powders, tablets, coated tablets, (micro) capsules, suppositories, syrups, emulsions, microemulsions, defined as optically isotropic thermodynamically stable systems consisting of water, oil and surfactant, liquid crystalline phases, defined as systems characterised by long-range order but short-range disorder (examples include lamellar, hexagonal and cubic phases, either water- or oil continuous), or their dispersed counterparts, gels, ointments, dispersions, suspensions, creams, aerosols, wafers, droplets or injectable solution in ampoule form and also preparations with protracted release of active compounds, in whose preparation excipients, diluents, adjuvants or carriers are customarily used as described above. The pharmaceutical composition and/or peptide may also be provided in bandages, plasters or in sutures or the like.

[0173] In some embodiments, the pharmaceutical composition and/or peptide is suitable for oral administration, parenteral administration and/or topical administration. For example, the pharmaceutical composition may be suitable for topical administration (e.g. ophthalmic administration, in the form of a spray, lotion, paste or drops etc.). The route of administration may depend on the type of infection. For example, inhalation/pulmonary routes of administration are more beneficial for treating TB infection.

[0174] The pharmaceutical compositions will be administered to a patient in a pharmaceutically effective dose. By "pharmaceutically effective dose" is meant a dose that is sufficient to produce the desired effects in relation to the condition for which it is administered. The exact dose is dependent on the activity of the compound, manner of administration, nature and severity of the disorder, age and body weight of the patient, whereby different and/or adapted doses may be needed. The administration of the dose can be carried out both by single administration in the form of an individual dose unit or else several smaller dose units and also by multiple administrations of subdivided doses at specific intervals.

[0175] The pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may be administered alone or in combination with other therapeutic agents, such as additional antibiotic, anti-inflammatory, immunosuppressive, proteases, vasoactive and/or antiseptic agents (such as anti-bacterial agents, anti-fungicides, anti-viral agents, and anti-parasitic agents). Examples of suitable additional antibiotic agents include penicillins, cephalosporins, carbacephems, cephamycins, carbapenems, monobactams, aminoglycosides, glycopeptides, quinolones, tetracyclines, macrolides, and fluoroquinolones. Antiseptic agents include iodine, silver, copper, chlorhexidine, polyhexanide and other biguanides, chitosan, acetic acid, and hydrogen peroxide. Likewise, the pharmaceutical compositions may also contain anti-inflammatory drugs, such as steroids and macrolactam derivatives. The further therapeutic agent may be selected depending on the target bacterium,

for example the combination therapy may be with anti-TB drugs if TB is the intended target.

[0176] Further therapeutic agents may be mycobacterial chemotherapeutics that are antibiotics, including any one or more agent selected from the list consisting of: isoniazid, pyrazinamide, ethambutol, or rifampin, fluoroquinolones (e.g. ciprofloxacin, levofloxacin, moxifloxacin), cyclic peptides (e.g. capreomycin, viomycin, enviomycin), thioamides (e.g. ethionamide, prothionamide), cycloserine, terizidone, an aminoglycoside, PAS, kanamycin, capreomycin, amikacin, streptomycin, macrolide, a  $\beta$ -lactam, a  $\beta$ -lactamase inhibitor, clavulanic acid, trimethoprim, or sulfamethoxazole, clarithromycin, rifampicin, rifabutin, amikacin, azithromycin, or moxifloxacin, diarylquinoline, bedaquiline, delamanid, TMC207, nitroimidazoles (including PA-824 and OPC-67683), oxazolidinones (including linezolid, sutezolid, and AZD5847), BTZ043, and SQ109.

[0177] Combination therapies as described herein may have: (i) enhanced potency, which may allow the dose of peptides of the present invention to be attenuated; (ii) a low (or lower) chance (e.g. compared with peptides of the present invention alone, and/or compared with known therapies, including known combination therapies) of having resistance developed against them; (iii) increased specificity (for example, due to the CBD derived from LysA improving specificity to cell walls of interest, including mycobacterial cell walls); and/or (iv) improved activity intracellularly (e.g. due to fusion with a PTD as described herein).

[0178] Such additional therapeutic agents may be incorporated as part of the same pharmaceutical composition or may be administered separately. Additional therapeutic agents can be administered simultaneously, sequentially and/or separately, either before, after and/or during administration of a pharmaceutical composition described herein.

[0179] It will be appreciated by persons skilled in the art that the peptides of the invention, compositions of the invention, and/or pharmaceutical compositions thereof, may be applied to devices (such as medical devices) and other products the implantation into or application of which to the human or animal body is associated with the risk of infection by a microbial agent. The purpose of applying peptides, compositions and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may be to protect devices (e.g. medical devices) from mycobacterial infection. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the peptides, compositions and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may be at least a surface coating on a device. Alternatively, or additionally, a device comprising a peptide, composition and/or pharmaceutical composition of the invention may be for use in recognition, prevention, monitoring, treatment and/or alleviation of mycobacteria or mycobacterial diseases.

[0180] Peptides, compositions and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may be in the form of nanoparticles, hydrogels, creams, ointments and/or wafers, for example for topical application.

[0181] In some embodiments, the peptides, compositions and/or pharmaceutical compositions of the invention may be for use in water treatment to reduce (or remove) mycobacteria. For example, a water supply can be treated with a peptide, composition and/or pharmaceutical composition after decanting the water into a vessel; and/or a filter could be applied to a water system that treats water passing through said filter, wherein the filter comprises a peptide, composition and/or pharmaceutical composition of the invention.

[0182] In some embodiments, the peptides and/or compositions described herein are for use in medicine, including veterinary medicine.

[0183] In some embodiments, the peptides and/or compositions described herein are for cosmetic purposes. For example, the peptides and/or compositions described herein may be prepared as a cosmetic. Such a cosmetic preparation may be in a formulation as described for compositions herein, including being suitable for any administration route as described herein. For example, a cosmetic composition may have activity against *Propionibacterium acnes*, and thus may be useful in treating acne.

[0184] In some embodiments, the peptides and/or compositions described herein may be components within a kit. A kit may further comprise instructions for use and/or constitution of peptides and/or composition.

[0185] In some embodiments, the peptides and/or compositions described herein may be for use in a diagnostic test, for example a diagnostic test for identifying mycobacterial infection. Diagnostic tests may be on a sample derived from a subject or on inanimate objects.

[0186] In some embodiments, the peptides and/or compositions described herein may be for use in the preparation of vaccines for use in treating or preventing disease in an organism, for example in a human, sheep, cow, dog, pig, or other farm animal. Alternatively, the vaccine may be prepared from a nucleic acid that encodes a peptide (or peptides) as described herein.

[0187] In some embodiments, the peptides and/or compositions described herein may be for use in: [0188] 1. promoting wound healing; [0189] 2. treating infection, optionally wherein the infection is by a bacterium with mycolic acids in their cell wall, for example mycobacterial infection, such as *M. abscessus*, or when the infection is caused by non-tuberculous mycobacteria (NTM); [0190] 3. treating skin/oral/dental infections [0191] 4. ocular, skin, soft tissue, oral and/or dental procedures; [0192] 5. sterilisation (e.g. sterilisation via biocidal activity, wherein the peptide is acting as a biocide); [0193] 6. treating granulomas and/or [0194] 7. treating biofilms.

[0195] For example, in one embodiment the peptides and/or compositions described herein may be used for treating a skin or soft tissue infection caused by non-tuberculosis mycobacteria (NTM).

[0196] As described above, in one embodiment, the peptides and/or compositions of the invention may be used in treating tuberculosis (TB). In one embodiment the tuberculosis to be treated may be active. In one embodiment the tuberculosis to be treated may be latent (or dormant) tuberculosis.

[0197] The treatment of “infection” as described herein may refer to an external and/or internal infection, and instances where co-infection of one pathogen may be more likely due to infection with an initial pathogen. For example, the infection may be internal to a subject in need of treatment, e.g. a patient with *M. abscessus* infection. Additionally, or alternatively, the infection may be on an external object, such as an object suspected or confirmed to be infected with *M. abscessus* and so in need of sterilisation from said infection.

[0198] By “biofilm” we mean any group of microorganisms in which cells stick to each other on a surface, such as in a complex structure, thereby forming a biofilm. For example, the culture (or natural growth) of mycobacteria may result in a biofilm forming, whereby many mycobacterial cells are stuck together on a surface. In some embodiments, the peptides are capable of breaking up biofilms. For example, the peptides may disrupt the interactions between mycobacterial cells that have formed a biofilm, and/or may prevent new formation of biofilms from existing mycobacteria on a surface (e.g. by pre-sterilising with peptides).

[0199] Formation of a biofilm begins with the attachment of free-floating microorganisms (e.g. mycobacteria) to a surface. These first colonists adhere to the surface initially through weak, reversible adhesion and, if not immediately separated from the surface, can anchor more permanently using cell adhesion structures (such as pili). Some species are not able to attach to a surface on their own but are sometimes able to anchor themselves to the matrix or directly to earlier colonists. Once colonization has begun, the biofilm grows through a combination of cell division and recruitment. Polysaccharide matrices typically enclose bacterial biofilms. The final stage of biofilm formation is known as dispersion and is the stage in which the biofilm is established and may only change in shape and size.

[0200] In one embodiment, a biofilm may comprise, consist essentially of, or consist of, multiple strains of microbial cells (e.g. mycobacterial cells) growing in a biofilm. Optionally, a biofilm may comprise, consist essentially of, or consist of, one species or strain of microbial (e.g. mycobacterial) cells.

[0201] In an alternative option, a biofilm may comprise, consist essentially of, or consist of, more than one species or strains of mycobacterial cell, such as up to at least 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 15, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90, 100, 150, 200, 250, 300, 350, 400, 450, 500, 600, 700, 800, 900, 1000 or more different species or strains of mycobacterial cell.

[0202] Accordingly, peptides, compositions and methods for inhibiting, reducing, or removing biofilm forming mycobacteria and mycobacterial infections are provided. In some embodiments, peptides or composition may further comprise an extra enzyme that is a biofilm degrader. For example, a biofilm degrader may be selected from the group consisting of depolymerases, glycoside hydrolases, lipases, esterases, nucleases and proteases. In some embodiments, a method for inhibiting, reducing or removing biofilm forming mycobacteria may comprise the step of treating a surface with a peptide or composition described herein, optionally further comprising the step of treating with an enzyme that is a biofilm degrader (sequentially, simultaneously and/or subsequently to the peptide or composition).

[0203] It will be apparent to the skilled person that as the invention provides peptides, the invention also provides corresponding polynucleotides that comprise or consist of a sequence that encodes the peptides of the invention (or domains thereof which are subsequently fused to a peptide of the present invention). The invention provides a DNA polynucleotide that comprises or consists of a sequence that encodes at least one peptide of the invention or at least one domain thereof. The invention also provides an RNA polynucleotide that comprises or consists of a sequence that encodes at least one peptide of the invention or at least one domain thereof. The skilled person will appreciate that a polynucleotide, for example a DNA or RNA polynucleotide, may comprise one or more modifications, for example a phosphorothioate modification. The polynucleotide may also comprise one or more other features, for example a promoter, terminator, or a tag for instance, for example the features typical of an expression cassette.

[0204] Nucleic acids of the present invention may not correspond to mycobacteriophage lysis cassettes.

Mycobacteriophage lysis cassettes encode a single LysA or LysB. Some mycobacteriophages do not have lysis cassettes that encode a LysB. However, lysis cassettes capable of encoding a peptide comprising at least one LysA (or component thereof) and at least one LysB (or component thereof) do not exist in nature, let alone a peptide further comprising a membrane permeabiliser domain. Similarly, mycobacteriophages that product LysA and LysB peptides do so as separate peptides, and not combined in the way of the peptides of the present invention.

[0205] The invention also provides a nucleic acid vector comprising the nucleic acid of the invention. The skilled person will understand that by nucleic acid vector we include the meaning of a plasmid, phage, artificial chromosome or other nucleic acid structure used to deliver or express at least one peptide or at least one domain thereof. The artificial chromosome may be any artificial chromosome and may be selected from, for example, a bacterial artificial chromosome (BAC), a yeast artificial chromosome (YAC), and a Human artificial chromosome (HAC).

[0206] The invention also provides a cell that comprises at least one peptide of the invention (or at least one domain thereof), at least one polynucleotide of the invention and/or at least one vector of the invention. The cell of the invention has two main uses, amongst others: i) manufacture of the cyclic peptides or viral vectors comprising at least one peptide of the invention, for example; and ii) medical uses for example screening for suitable peptides for particular situations, or as a therapeutic cell.

[0207] In one embodiment, the cell is a cell that is used in the commercial, large scale manufacture of the peptides of the invention, for example is a bacterial cell such as *E. coli*, or is a yeast cell such as *P. pastoris*, or a cell derived from a plant, virus, insect or otherwise.

[0208] In another embodiment the cell is a cell that either is a direct “diseased” cell, for example taken from a biopsy from a patient. In another embodiment the cell is a cell that is intended to mimic or model a particular disease state. Such

cells can be used to screen for appropriate peptides that are suitable for use in particular therapeutic situations.

[0209] Since the peptides of the invention are able to disrupt particular microbial cell walls, for example mycobacterial cell walls, it will be apparent to the skilled person that the peptides of the invention, the polynucleotides of the invention and/or the vectors of the invention have use in the treatment and/or prevention of diseases, disorders or conditions. For example, in one embodiment the peptides of the invention are useful in the treatment or prevention of a disease, disorder or condition that is associated with and/or caused by bacterial, for example mycobacterial, infection.

[0210] The peptides and/or compositions of the present invention may be for use in a method (e.g. an in vitro method) of lysing and/or killing bacteria (e.g. mycobacteria), and/or in a method of reducing the growth and/or viability of said bacteria.

[0211] In some embodiments is provided a method (e.g. an in vitro method) of lysing and/or killing bacteria (e.g. mycobacteria), and/or in a method of reducing the growth and/or viability of said bacteria, with any one or more of the previously described embodiments (e.g. peptides and/or compositions described herein).

[0212] Lysing and/or killing bacteria (e.g. mycobacteria) and/or reducing the growth and/or viability of bacteria may be assessed, for example, based on percentage growth inhibition.

[0213] The percentage growth inhibition can be calculated following an assessment of optical density using methods known to the skilled person and as demonstrated in the Examples, wherein a lower optical density may indicate a lower level of bacteria. Thus, in some embodiments, the peptide may have a percentage growth inhibition of at least 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 85%, 90%, 95%, 96%, 97%, 98%, 99%, or of 100%. Preferably, the peptides have a percentage growth inhibition of at least 90%; more preferably at least 95%. For further details of percentage growth inhibition measurements, see Tenland et al., 2018.

[0214] Alternatively, or additionally, the reduction in growth or lysing/killing of bacteria may be measured according to a scaled scoring system. In one embodiment of such a scoring system, different scores from ‘+++’, ‘+’, ‘+’ and ‘-’ are assigned, wherein ‘+++’ is indicative of the most bacterial growth inhibition, and ‘-’ is indicative of the lowest level of inhibition, or no level of growth inhibition. In one embodiment, assessment is based on OD655 nm values (representative of bacterial growth in a plate) as follows: hits are ranked as ‘+++’ if no bacterial growth was observed; hits are ranked as ‘++’ if they exhibit bacterial growth with OD655 nm between 0 and 0.1; hits are ranked as ‘+’ if they exhibit bacterial growth with OD655 nm between 0.1 and 0.2; and finally hits are ranked as ‘-’ if they exhibit bacterial growth with OD655 nm larger than 0.2. The OD655 nm values can be corrected for background OD655 nm of the medium. For further details of such a scoring system see Gerstmans et al., 2020. Thus in one embodiment the peptides of the invention may be described as being capable of lysing/killing bacteria if they are classed as ‘+++’, or alternatively the peptides may be described as being capable of lysing/killing bacteria if they are classed as ‘+++’ or ‘++’, or alternatively the peptides may be described as being capable of lysing/killing bacteria if they are classed as ‘+++’, ‘+’ or ‘+’.

[0215] Peptides may be classed as ‘hits’ i.e. peptides having a predefined level of bacterial killing activity, if the OD of bacterial growth in a plate is less than 0.1, as described above and further in the Examples of the present application. Alternatively, peptides may be classed as hits if the OD is less than 0.15, 0.20, 0.25, 0.30, 0.35, 0.40, 0.45 or 0.50.

[0216] Such bacterial growth inhibition may also be measured relative to a positive control (e.g. a plate well wherein the bacteria is allowed to grow without application of the peptides of the invention). Accordingly, any clones expressing measurable inhibition (i.e. significantly lower OD than the control) may be classed as having bacterial killing/lysing/growth inhibition effect.

[0217] Accordingly, the present application also provides aspects according to the following numbered paragraphs. [0218]

1. A peptide comprising: [0219] (i) a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, and [0220] (ii) a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and [0221] (iii) a third domain with membrane permeabilising, destabilizing and/or disrupting activity. [0222]
2. The peptide according to paragraph 1, further comprising a fourth domain that is at least one protein transduction domain (PTD). [0223]
3. The peptide according to paragraph 1 or 2, wherein the first domain is a lysin, optionally an endolysin; a lysozyme; and/or an autolysin. [0224]
4. The peptide according to paragraph 3, wherein the endolysin is selected from the group consisting of structural endolysins, modular endolysins, globular endolysins. [0225]
5. The peptide according to paragraph 3 or 4, wherein the endolysin is a peptidoglycan hydrolase enzyme. [0226]
6. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the first domain is a LysA and/or at least one portion thereof, optionally wherein the portion thereof is at least one enzymatically active domain (EAD). [0227]
7. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the first domain comprises or consists of an amino sequence selected from any one of SEQ ID NOS: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14 or 326 to 338, or a variant, fragment, derivative or fusion thereof, or fusions of said fragments, variants and derivatives thereof, which retain the activity specific to peptidoglycan, [0228] or wherein the first domain is encoded by a nucleotide sequence selected from any one of SEQ ID NOS: 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11 and 13, or 313 to 325. [0229]
8. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the second domain is specific to the ester linkage between mycolic acid and arabinogalactan; or between mycolic acid and trehalose or between arabinogalactan and peptidoglycan. [0230]
9. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the second domain is derived from alpha/beta hydrolases, such as esterases, lipases and/or cutinases. [0231]
10. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the second domain is a mycolyl arabinogalactan esterase and/or a mycolyl-arabinogalactan-peptidoglycan (mAGP) hydrolase. [0232]
11. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the second domain is a LysB and/or at least one portion thereof, optionally wherein the portion thereof is at least one enzymatically active domain (EAD). [0233]
12. The peptide

according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the second domain comprises or consists of an amino sequence selected from any one of SEQ ID NOs: 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 26, 28, 30 or 32, or a variant, fragment, derivative or fusion thereof, or fusions of said fragments, variants and derivatives thereof, which retain the activity specific to peptidoglycan, [0234] or wherein the first domain is encoded by a nucleotide sequence selected from any one of SEQ ID NOs: 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 25, 27, 29 or 31. [0235] 13. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the first domain is LysA or a portion thereof and/or the second domain is LysB or a portion thereof, [0236] optionally wherein the LysA and/or LysB comprise a cell wall binding domain (CBD). [0237] 14. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the first domain is LysA or a portion thereof and comprises a cell wall binding domain (CBD) that is specific to the bacterial target of interest, optionally wherein the CBD is not specific to the cell walls of gram positive and/or gram negative bacteria, preferably wherein the CBD is specific to mycobacterial cell walls. [0238] 15. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the peptide comprises multiple domains corresponding to a first domain, second domain, third domain, and/or fourth domain; optionally wherein the multiple domains are: [0239] (i) repeats of the same domain; [0240] (ii) different domains but with the same type of activity; [0241] (iii) derived from the same source (for example, all domains may be from the same organism); [0242] (iv) derived from different sources (for example, any one or more of the domains may be from a different organism to any other domain). [0243] 16. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the third domain with membrane permeabilising, destabilizing and/or disrupting activity is an antimicrobial peptide (AMP) or portion thereof and/or a holin or portion thereof, [0244] optionally wherein the AMP or a portion thereof is cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic, amphipathic, synthetic or natural or any combination thereof (or comprises portions that are cationic, etc, or any combination thereof). [0245] 17. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the second domain comprises or consists of an amino sequence selected from any one of SEQ ID NOs: 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 26, 28, 30 or 32, or a variant, fragment, derivative or fusion thereof, or fusions of said fragments, variants and derivatives thereof, which retain the activity specific to peptidoglycan, [0246] or wherein the first domain is encoded by a nucleotide sequence selected from any one of SEQ ID NOs: 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 25, 27, 29 or 31. [0247] 18. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the domains are in the following order (N- to C-terminal): [0248] (a) at least one third domain—at least one second domain—at least one first domain; [0249] (b) at least one third domain—at least one first domain—at least one second domain; [0250] (c) at least one first domain—at least one second domain—at least one third domain; [0251] (d) at least one second domain—at least one first domain—at least one third domain; [0252] (e) at least one first domain—at least one third domain—at least one second domain; [0253] (f) at least one second domain—at least one third domain—at least one first domain; [0254] optionally wherein any of the peptides (or further, alternative configurations) further comprises at least one PTD and/or at least one linker, wherein the PTD and/or linker is at the N-terminus, C-terminus and/or between any of the domains. [0255] 19. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the peptide further comprises at least one linker peptide, wherein the linker peptide connects: [0256] (i) the first domain to the second domain; [0257] (ii) the second domain to the third domain; [0258] (iii) the first domain to the third domain; and/or [0259] optionally wherein at least one linker comprises an amino acid sequence [0260] selected from SEQ ID NOs: 104, 106, 108, 110, 112 or 114; [0261] optionally wherein the length of the linker is between 1 amino acid and about 10 amino acids, and/or not in excess of 100 amino acids. [0262] 20. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein the first domain and/or second domain comprises a domain with a mechanism of action selected from the group consisting of amidase, transglycosylase, muramidase and/or peptidase, N-acetylmuramoyl-L-alanine amidase, Amidases in general including all families, D-Alanine-meso-Diaminopimelic (DD) endopeptidase, c-D-glutamyl-meso-diaminopimelic acid (DL) peptidase, Endopeptidases in general including all families, lytic transglycosylases, N-acetylmuramidase, lysozyme, Chitinase, L-alanyl-D-glutamate (LD) endopeptidase, m-DAP-m-DAP (LD) endopeptidase in general, D-alanyl-D-alanine carboxypeptidase, Glycoside hydrolases in general including all families, L-Alanine-D-Glutamate peptidase, cysteine protease and N-acetyl-β-D-glucosaminidase, carboxypeptidase, glycosidase (glucosaminidases), transpeptidases, epimerase, Y-D-glutamyl-meso-diaminopimelic acid (DL) peptidases, and/or combinations thereof. [0263] 21. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein any one or more of the domains are effective against the phylum Actinobacteria; derived from the class Actinobacteridae; derived from the order Actinomycetales, and/or Bifidobacteriales. Optionally wherein at least one lysin is derived from a subclass and/or family selected from the list consisting of: Actinomycineae: Actinomycetaceae (*Actinomyces*, *Mobiluncus*); Corynebacterineae: Mycobacteriaceae (*Mycobacterium*), Nocardiaceae; Frankineae: Frankiaceae; Micrococcineae: Brevibacteriaceae; Propionibacteriaceae (*Propionibacterium*); Bifidobacteriaceae (*Bifidobacterium*, *Falcivibrio*, *Gardnerella*); Acidimicrobidae, Coriobacteridae, Rubrobacteridae, Sphaerobacteridae. [0264] 22. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein any one or more of the domains are effective against *Mycobacterium* selected from the group consisting of: *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium microti*, *Mycobacterium africanum*, *Mycobacterium bovis*, *Mycobacterium canettii*, *Mycobacterium pinnipedii*, *Mycobacterium caprae*, *Mycobacterium mungi*, *Mycobacterium leprae*, *Mycobacterium ulcerans*, *Mycobacterium xenopi*, *Mycobacterium shottsii*, *Mycobacterium avium*, *Mycobacterium avium* subsp. *paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium intracellulare*, *Mycobacterium smegmatis*, *Mycobacterium abscessus*, *Mycobacterium kansasii*, *Mycobacterium terrae*, *Mycobacterium nonchromogenicum*, *Mycobacterium gordonae*, and *Mycobacterium triviale*, and non-tuberculosis mycobacteria (NTM). [0265] 23. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein any one or more of the domains are derived from at least one mycobacteriophage, optionally wherein the mycobacteriophage is selected from the group consisting of: TM4, D29, L5, Bxz2, Saal, Enkosi, Ms6, Omega, Obama12, Echid, DS6A, Pumpkin or any other mycobacteriophage as listed

in The Actinobacteriophage Database. [0266] 24. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein any one or more of the domains are a mutant, variant or wildtype domain. [0267] 25. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph, wherein at least one of the domains is a mutant or variant that comprises at least 10%, 20%, 30%, 40%, 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, 95%, 96%, 97%, 98%, 99% or 100% of a wildtype sequence, optionally wherein the mutant or variant retains substantially the same level of activity of the wildtype domain. [0268] 26. A composition comprising a peptide as defined by any preceding paragraph, optionally wherein the composition comprises one or more further agents (e.g. pharmaceutically acceptable excipients). [0269] 27. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph for use in medicine, including veterinary medicine. [0270] 28. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph for use in targeting a cell envelope comprising: [0271] (i) an outer leaflet and inner leaflet; [0272] (ii) an arabinogalactan layer; [0273] (iii) a mycolic acid layer; [0274] (iv) a peptidoglycan layer; [0275] (v) a periplasmic space; [0276] (vi) a granular layer; and/or [0277] (vii) an inner membrane. [0278] 29. The peptide according to any preceding paragraph for use in: [0279] (i) promoting wound healing [0280] (ii) treating infection, optionally wherein the infection is mycobacterial infection or when the infection is caused by non-tuberculous mycobacteria (NTM) [0281] (iii) treating active tuberculosis and/or latent tuberculosis; [0282] (iv) treating respiratory, ocular, skin, oral and/or dental infections; [0283] (v) ocular, skin, oral and/or dental procedures; [0284] (vi) sterilisation (e.g. sterilisation via biocidal activity, wherein the peptide is acting as a biocide); [0285] (vii) treating granulomas; and/or [0286] (viii) treating biofilms. [0287] 30. The peptide, composition, and/or use of any preceding paragraph, wherein the bacterium (such as the *Mycobacterium*) is resistant to at least one drug, optionally at least 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 or more drugs; and/or is classified as multidrug-resistant (MDR), extremely drug-resistant (XDR), or totally drug-resistant (TDR). [0288] 31. A polynucleotide comprising a nucleic acid encoding the peptide according to any preceding paragraph. [0289] 32. A vector comprising a peptide according to any preceding paragraph, and/or the nucleic acid according to paragraph 31. [0290] 33. A cell comprising a peptide according to any preceding paragraph, the nucleic acid according to paragraph 31, and/or the vector according to paragraph 32. [0291] 34. The peptide or composition for use of any preceding paragraph, wherein the peptide/composition is used in combination with at least one additional therapeutic agent, optionally wherein the additional therapeutic agent is one or more anti-mycobacterial agent, such as a mycobacterial chemotherapeutic. [0292] 35. An in vitro method of lysing, killing, reducing growth of, and/or reducing viability of mycobacteria, wherein the method comprises administering a peptide according to any preceding paragraph. [0293] 36. A (medical) device comprising a peptide according to any preceding paragraph. [0294] 37. A kit comprising an agent according to any preceding paragraph, optionally wherein the kit further comprises instructions for use. [0295] 38. A peptide, composition, use of a peptide or composition, a method of treatment or diagnosis, or a kit substantially as defined herein with reference to the description.

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## Description

### FIGURE LEGENDS

[0296] FIG. 1: Schematic structure of mycobacterial cell envelope showing the target sites for Antimicrobial peptides (AMPs) acting on the inner and outer membranes, LysB enzymes hydrolyzing the ester bond that connects mycolic acid to the arabinogalactan-peptidoglycan and LysA enzymes that hydrolyze the peptidoglycan layer of the cell wall (Vincent et al., 2018).

[0297] FIG. 2: SDS-PAGE of some clones of the constructed library 1 expressed in LB medium, at 16° C. for 72 hr. L1: Molecular weight ladder (Allblue). L2: Clone 1A7 soluble fraction (MW: 53 kDa). L3: Clone 1A7 insoluble fraction (MW: 53 kDa). L4: Clone 1A11 Soluble fraction. L5: Clone 1A11 insoluble fraction (MW: 50 kDa). L6: Clone 1B4 Soluble fraction (MW: 95 kDa). L7: Clone 1B4 insoluble fraction (MW: 95 kDa). L8: Clone 1B6 Soluble fraction (MW: 50 kDa). L9: Clone 1B6 insoluble fraction (MW: 50 kDa). L10: Clone 1B7 soluble fraction (MW: 97 kDa). L11: Clone 1B7 Insoluble fraction (MW: 97 kDa). L12: Clone 1B7 LB medium supernatant (MW: 97 kDa). L13: Clone 1B8 Soluble fraction (MW: 100 kDa). L14: Clone 1B8 insoluble fraction (MW: 100 kDa). L15: Clone 1A11 LB medium supernatant (MW: 50 kDa).

[0298] FIG. 3: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 1 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0299] FIG. 4: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 2 (AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0300] FIG. 5: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 3 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-D10 (i.e. A1-A12, B1-B12, C1-C12 and D1-D10) represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells

having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0301] FIG. 6: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Nocardia iowensis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 1 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *Nocardia iowensis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=0.65).

[0302] FIG. 7: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Nocardia iowensis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 2 (AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD) were mixed with 50 µl of *Nocardia iowensis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=0.65).

[0303] FIG. 8: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Nocardia iowensis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 3 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD) were mixed with 50 µl of *Nocardia iowensis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-D10 (i.e. A1-A12, B1-B12, C1-C12 and D1-D10) represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=0.65).

[0304] FIG. 9: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Rhodococcus erythropolis* 108 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 1 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *Rhodococcus erythropolis* 108 with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=0.43).

[0305] FIG. 10: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Rhodococcus erythropolis* 108 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 2 (AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD) were mixed with 50 µl of *Rhodococcus erythropolis* 108 with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=0.43).

[0306] FIG. 11: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Rhodococcus erythropolis* 108 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 3 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD) were mixed with 50 µl of *Rhodococcus erythropolis* 108 with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-D10 (i.e. A1-A12, B1-B12, C1-C12 and D1-D10) represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=0.43).

[0307] FIG. 12: Percentage killing efficiency of 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 1 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA) mixed with 50 µl of *Mycobacterium bovis* BCG strain with inoculum size of 106 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate.

[0308] FIG. 13: Percentage killing efficiency of 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 2 (AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD) mixed with 50 µl of *Mycobacterium bovis* BCG strain with inoculum size of 106 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate.

[0309] FIG. 14: Percentage killing efficiency of 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 3 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD) mixed with 50 µl of *Mycobacterium bovis* BCG strain with inoculum size of 106 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. A1-D10 (i.e. A1-A12, B1-B12, C1-C12 and D1-D10) represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate.

[0310] FIG. 15: Percentage killing efficiency of 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 1 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA) mixed with 50 µl of *Mycobacterium abscessus* with inoculum size of 10.sup.7 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate.

[0311] FIG. 16: Percentage killing efficiency of 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 2 (AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD) mixed with 50 µl of *Mycobacterium abscessus* with inoculum size of 10.sup.7 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate.

[0312] FIG. 17: Percentage killing efficiency of 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 3 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD) mixed with 50 µl of *Mycobacterium abscessus* with inoculum size of 10.sup.7 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. A1-D10 (i.e. A1-A12, B1-B12, C1-C12 and D1-D10) represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate.

[0313] FIG. 18: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 4 (AMP-LysB) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0314] FIG. 19: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after



24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 5 (AMP-Linker-LysB) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0315] FIG. 20: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 6 (AMP-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0316] FIG. 21: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 7 (AMP-Linker-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0317] FIG. 22: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 8 (AMP-EAD) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0318] FIG. 23: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 9 (AMP-Linker-EAD) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0319] FIG. 24: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.5 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 10 (LysB-Linker-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.5 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1.

[0320] FIG. 25: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.5 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 11 (LysB-Linker-EADs) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.5 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1.

[0321] FIG. 26: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of 50 µl *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.5 CFU/ml mixed with 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from LysB enzymes after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of Mueller-Hinton broth mixed with 50 µl *M. smegmatis* cells 10.sup.5 CFU/ml was considered as positive control (OD=0.4). Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1.

[0322] FIG. 27: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of 50 µl *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.5 CFU/ml mixed with 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from LysA enzymes after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of Mueller-Hinton broth mixed with 50 µl *M. smegmatis* cells 10.sup.5 CFU/ml was considered as positive control (OD=0.4). Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1.

[0323] FIG. 28: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of 50 µl *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.5 CFU/ml mixed with 50 µl of clarified cell lysate prepared from some selected Enzyme Active Domains (EADs) after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of Mueller-Hinton broth mixed with 50 µl *M. smegmatis* cells 10.sup.5 CFU/ml was considered as positive control (OD=0.4). Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1.

[0324] FIG. 29: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 1 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0325] FIG. 30: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 2 (AMP-LysB-Linker-EAD) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0326] FIG. 31: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 3 (AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA-PTD) were mixed

with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-D12, B1-B12, C1-C12 and D1-D10) represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0327] FIG. 32: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 12 (AMP-LysA-Linker-LysB) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0328] FIG. 33: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 12 (AMP-LysA-Linker-LysB) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0329] FIG. 34: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 13 (AMP-EAD-Linker-LysB) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0330] FIG. 35: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 13 (AMP-EAD-Linker-LysB) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0331] FIG. 36: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 14 (LysB-Linker-LysA-AMP) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0332] FIG. 37: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 14 (LysB-Linker-LysA-AMP) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0333] FIG. 38: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 15 (LysA-Linker-LysB-AMP) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0334] FIG. 39: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 15 (LysA-Linker-LysB-AMP) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0335] FIG. 40: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 16 (LysB-AMP-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *M. smegmatis* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.3).

[0336] FIG. 41: Optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) of microtiter plate of *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml after 24 hours incubation at 37° C. Fifty microliters of clarified cell lysate prepared from library 16 (LysB-AMP-LysA) were mixed with 50 µl of *E. coli* with inoculum size of 10.sup.8 CFU/ml. A1-H12 represents the positions of different constructs from the library within a 96-well plate. Wells with OD<0.1, indicating strong antibacterial activity, are marked with black colour and hit rate is the percentage of wells having OD<0.1. Positive control (OD.sub.625 nm=1.4).

[0337] FIG. 42: A comparison of the growth curve based on optical density (OD.sub.625 nm) for various clones (AMP-LysB, AMP-LysA and 4D10) in LB medium. AMP=Ci-MAM-A24, LysB=D29, Linker=Linker 1, and LysA=TM4. 4D10 includes each component, culminating in [Ci-MAM-A24]-[D29]-[Linker]-[TM4]. Optical density positively correlates with expression levels, in that a higher optical density means a higher level of expression of the peptide. 4D10 shows considerably faster expression compared with both AMP-LysB and AMP-LysA.

[0338] FIG. 43: A comparison of the antimycobacterial activity against *M. smegmatis* for LysA alone; LysB alone; a mixture of LysA and LysB; AMP-LysA alone; AMP-LysB alone; a mixture of AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB; and AMP-

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## EXAMPLES

### Example 1

#### Materials and Methods

[0380] Different LysB and LysA genes were codon optimized and synthesized as gene fragments (gBlock) (FIG. 2) from Integrated DNA Technologies (IDT, Leuven, Belgium). The gene fragments were amplified with PCR using Phusion® High fidelity DNA polymerase (Thermo Scientific®, Pittsburgh, PA, USA) to include the restriction site of the BsaI restriction enzyme using the following PCR primers (SEQ ID NOs: 115-146, see Table 1) and cloned into pVTSEIII cloning vector with the aid of BsaI restriction enzyme and transformed into *E. coli* TOP 10 cloning host (Grimon et al., 2019).

TABLE-US-00008 TABLE 1 PCR primers. Target Forward Primer (5'-3') Reverse Primer (5'-3') LysB\_D29 GCAGCTCTTC AAGAGGTCTC AGTGCAAGCA CTTGCTCTTCGCTTGGTCTC GCCTGCGATC AGCCCTGGCT G TGTCGTAGGA ACTCGACCGC (SEQ ID NO: 115) (SEQ ID NO: 116) LysB\_Omega GTAGCTCTTC CAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTTTGA GCAGCTCTTCGCTTGGTCTCGCCTGCATTT ACGGTGAATT TTACGTTCCG GTTACGAAGTT CATTGCCCGT GC (SEQ ID NO: 117) (SEQ ID NO: 118) LysB\_Saal TCAGCTCTTC CAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTCGCA CGAGCTCTTC CCTTGGTCTC TCGACGGTCA ATATGTG GCCTGCTGTG CGCAGGTAAT CGATCG (SEQ ID NO: 119) (SEQ ID NO: 120) LysB\_DS6A GTCGCTCTTC CAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTACCTATTGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC GGATTGGCTG GC GCCTGCCGCG GCTAAAGCCA AGC (SEQ ID NO: 121) (SEQ ID NO: 122) LysB\_ATGGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTCTGA TGTGCTCTTC ACTTGGTCTC Obama12 AGTTAGGATC AAACGGGC GCCTGCTGTT ACAGACGCGA CAATGCG (SEQ ID NO: 123) (SEQ ID NO: 124) LysB\_Enkosi GCTGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTTCTA GTTGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC AGCCTGTGCT GTTACTGC ACCTGCGGCG GCCATAGCGC G (SEQ ID NO: 125) (SEQ ID NO: 126) LysB\_Bxz2 TCGGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTCCGT AGTGCTCTTCACTTGGTCTCGCCTGCTGAG TACGCGTGGG C CGAAGAAAAT CAATCGCCG (SEQ ID NO: 127) (SEQ ID NO: 128) LysB\_L5 CGTGCTCTTCTAGAGGTCTC TGTGCTAGTA GCCGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC AACCGTGGTT ATTTACTGTG CGCCTGCAATG CGACGCAGAA ATTCTACG (SEQ ID NO: 129) (SEQ ID NO: 130) LysB\_Ms6 CTCGCTCTTCTAGAGGTCTC GGTGCTCGTA ATCGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC TCGACGGCCA ATATGTTGG GCCTGCCGTG CGGAGATAGT CG (SEQ ID NO: 131) (SEQ ID NO: 132) LysA\_DS6A TATGCTCTTCTAGAGGTCTC CTAGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC GGAAGCATGTAACTGTAGAGAGCTTCGCTGC TGAGCCACGA CCAGCTTCGC GATCTGC (SEQ ID NO: 133) (SEQ ID NO: 134) LysA\_BTCU GTAGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC AGAAGCACAG GTTGCTCTTCGCTTGGTCTC TGAGCCTTGT AGCGTGTCTT GC TCAATAATGC GATTATGTGT AAC (SEQ ID NO: 135) (SEQ ID NO: 136) LysA\_Bxb1 TCAGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGAAGCCCTC CGAGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC GCGTGGTCTA TGGTC TGAGCCCGCC GCGTGAAATT TCTG (SEQ ID NO: 137) (SEQ ID NO: 138) LysA\_D29 GTCGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGAAGCACCT TGTGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC TGATTGTAAC GCGCG TGAGCCTAAC GCGCCGTTGC G (SEQ ID NO: 139) (SEQ ID NO: 140) LysA\_Giles ATCGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGAAGCCCTG TGTGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC TCTATGCGAT TCAGTCTG TGAGCCCAA ACCAGGCCGA TTTTGG (SEQ ID NO: 141) (SEQ ID NO: 142) LysA\_Ms6 ACTGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGAAGCACTA TGCGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC CAAAGGACCA GGTAGCG TGAGCCATGT CCCAGCAACT CCG (SEQ ID NO: 143) (SEQ ID NO: 144) LysA\_TM4 GCTGCTCTTC TAGAGGTCTC GGAAGCTCAT GTAGCTCTTC GCTTGGTCTC TTACGCGCTT TCTCCAAG TGAGCCTGCC GCGCCACCAT C (SEQ ID NO: 145) (SEQ ID NO: 146)

[0381] The transformation mixtures were plated on LB agar plates supplemented with ampicillin (100 µg/ml) and 5% sucrose as selection markers. Plasmids were extracted from colonies 5 and were verified by sequencing (LGC genomics GmbH, Berlin, Germany). The clones with the right sequences were used as tiles for library construction and further in DNA shuffling reactions. Glycerol stocks of the tiles with the correct sequences cloned in pVTSEIII and transformed into *E. coli* Top 10 were prepared and stored at -80° C.

#### Construction of Libraries

[0382] To construct a library for DNA shuffling, different tiles comprising different sets of enzymes were assembled

together according to their required positions into pVTSDI, II and III expression vectors with the aid of SapI restriction enzyme (Grimon et al., 2019).

[0383] The positions in the final assembly of the DNA shuffling reactions were as follows: [0384] For library 1: N-terminal 6×Histag from pVTSDI expression vector followed by different variants of antimicrobial peptides (AMPs) with different properties (cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic or amphipathic) are in position 1, LysB enzyme variants in position 2, linkers with different properties (flexible or rigid, helix or coil, short or long) are in position 3 and finally LysA enzyme variants with different mechanisms of actions are in position 4. [0385] For library 2: antimicrobial peptides (AMPs) variants with different properties (cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic or amphipathic) are in position 1, LysB enzyme variants in position 2, linkers with different properties (flexible or rigid) are in position 3 and finally different variants of enzyme active domains (EADs) with different mechanisms of actions are in position 4 followed by 6×Histag from the pVTSDIII expression vector. [0386] For library 3: variants of antimicrobial peptides (AMPs) with different properties (cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic or amphipathic) are in position 1, LysB enzymes in position 2, linkers with different properties (flexible or rigid) are in position 3 and finally LysA enzymes with different mechanisms of actions are in position 4 and finally protein transduction domains (PTDs) in position 5 followed by 6×Histag from the pVTSDIII expression vector. Moreover, different libraries were constructed for exclusion criteria, through removing one of the modules, the libraries are summarized in Table 2. The libraries were constructed with the aid of SapI restriction enzyme and T4 DNA ligase enzyme with the following cycling parameters (Table 3) in a thermal cycler.

TABLE-US-00009 TABLE 2 Organization and positions of the modules in the designed libraries. Library Pos1 Pos2 Pos3 Pos4 Pos5 1 AMPs LysB Linker LysA — 2 AMPs LysB Linker EADs 3 AMPs LysB Linker LysA PTDs 4 AMPs LysB — — 5 AMPs Linker LysB — — 6 AMPs LysA — — 7 AMPs Linker LysA — — 8 AMPs EADs — — — 9 AMPs Linker EADs — — 10 LysB Linker LysA — — 11 LysB Linker EADs — —

[0387] Swapping the positions of any of the components in Table 2 would not be expected to impact the functionality of the peptides derived from said libraries. For example, swapping LysA and LysB in libraries 1-3 would be expected to yield peptides with similar activities as those derived from libraries 1-3. Likewise, the AMP may be N-terminal, C-terminal or between other domains, without negatively impacting the overall activity of peptides derived from such libraries. Further, increasing the number of modules (e.g. having AMP at both termini) may be expected to enhance activity further.

TABLE-US-00010 TABLE 3 Thermal cycler parameters used for the shuffling reactions (Grimon et al., 2019, US 2019/0323017 A1). Temperature Number Step (° C.) Time of cycles Restriction 37° C. 2 min 30 Ligation 16° C. 3 min Ligase inactivation 50° C. 5 min 1 Type IIs inactivation 65° C. 20 min 1

#### Expression of Libraries

[0388] The ligation mixture comprising different libraries was transformed into chemically competent *E. coli* codon plus expression host according to the manufacturer's instructions and plated on LB agar plates supplemented with kanamycin (50 µg/ml) and 5% sucrose as selection markers and incubated at 37° C. for overnight.

[0389] For preculture preparation, colonies were picked up with sterile toothpicks and used to inoculate 200 µl of LB medium in 96 well sterile plates supplemented with kanamycin (50 µg/ml) and 5% sucrose as selection markers and incubated at 37° C. for overnight, 100 µl of the 96 well preculture plates were used to prepare glycerol stocks and stored at -20° C.

[0390] Each well contains a different clone, i.e. the 96 well plate is representing 96 different clones. For expression of libraries, 20 µl of the precultures were added to 500 µl of autoinduction medium (containing per liter: 10 g α-lactose, 2.5 g glucose, 5 g glycerol, 2 mM KH.sub.2PO.sub.4, 2 mM MgSO.sub.4, 50 mM Na.sub.2HPO.sub.4, 25 mM (NH.sub.4).sub.2SO.sub.4, 5 g yeast extract and 10 g of tryptone) in 96 deep well plates. The deep well plates were incubated at 37° C., 1000 rpm (IKA-Vibramax-VXR; IKA-Labortechnik, Staufen, Germany) for the first 4 hours and then continued for 48 hours at 30° C. The cells were harvested by centrifugation (4500 rpm, 4° C., 20 min, Sigma 3-16PK), the supernatant was discarded, and the cell pellet was used for cell lysate preparation. *E. coli* codon plus expression strain transformed with blank plasmids (plasmids without any inserts) were subjected to the same cultivation and expression conditions and used as controls.

[0391] The clarified cell lysate was loaded on SDS-PAGE to check the expression levels of the induced clones. For expression, LB medium was applied. The inocula was prepared by inoculating 10 ml LB medium supplied with kanamycin (50 µg/ml) with 50 µl glycerol stock of the corresponding clones, incubated overnight at 37° C., 200 rpm. The inocula were used to inoculate 100 ml of LB medium supplemented with kanamycin (50 µg/ml) and incubated at 37° C., 200 rpm till the OD600.sub.nm of ≈0.5-0.6. For induction, IPTG was added to a final concentration of 1 mM and the cultivation was continued at 30° C. for extra 4 hours.

[0392] To test the effect of temperature on the expression levels and the solubility of the induced proteins, induction with IPTG (1 mM) was performed at 16° C., 180 rpm for 72 hours. To check the expression levels and solubility of the expressed proteins, samples were taken at the end of the induction period and checked by SDS-PAGE.

#### Preparation of Cell Lysate

[0393] The cells were lysed by exposure to chloroform vapours, the deep-well plates were put upside-down in a glass chamber containing filter papers on its bottom. Twenty milliliters of chloroform were added, then immediately the glass chamber was sealed, and the deep well plates were incubated above a chloroform-saturated filter papers for 2 hours in the fume hood.

[0394] Later on, the plates were inverted and set to stand for another 15 minutes in the fume hood, the cell pellet was resuspended in 500 µl of resuspension buffer (50 mM Tris-HCL, 50 mM NaCl, pH 8) supplemented with 1 U of DNase I enzyme and incubated at 30° C., 100 rpm for 1 hour. The cell debris was removed by centrifugation (4500 rpm, 4° C., 60 min, Sigma 3-16PK) and the clarified cell lysate was stored at 4° C. for further screening. LB cultures were lysed using BugBuster® (Novagen, Madison, WI, USA) cell lysis solution according to the manufacturer's instructions. The lysed cell suspension was centrifuged at 14000 rpm, 30 min at 20° C. The crude extract as well as the cell debris (after resuspension in the same starting volume in 50 mM Tris, 50 mM NaCl, pH 8) were loaded to SDS-PAGE.

#### Screening of the Antibacterial Activity of the Expressed Libraries

[0395] Screening of the antibacterial activity was done through antibacterial (growth) assay method. Any suitable screening method can be used to determine activity of the library, and screening methods are known to the skilled person, such as the screening method used in Gerstmans et al., 2020 and Tenland et al., 2018 and Van Schie et al. 2021.

[0396] Briefly, the inocula of the test strains (*Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 155; ATCC 700084, *Mycobacterium abscessus*, *Nocardia iowensis*, *Rhodococcus erythropolis* and *Staphylococcus aureus*) were grown overnight in Mueller-Hinton broth (MH) broth at 37° C., 200 rpm. For initial screening of the antibacterial activity, the final inoculum size (bacterial load) of the *M. smegmatis* in the assay was adjusted to ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.5}$  CFU/ml) through dilution in 2×MHB. To increase the stringency of the assay conditions the final inoculum size of *M. smegmatis* in the assay was adjusted ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.7}$  CFU/ml) and ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.8}$  CFU/ml). For the assay, 50 µl of different inoculum size was mixed with 50 µl of the clarified cell lysate in a microtiter plate and incubated at 37° C. for 24 h.

[0397] Endpoint measurement at OD<sub>625</sub> nm was performed in a microplate reader (Multiskan™ GO Microplate Spectrophotometer, Thermo Scientific) after 24 h and the MIC can be determined by eye as well. For determination of the bactericidal effect, 50 µl of the clear wells (wells with no growth) was spotted in LB agar and incubated for 24 h at 37° C. and examined for growth. A well with 100 µl 2×MH broth served as negative control, another well with the test strain only was considered as positive control. For screening against *Mycobacterium bovis bacillus* Calmette-Guerin (BCG), BCG expressing luxAB was diluted in Middlebrook 7H9 medium (106 CFU; 50 µl/well) in 96-well opaque white plates (Corning).

[0398] Fifty microliters of the clarified cell lysate were added to the wells, the plates were incubated at 37° C. for 24 h before adding 0.1% n-decyl aldehyde (Decanal, Sigma), a substrate for bacterial luciferase. Bioluminescence was measured as relative luminescence unit (RLU) for 1 s using a TriStar2 microplate reader (Berthold Technologies) (Tenland et al., 2018).

#### Results

##### Library Construction

[0399] The correct assembly of the libraries was checked through sequencing (GATC Biotech AB, Solna, Sweden) of the shuffled enzymes and peptides each on its correct position. Sequencing analysis of the sequenced clones was done using Geneious prime software, (Geneious version 2020.1.2; Biomatters Ltd., Auckland, New Zealand).

##### Expression of the Constructed Libraries

[0400] The expression levels of the expressed libraries were checked on SDS-PAGE. The expression levels of the initial expression screening of the constructed libraries were quite low, no protein bands corresponding to the estimated molecular mass of the expressed clones were detected on SDS-PAGE (FIG. 2). On the other hand, expression in LB medium resulted in decent expression levels corresponding to the calculated molecular mass both at 30° C. and 16° C., however the majority of the expressed proteins are in the insoluble fraction (FIG. 2).

##### Screening of the Expressed Libraries

[0401] The initial screening of most the constructed libraries was done against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 155 strain with a bacterial load of ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.5}$  CFU/ml) and resulted in many active hits (Data not shown). The test stringency was increased to make a filtration/selection criterion through gradual increase of the bacterial load from ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.5}$  up to  $4 \times 10^{5.8}$  CFU/ml). The data was normalized by subtraction from the negative control well.

[0402] Wells with no visible bacterial growth both at the end of the incubation period and after subculture on LB agar plates were considered as positive antibacterial activity hits. Wells with bacterial growth were compared with the positive control well for identification of any inhibitory effect of the expressed clones in the corresponding wells.

[0403] Library 1 with the organization (AMPs-LysB-Linker-LysA) exhibited the highest numbers of positive active hits against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 155 strain with a bacterial load of ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.8}$  CFU/ml) (FIG. 3).

[0404] Screening of the second library against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 155 strain with a bacterial load of ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.8}$  CFU/ml) resulted in much lower number of active variants (FIG. 4), potentially due to a lack of the cell wall binding domains (CBD) that are present in LysA enzymes shuffled in the first library. The proposed function of the cell wall binding domain is to bring the catalytic domain to a proximity of the peptidoglycan thus facilitating its interaction with the peptidoglycan layer of the mycobacterial cell wall. Moreover, LysA enzymes are modular enzymes comprising more than one catalytic domain with different mechanisms of action targeting different bonds in the peptidoglycan structure and a cell wall binding domain.

[0405] Due to the limited transformation efficiency of the third library, only few clones were transformed and screened against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 155 strain ( $\approx 4 \times 10^{5.8}$  CFU/ml) with some active hits were obtained (FIG. 5).

[0406] The expressed libraries (1, 2 and 3) were also tested for their antibacterial activities against different species from

the order Actinomycetales including *Nocardia iowensis* (FIGS. 6-8) and *Rhodococcus erythropolis* (FIGS. 9-11) and resulted in some clones with antibacterial activity. The expressed libraries were also tested for their antibacterial activity against some pathogenic strains including *Mycobacterium bovis bacillus Calmette-Guerin* (BCG) and *Mycobacterium abscessus* strains. The antibacterial activity against *Mycobacterium bovis bacillus Calmette-Guerin* (BCG) was expressed as percentage of growth inhibition of the bacterial cells compared to positive control (FIGS. 12-14). The majority of the expressed clones from libraries 1, 2 and 3 showed a potential antibacterial activity against BCG strain with % antibacterial efficiency up to 98% (FIGS. 12-14).

[0407] On the other hand, the antibacterial activity against the pathogenic *Mycobacterium abscessus* was expressed as 99, 90 and 0% inhibition in comparison with positive control (FIGS. 15-17). Almost half of the expressed clones from the library 1 showed antibacterial inhibition against *Mycobacterium abscessus* with 6 clones demonstrated 99% inhibition (FIG. 15). Moreover, only 14 clones expressed from library 2 were positive against *Mycobacterium abscessus* with 3 variants showed 99% inhibition (FIG. 16). On the contrary, only 2 variants expressed from library 3 inhibited the growth of *Mycobacterium abscessus* by 95% (FIG. 17).

[0408] For exclusion criteria, different libraries with domain organizations were constructed and screened. Expressed clones from library 4 (AMPs-LysB) did not exhibit antimycobacterial activity against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* (FIG. 18).

[0409] Addition of linkers between AMPs and LysB enzymes was used to construct library 5 (AMPs-Linkers-LysB), which did not exhibit antimycobacterial activity after expression against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* (FIG. 19).

[0410] Library 6 was constructed by direct fusion of AMPs with LysA enzymes and failed to express antimycobacterial activity against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* as well (FIG. 20).

[0411] Separating the AMPs from LysA enzymes by linkers was the basis to design library 7 which upon screening against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* did not show antimycobacterial activity (FIG. 21). The enzyme active domains (EADs) were either fused directly to AMPs (library 8) or via linkers (library 9) which did not result in antimycobacterial activity upon testing against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* (FIGS. 22 and 23).

[0412] Furthermore, different libraries had been constructed through excluding the AMPs, LysB enzymes were shuffled with either LysA enzymes (library 10) or EADs (library 11). It seems that the AMPs are crucial for exerting the antibacterial activity, since there was no antibacterial activity was detected for libraries 10 and 11 against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* with a bacterial load of 10<sup>sup</sup>.5 CFU/ml (FIGS. 24 and 25).

[0413] In addition, LysB, LysA enzymes as well as EADs were cloned individually and expressed in *E. coli* codon plus expression host and their antibacterial activity was also tested. None of the respective enzymes exhibited antibacterial activity against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* with a bacterial load of 10<sup>sup</sup>.5 CFU/ml (FIGS. 26-28) suggesting that the antibacterial activity is a result of synergistic effect of LysB, LysA/EADs and AMPs.

[0414] AMPs that are active against gram negative or Gram-positive bacteria (which may have no activity when tested against mycobacteria) can be combined with LysB and LysA/EAD to result in peptides capable of activity against *Mycobacterium*. Alternatively, AMPs with activity specific to mycobacteria may be used.

[0415] Peptides resembling those of US 2017/0136102 A1 (Sharma) failed to demonstrate activity against *Mycobacterium*, even in the presence of anti-TB drugs. The Sharma peptides are comprised of an AMP with LysB but lack any LysA (or LysA-like domain/EAD), and so it is not unexpected that such peptides actually fail to produce antimycobacterial activity.

[0416] The expressed libraries (1, 2 and 3) were tested for their antibacterial selectivity/specificity through testing against Gram-positive and negative strains. A representative of the pathogenic Gram-positive tested bacterial strain is *Staphylococcus aureus*, against which none of the expressed clones from the corresponding libraries (1, 2 and 3) showed bacterial growth inhibition (Data not shown). In the same context, the expressed libraries (1, 2 and 3) did not exhibit bactericidal activity against the Gram-negative tested *E. coli* strain (FIGS. 29-31). Altogether, these data indicate that the specificity/selectivity of the expressed libraries (1, 2 and 3) is against mycobacterial strains only.

TABLE-US-00011 TABLE 4 Constructs showing antimycobacterial activity

| Library                 | Pos1 | Pos2 | Pos3                  | Pos4                  | Pos5 | activity |
|-------------------------|------|------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------|----------|
| 1 AMPs LysB Linker LysA | —    | YES  | 2                     | AMPs LysB Linker EADs | YES  | 3        |
| 2 AMPs LysB Linker EADs | YES  | 3    | AMPs LysB Linker LysA | PTDs                  | YES  | 4        |
| 3 AMPs LysB Linker LysA | PTDs | YES  | 4                     | AMPs LysB             | —    | —        |
| 4 AMPs LysB             | —    | —    | NO                    | 5 AMPs Linker LysB    | —    | —        |
| 5 AMPs Linker LysB      | —    | —    | NO                    | 6 AMPs LysA           | —    | —        |
| 6 AMPs LysA             | —    | —    | NO                    | 7 AMPs Linker LysA    | —    | —        |
| 7 AMPs Linker LysA      | —    | —    | NO                    | 8 AMPs EADs           | —    | —        |
| 8 AMPs EADs             | —    | —    | NO                    | 9 AMPs Linker EADs    | —    | —        |
| 9 AMPs Linker EADs      | —    | —    | NO                    | 10 LysB Linker LysA   | —    | —        |
| 10 LysB Linker LysA     | —    | —    | NO                    | 11 LysB Linker EADs   | —    | —        |
| 11 LysB Linker EADs     | —    | —    | NO                    |                       |      |          |

## CONCLUSION

[0417] For all libraries prepared, only a small fraction of the possible combinations has been tested as a proof in principle for workable fusions of particular configurations. Therefore, the exemplified hits in libraries should not be construed as being the only hits that work for a particular library. The key point is that the proof in principle data shows that workable constructs can be developed of certain configurations (i.e. those that contain (i) a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, (ii) a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and (iii) a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity), while configurations lacking these essential components always fail to demonstrate antimycobacterial activity unless they are used in particular mixtures.

## Example 2

[0418] After observing the positive findings for Libraries 1-3, additional libraries were constructed in which the domains present, and their positioning within the fusion protein, were altered (see Table 5). The same screening approach was



performed as with Example 1.

TABLE-US-00012 TABLE 5 Additional constructs showing antimycobacterial activity Anti- mycobacterial Library Pos1 Pos2 Pos3 Pos4 Pos5 activity 12 AMPs LysA Linker LysB — YES 13 AMPs EAD Linker LysB — YES 14 LysB Linker LysA AMP — YES 15 LysA Linker LysB AMP — YES 16 LysB AMP LysA — — YES

[0419] Library 12 with the organization (AMPs-LysA-Linker-LysB) exhibited the highest numbers of positive active hits against *Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 155 strain with a bacterial load of ( $\approx 4 \times 10^8$  CFU/ml) (FIG. 32), at a slightly higher rate than was seen for Library 1.

[0420] Library 13 resulted in a much lower number of active variants (FIG. 34), potentially due to a lack of the cell wall binding domains (CBD) that are present in LysA enzymes shuffled in the first library, as hypothesised previously with respect to Libraries 1 and 2.

[0421] The domains of Library 12 were reversed to form Library 14. This means that the orientation of each domain is flipped, such that the previous N- to C-terminal fusions of Library 12 are instead in a C- to N-configuration for Library 14. For example, an exemplary peptide of Library 12 may be comprised of SEQ ID NOs: 58+12+108+16, from N-terminus to C-terminus, meaning that the C-terminus of SEQ ID NO: 58 is fused to the N-terminus of SEQ ID NO: 12, and so on. The reversed peptide of Library 14 would therefore be SEQ ID NOs: 16+108+12+58, from N-terminus to C-terminus, meaning that the N-terminus of SEQ ID NO: 58 is fused to the C-terminus of SEQ ID NO: 12, and so on.

[0422] Library 12 exhibited a hit rate of 46.9%, and reversing the orientation of the domains maintained a hit rate of 36.5%.

[0423] The domains of Library 1 were also reversed to form Library 15 (in the same way as Libraries 12 and 14 with respect to each other). However, despite reorientation of the domains in the fusion protein, a number of successful hits for antimycobacterial fusion peptides were identified.

[0424] These reorientation data demonstrate that the domains of the fusion peptide can be in either orientation with respect to each other, while maintaining the beneficial properties of the fusion peptides.

[0425] A further library (library 16) was developed that used AMP domains in place of a linker between LysB and LysA (i.e. LysB-AMP-LysA fusion peptides), to form 3-domain fusion peptides that exclude the linkers described herein. A number of successful hits for antimycobacterial fusion peptides were identified, thereby demonstrating that a linker is not essential for retaining the beneficial properties of the fusion peptides. An alternative way to consider library 16 is that the AMP acts as a linker between LysA and LysB.

[0426] As previously shown for libraries 1-3, in the same context, the expressed libraries (12-16) did not exhibit bactericidal activity against the Gram-negative tested *E. coli* strain (FIGS. 33, 35, 37, 39 and 41). Altogether, these data indicate that the specificity/selectivity of the expressed libraries (12-16) is against mycobacterial strains only.

## CONCLUSION

[0427] As with Example 1, for all libraries prepared, only a small fraction of the possible combinations and/or reorientations of domains have been tested as a proof in principle for workable fusions of particular configurations. Therefore, the exemplified hits in libraries should not be construed as being the only hits that work for a particular library. The key point is that the proof in principle data shows that workable constructs can be developed of certain configurations (i.e. those that contain (i) a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, (ii) a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and (iii) a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity), while configurations lacking these essential components always fail to demonstrate antimycobacterial activity unless they are used in particular mixtures, and that the domains used can be oriented in either direction within the fusion peptide.

## Example 3

[0428] Growth curves were prepared when constructing the various libraries to assess whether there were any differences in expressing the proteins based on their configuration. The comparison was made based on optical density (OD<sub>sub</sub>625 nm), which positively correlates with expression levels (i.e. a higher mass of bacterial growth results in a larger expression level of the fusion protein).

[0429] The components used for all conditions were as follows: [0430] AMP=Ci-MAM-A24; [0431] Linker=Linker 1; [0432] LysA=TM4; and [0433] LysB=D29.

[0434] Fusions of AMP-LysA, AMP-LysB and AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA (referred to as 4D10) were created using these domains, and expressed in bacteria as previously described. The bacteria were grown in LB medium for up to 8 hours, with optical density being assessed at 2, 3, 4, 6 and 8 hours. For 4D10, a considerably faster expression level was achieved, as shown by the vastly increased optical density at 2 and 3 hours in FIG. 42. Surprisingly, even 8 hours later the AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB conditions did not achieve equivalent expression levels as 4D10 at 3 hours.

[0435] These data support an advantage of the fusion peptides comprised of all three domains (compared with the prior art 2-domain peptides), which are able to be expressed faster. It is also important to note the advantage of expressing the required proteins for antimycobacterial activity in a single bacterial colony. On the other hand, if mixtures of AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB are required to achieve antimycobacterial activity, then two separate bacterial colonies must be created, each protein purified, and the mixture then formed. The present invention therefore streamlines the process while obtaining the surprising technical effect of faster expression. Furthermore, AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB constructs were observed to be toxic to *E. coli*, used as the host for peptide expression, thereby resulting in a lower rate of expression. Surprisingly, fusion peptides comprising AMP, LysA and LysB removed this host toxicity, resulting in the faster rate of expression. Accordingly, by creating fusions of AMP-LysA-LysB, such as 4D10, it is possible to express anti-



mycobacterial peptides in host *E. coli* that would otherwise (i.e. in an AMP-LysA or AMP-LysB format) result in *E. coli* cytotoxicity.

[0436] A summary of the growth inhibition and mycobacterial specificity for clone 4D10 can be seen in the Table 6. TABLE-US-00013 TABLE 6 Growth inhibition of various mycobacteria and bacterial controls for 4D10. Test strain Growth inhibition *Mycobacterium smegmatis* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml >70% *Mycobacterium bovis* 10.sup.6 CFU/ml >99% *Mycobacterium abscessus* 10.sup.7 CFU/ml >99% *E. coli* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml 0% *Staphylococcus aureus* 10.sup.8 CFU/ml 0% *Micrococcus lysodeikticus* 10.sup.6 CFU/ml 0%

Example 4

Methods

Expression and Purification

[0437] Different combinations and mixtures of AMP (Ci-MAM-20, SEQ ID NO: 37), LysA (TM4, SEQ ID NO: 13) and LysB (D29, SEQ ID NO: 15) were constructed according to Table 7. Each construct was expressed in *E. coli* CodonPlus (DE3)-RIL, preculture of 10 mL of LB medium supplemented with kanamycin and grown overnight. 150 ml of Terrific Broth (TB) medium supplemented with Kanamycin were inoculated with 3 ml of the preculture, and incubated at 37° C. When the optical density (OD600.sub.nm) reached 0.5-0.6, the cells were induced for protein expression using IPTG at a final concentration of 0.5 mM at 16° C. for 18 hours. The cells were harvested by centrifugation and the cell pellet was resuspended in 20 ml of binding buffer (50 mM Tris-HCl, 0.5 M NaCl, 20 mM imidazole, pH 8) and sonicated on ice. Lysates were cleared by centrifugation (18,500×g, 30 min) and filtered (0.22-μm). The clarified lysate was purified using HisTrap FF™ nickel column (GE Healthcare Bio-Sciences AB, Uppsala, Sweden). The eluted fractions were pooled together and dialyzed against dialysis buffer (50 mM Tris-HCl, 0.5 M NaCl, pH 8) overnight at 4° C. Protein concentration was measured by nanodrop, and samples were kept at 4° C.

Testing the Antibacterial Activity of the Purified Samples

[0438] *Mycobacterium smegmatis* mc.sup.2 (155; ATCC 700084) was grown overnight in Mueller-Hinton broth (MHB) at 37° C. For the assay, 50 μl of 4×10.sup.5 CFU/ml *M. smegmatis* cells were mixed with 50 μl of the purified proteins (35-50 μg) in a microtiter plate in duplicates and incubated at 37° C. for 24 hours. The endpoint measurement at OD625.sub.nm was performed in a microplate reader (Multiskan™ GO Microplate Spectrophotometer, Thermo Scientific) after 24 hours. A well with 100 μl MHB served as 100% inhibitory activity positive control, and another well with *M. smegmatis* cells was considered as 0% inhibitory activity negative control.

Results

[0439] Neither LysA (50 μg) nor LysB (50 μg) alone or in a mixture showed any antimycobacterial activity against *M. smegmatis*. Neither AMP-LysA (50 μg) nor AMP-LysB (50 μg) alone showed any antibacterial activity, but when both were present in a mixture (AMP-LysA (50 μg) and AMP-LysB (50 μg)), 50% inhibitory activity was observed (FIG. 43). Surprisingly, however, the fusion protein AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA (Seq ID: 38+16+104+14) 35 μg showed 100% inhibitory activity (FIG. 43).

TABLE-US-00014 TABLE 7 The antibacterial activity of the purified proteins SEQ Total amount Concentration Inhibitory Construct/Mixture ID NOS (μg) (μM) activity (%) LysA 14 50 8.4 0 LysB 16 50 17 0 LysA and 14 and 16 50 + 25.4 0 LysB 50 = 100 AMP-LysA 38 + 14 50 7.8 0 AMP-LysB 38 + 16 50 14.6 0 AMP-LysA and (38 + 14) and 50 + 22.2 50 AMP-LysB (38 + 16) 50 = 100 AMP-LysB- 38 + 16 + 35 3.75 100 Linker-LysA 104 + 14

[0440] There are potential safety issues for using certain AMPs at high doses, and so it is advantageous to be able to use AMPs at lower doses while maintaining AMP activity. Therefore, the amount of each component was estimated using a percentage fraction based on kDa of the fusion peptide (see Table 8). These data demonstrate that the fusion peptide is more effective despite being at a lower over amount (in μg), which allows the creation of more effective fusion peptides with increased function at lower concentrations. Such improved peptides are particularly advantageous from a safety point of view for dosing recipients of the fusion peptides.

TABLE-US-00015 TABLE 8 Amount and concentration of each component used based on kDa. Mixture Fusion peptide AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA Element μg μM μg μM LysA 47.7 7.8 22.0 3.8 LysB 45.5 14.6 10.7 3.8 AMP 6.8 22.3 1.1 3.9 Fusion/ 100 NA 35 3.8 Mixture

[0441] The concentration of AMP, LysA and LysB is substantially lower in the fusion peptide AMP-LysB-Linker-LysA, and AMP in particular with almost 6 times lower concentration than used in the mixture (AMP-LysA and AMP-LysB), which only obtained half the inhibitory activity of the fusion peptide.

## Claims

1. A peptide comprising: (i) a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, and (ii) a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and (iii) a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity.
2. The peptide according to claim 1, further comprising a fourth domain that is at least one protein transduction domain (PTD).
3. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein the first domain is an enzyme domain.
4. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein the second domain: (iv) is an enzyme domain; (v) is specific to the ester linkage between mycolic acid and arabinogalactan; or between mycolic acid and trehalose or between arabinogalactan and peptidoglycan, and/or any member of the alpha/beta hydrolase family; (vi) is specific to alpha and/or beta hydrolases;

(vii) is a mycolyl arabinogalactan esterase and/or a mycolyl-arabinogalactan-(vii) peptidoglycan (mAGP) hydrolase; and/or (viii) have mechanisms of action corresponding to alpha/beta hydrolase activity, esterase activity, lipase activity, protease activity, TDMH, cutinase activity, trehalose dimycolate hydrolase (TDMH), Pectinesterase, CheB methyltransferase, Glycerophosphoryl diester phosphodiesterase, Plant invertase/pectin methyltransferase inhibitor, Carboxylesterase family, Calcineurin-like phosphoesterase, Putative esterase, Thioesterase domain, Hemagglutinin esterase, Calcineurin-like phosphoesterase superfamily domain, Pectinacetyltransferase, Putative serine esterase, Esterase PHB depolymerase, Esterase-like activity of phytase, Chitin recognition protein, Glycosyl hydrolase all families, Amidase, Lipase all families, GDSL-like Lipase/Acylhydrolase, Partial alpha/beta-hydrolase lipase region, GDSL-like Lipase/Acylhydrolase family, Secretory lipase, Patatin-like phospholipase, Carboxylesterase, Variant-surface-glycoprotein phospholipases all families, Putative lysophospholipase, Alpha/beta-hydrolase superfamily, Hydrolase, haloacid dehalogenase-like hydrolase, epoxide hydrolase and dehalogenases, peroxidase, or any combinations thereof.

5. (canceled)

6. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein the peptide comprises multiple domains corresponding to a first domain, second domain, third domain, and/or fourth domain, wherein the multiple domains are: (i) repeats of the same domain; (ii) different domains but with the same type of activity; (iii) derived from the same source; or (iv) derived from different sources.

7. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein the third domain with membrane permeabilising activity is an antimicrobial peptide (AMP) or portion thereof, a holin or portion thereof, and/or a spanin or portion thereof, optionally wherein the AMP or a portion thereof is cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic, amphipathic, synthetic or natural or any combination thereof (or comprises portions that are cationic, polycationic, hydrophobic, amphipathic, synthetic or natural, or any combination thereof).

8. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein the peptide further comprises at least one linker peptide, wherein the linker peptide connects: (i) the first domain to the second domain; (ii) the second domain to the third domain; (iii) the first domain to the third domain; and/or (iv) a domain to a further linker.

9. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein: (i) the first domain and/or second domain comprises a domain with a mechanism of action selected from the group consisting of amidase, transglycosylase, chitinase, muramidase and/or peptidase, N-acetylmuramoyl-L-alanine amidase, Amidases in general including all families, D-Alanine-meso-Diaminopimelic (DD) endopeptidase, c-D-glutamyl-meso-diaminopimelic acid (DL) peptidase, Endopeptidases in general including all families, lytic trans glycosylases, N-acetylmuramidase, lysozyme, L-alanoyl-D-glutamate (LD), m-DAP-m-DAP (LD) endopeptidase in general, D-alanyl-D-alanine carboxypeptidase, Glycoside hydrolases in general including all families, L-Alanine-D-Glutamate peptidase, cysteine protease, N-acetyl- $\beta$ -D-glucosaminidase carboxypeptidase, glycosidase (glucosaminidases), transpeptidases, epimerase,  $\gamma$ -D-glutamyl-meso-diaminopimelic acid (DL) peptidases, and/or combinations thereof; (ii) any one or more of the domains are effective against the phylum Actinobacteria; derived from the class Actinobacteridae; derived from the order Actinomycetales, and/or Bifidobacteriales; (iii) any one or more of the domains are effective against *Mycobacterium* selected from the group consisting of: *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium microti*, *Mycobacterium africanum*, *Mycobacterium bovis*, *Mycobacterium canettii*, *Mycobacterium pinnipedii*, *Mycobacterium caprae*, *Mycobacterium mungi*, *Mycobacterium leprae*, *Mycobacterium ulcerans*, *Mycobacterium xenopi*, *Mycobacterium shottsii*, *Mycobacterium avium*, *Mycobacterium avium* subsp. *paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium intracellulare*, *Mycobacterium smegmatis*, *Mycobacterium abscessus*, *Mycobacterium kansasii*, *Mycobacterium terrae*, *Mycobacterium nonchromogenicum*, *Mycobacterium goodii*, and *Mycobacterium triviale*, and non-tuberculosis mycobacteria (NTM); and/or (iv) any one or more of the domains are derived from at least one mycobacteriophage and/or at least one *Mycobacterium* prophage.

10. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein any one or more of the domains are a mutant, variant or wildtype domain; wherein the mutant or variant retains substantially the same level of activity of the wildtype domain.

11-13. (canceled)

14. A polynucleotide, vector, and/or cell comprising a nucleic acid encoding a peptide comprising (i) a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, and (ii) a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and (iii) a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity.

15. (canceled)

16. An in vitro method of lysing, killing, reducing growth of, or reducing viability of mycobacteria, wherein the method comprises administering a peptide according to claim 1.

17. A device comprising a peptide according to claim 1.

18.-19. (canceled)

20. The peptide according to claim 3, wherein the enzyme domain is a lysin.

21. The peptide according to claim 1, wherein the first domain is a LysA or at least a portion thereof, or the second domain is a LysB or at least a portion thereof.

22. The peptide according to claim 21, wherein: (i) the portion of LysA or the portion of LysB is an enzyme active domain (EAD); or (ii) the LysA or LysB comprises a cell wall binding domain (CBD).

23. The peptide according to claim 22, wherein the cell wall binding domain (CBD) is: (i) specific to a bacterial target of interest; (ii) is not specific to the cell walls of Gram positive or Gram negative bacteria; or (iii) is specific to mycobacterial cell walls.

**24.** A method for treating infection, granulomas or biofilms, or promoting wound healing, the method comprising administering to an individual in need thereof a therapeutically effective amount of a peptide comprising: (i) a first domain with activity specific to a peptidoglycan or component thereof, and (ii) a second domain with activity specific to an ester linkage; and (iii) a third domain with membrane permeabilising activity.

**25.** The method according to claim 24, wherein the infection is: (i) a mycobacterial infection; or (ii) tuberculosis; or (iii) an infection caused by a bacteria selected from *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium microti*, *Mycobacterium africanum*, *Mycobacterium bovis*, *Mycobacterium canettii*, *Mycobacterium pinnipedii*, *Mycobacterium caprae*, *Mycobacterium mungi*, *Mycobacterium leprae*, *Mycobacterium ulcerans*, *Mycobacterium xenopi*, *Mycobacterium shottsii*, *Mycobacterium avium*, *Mycobacterium avium* subsp. *paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium paratuberculosis*, *Mycobacterium intracellulare*, *Mycobacterium smegmatis*, *Mycobacterium abscessus*, *Mycobacterium kansasii*, *Mycobacterium terrae*, *Mycobacterium nonchromogenicum*, *Mycobacterium gordonae*, and *Mycobacterium triviale*, and non-tuberculosis mycobacteria. (iv) a respiratory, ocular, skin, oral or dental infection; or (v) a bacterial infection caused by a bacterium that is resistant to at least one drug or is classified as multidrug-resistant (MDR), extremely drug-resistant (XDR), or totally drug-resistant (TDR).

**26.** The method according to claim 24, further comprising administration of at least one additional therapeutic agent.

**27.** The method according to claim 26, wherein the additional therapeutic agent is an anti-mycobacterial agent.

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